

Climate Commitments or Creative Accounting? How International Organizations Navigate Conflicting Demands*

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Abstract

In recent years, the World Bank has pledged to support climate-friendly development while reducing fossil fuel finance. We argue the Bank has responded to external pressure not primarily by changing the types of projects it funds, but by reclassifying existing projects to emphasize their climate content. We use automated text classification of all World Bank projects approved between 2001 and 2022 to compare official sector and theme classifications against topic proportions derived from project descriptions. Our results show strong agreement between official and text-based measures for extractive content, but sharp divergence for climate: the official classifications systematically overstate both the climate content of projects and the scale of climate finance, with the gap widening considerably after the Paris Agreement. These findings illustrate how international organizations may adapt to external pressure not through substantive change, but through the strategic use of classification and labeling systems.

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1 Introduction

How do international organizations (IOs) balance their original mandates with new initiatives? In 2016 and 2020, the World Bank adopted ambitious Climate Change Action Plans, promising to increase climate finance to 35 percent of its total budget and align all its operations with the Paris Agreement. By 2023, it had already become the largest single provider of multilateral climate finance to low- and middle-income countries ([European Investment Bank, 2024](#)), and in 2024, it raised its climate finance target to 45 percent. In parallel, during the 2017 One Planet Summit, the Bank pledged to cease financing upstream oil and gas projects by 2019.¹ However, this pledge has been repeatedly challenged by high-profile instances of continued support for fossil fuel-related activities, leading environmental groups to accuse the Bank of deception.² Likewise, some member states have urged the Bank to continue to take steps to meet its climate commitments.³ These pledges reflect sustained pressure from developed country principals and environmental NGOs, but sit in tension with the Bank’s core mandate to promote economic development in the world’s poorest countries, where new fossil fuel discoveries often represent significant growth opportunities.

These competing pressures remain acute. In a 2025 speech, US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent declared: “the Bank must take an all-of-the-above approach to energy that includes financing for gas, oil, and coal ... To accomplish this, the Bank must remove its 45% climate co-benefits financing target, which skews projects away from country priorities and distorts projects away from the goal of increasing access to the affordable and reliable energy needed to increase growth and productivity.”⁴ At the same time, other countries have pressured the Bank to continue to meet climate goals. For instance, France’s development minister said in

¹“Upstream” refers to projects focused on the extraction of natural resources, while “downstream” refers to the management of revenue generated by extraction.

²In 2020, for example, Guyana received \$55 million to train oil and gas officials and revamp the banking and insurance sectors to support the fossil fuel industry. See Jasper Jolly. 2020. “Anger Over World Bank’s \$55M Pledge to Guyana’s Fossil Fuel Industry.” *The Guardian*.

³See Marc Jones, “France urges World Bank not to scrap climate target,” Reuters 25 June 2026.

⁴US Department of the Treasury. 2025. *Statement from US Secretary of the Treasury Scott Bessent for the World Bank Development Committee and IMF International Monetary and Financial Committee*. See also [Bessent Statement](#).

2026: “as shareholders, countries of these institutions, it is, of course, our responsibility to ensure that their operations remain sufficiently ambitious when it comes to climate finance... and this is, of course, the case where other shareholders have different views on climate, as it is the case now.”⁵ As two of the Bank’s largest shareholders, the US and France illustrate how the institution is often pulled in opposing directions.

Competing or partially competing goals are common among IOs. The International Monetary Fund (IMF) must weigh the trade-offs between injecting immediate liquidity to halt debt crises and pursuing painful reforms designed to prevent future crises. The UN Human Rights Council must balance its desire to hold repressive regimes accountable with the universal membership provisions of the UN and the need for engagement with the most repressive regimes, resulting in cases in which states accused of human rights abuses end up serving a term on the Council. The International Criminal Court must contend with its mission to hold perpetrators of war crimes accountable while not unduly infringing on state sovereignty.

IOs facing competing pressures adopt multiple strategies. For instance, IO leaders can bargain with state principals to craft compromise solutions. IO bureaucracies also engage in public advocacy to promote new programs while continuing existing ones, thereby highlighting efforts to address the demands of outside principals or constituencies without abandoning core priorities. Another strategy is promoting internal procedural reforms that signal compliance with new goals while allowing traditional programs to continue. While the World Bank has adopted a mixture of these strategies in response to calls for increased climate finance, we focus on the third: internal changes that emphasize the Bank’s improved climate portfolio.

Specifically, we examine project-level data to understand the extent to which the World Bank increased climate finance and reduced oil and gas finance, especially after 2019. Our analysis uses data on all projects funded by the World Bank Group’s two public sector in-

⁵Marc Jones, “France urges World Bank not to scrap climate target,” Reuters 25 June 2026.

stitutions: the International Development Association (IDA), which provides concessional loans and grants, and the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD), which provides non-concessional loans. Following [Kaya and Leblebicioglu \(2025\)](#), we conduct a textual analysis of all project descriptions. To validate the Bank’s official project classifications, we use keyword-assisted topic models ([Eshima, Imai and Sasaki, 2024](#)) to generate text-based measures of each project’s substantive content, assessing how closely these text-derived topics align with the Bank’s labels. We then examine how both the official classifications and the alternative topics have evolved over time, using project-level regressions to compare trends in climate, extractive, and renewable content, with health-related projects as the reference category. Finally, we evaluate whether the Bank’s reported climate components translated into meaningful financial commitments by analyzing project-level IDA and IBRD funding. Our results show that while the extractive, renewable, and health measures broadly agree across official and text-based classifications, the climate measures diverge sharply, suggesting that the Bank’s reporting systematically overstates both the climate content of its projects and the scale of climate finance they deliver.

This over-reporting coincides with outside pressure to deliver on the Bank’s promise to divest from fossil fuel projects. Despite the recent U.S. retreat from environmental cooperation, many country principals remain committed to sustainable development. NGOs also scrutinize World Bank projects for evidence the Bank is living up to its pledges.⁶ This outside pressure can seep down to the level of project classification in several ways. The project classification process, explained in brief below, entails multiple points of quality assessment and feedback and ultimately requires executive board approval (though this is sometimes expedited). At any one of these stages, bureaucrats up and down the “delegation chain” can push for greater emphasis on the environmental benefits of a project. Country directors, whose approval is necessary for projects to proceed, may feel direct and indirect incentives to request more climate-related language. Others have pointed out the Bank’s culture is

⁶See, for instance, *Investing in Climate Disaster: World Bank Finance for Fossil Fuels*, report from *The Big Shift Global*, available at [Investing in Climate Disaster](#)

characterized by “approval seeking” (Heinzel, Weaver and Jorgensen, 2025; Weaver, 2008), and project success is an important determinant of job advancement. As pressure from state principals and civil society mounts, project leaders may insert more language touting projects’ climate benefits to increase the likelihood of approval.

Our main contribution is to highlight how IOs respond to external pressures from multiple constituencies. Despite its stated goal of combating climate change, the World Bank must please its principals (whose own climate commitments are often tenuous at best), compete with China (which offers fast, generous infrastructure loans with lax environmental safeguards), promote development in resource-rich countries (where institutions are often too weak to manage windfalls transparently), and fend off accusations of hypocrisy (as it is difficult to demand that recipients downscale emissions when high-emitting donors are unwilling to do the same). It is no surprise, then, that our empirical results suggest the Bank’s own accounting overstates its climate commitments: this discrepancy reflects the Bank’s need to balance its missions against pleasing principals with disparate and sometimes rapidly changing interests.

2 Competing Interests in Multilateral Lending

2.1 Principal Demands and Donor Competition

While World Bank lending is ostensibly client-oriented and needs-based (Cormier, 2016), macroeconomic performance is sometimes a secondary consideration when lending to US allies (Kilby, 2009). Important US trade partners or bilateral aid recipients tend to receive larger loans (Fleck and Kilby, 2006), whereas temporary members of the UN Security Council receive IMF loans with fewer conditions (Dreher, Sturm and Vreeland, 2015) and attract more frequent funding from both Bretton Woods institutions (Dreher, Sturm and Vreeland, 2009a,b). When countries’ voting behavior in the UN General Assembly aligns with that of the US, the World Bank tends to disburse loans faster, particularly ahead of competitive

executive elections (Kersting and Kilby, 2016). Bank staff also tend to design programs that align with US preferences (Clark and Dolan, 2021). This political control is reinforced by the fact that a considerable chunk of multilateral climate finance comes from multi-donor trust funds (Arias and Clark, 2026), where voluntary contributions allow donors to tie the hands of international bureaucrats and ensure that their own climate preferences are met, even if this comes at the expense of recipients’ needs (Reinsberg, 2017; Eichenauer and Reinsberg, 2017; Graham, 2023).

To its credit, the World Bank recognizes that overly restrictive demands may drive borrowers into the arms of non-traditional lenders, and in the case of China, a geopolitical rival to the US. Faced with competition, the Bank emulates China by funding projects in infrastructure-intensive sectors (including oil and gas) and possibly relaxing environmental safeguard requirements (Zeitz, 2021). It also makes fewer demands to borrowers that simultaneously receive aid from new donors like China, India, Saudi Arabia, and the United Arab Emirates (Hernandez, 2017).

This political reality is compounded by a stark power imbalance. The most powerful members of the Bretton Woods institutions are responsible for the largest share of cumulative carbon emissions. Conversely, those least responsible for such emissions and most vulnerable to climate change have the least decision-making power within these institutions. For example, the US, responsible for a fifth of all cumulative carbon emissions since 1850, controls between 9.71 and 17.66 percent of the votes in the organizations composing the World Bank Group.⁷ In contrast, the 68 developing countries that self-identify as climate-vulnerable (V20)⁸ are responsible for 5 percent of global emissions and command a similarly small vote share in the World Bank and the IMF (Merling and Forster, 2024, 552). Despite comprising about 22% of the world’s population, V20 countries currently only account for about 7.7% of vote shares on the Bank’s Board of Governors.⁹

⁷As of 2024, the specific US vote shares are 9.71 percent for IDA, 14.81 percent for MIGA, 15.49 percent for IBRD, and 17.66 percent for IFC.

⁸The original group included only 20 countries but has greatly expanded in recent years.

⁹Vote shares on the Executive Board are more difficult to calculate, since the Executive Board currently

Given this imbalance, skeptics point to the Bank’s so-called organized hypocrisy: its rhetoric changes much faster than its reality (Weaver, 2008). This hypocrisy reflects not only the need for international bureaucrats to please multiple political masters with heterogeneous and inconsistent preferences, but also the broader pathologies and dysfunctions of IOs. If the Bank is beholden to the demands of its key principals and pressured to compete with new donors that have less ambitious climate policies, like China (Tørstad, Sælen and Bøyum, 2020), why should it seriously pursue climate change mitigation? The competing pressures to simultaneously meet shifting climate goals of key principals while remaining an influential source of development funding are stark.

2.2 Climate Policy

Despite facing pressure from key principals, IOs are ultimately independent actors with their own agendas (Barnett and Finnemore, 1999). IMF staff care about the climate (Clark and Zucker, 2024) and extend less stringent conditions to climate-vulnerable countries (Arias and Clark, 2026). Though there is no equivalent research on the climate preferences of World Bank staff, one can reasonably assume that these individuals agree with their IMF counterparts: not only do both IOs have common development priorities and overlapping operations (Marchesi and Sirtori, 2011), but they also recruit from a similar pool of neoliberal economists (Nelson, 2014).

Additionally, IO staff care about their employer’s reputation. Non-governmental organizations can meaningfully influence IO behavior (Tallberg et al., 2015); in the past, the World Bank has responded to civil society pressure by dropping large infrastructure projects associated with human rights violations and environmental damage (Wade, 2009). At a minimum, staff want to honor existing commitments to prevent reputational damage. The Bank also seems to respond to new information. Shifts in the World Bank’s research program affect the content of loan conditionality; for instance, as staff research increasingly focuses on

has 25 seats representing 189 countries.

domestic ownership, more loan conditions reflect this concern (Cormier and Manger, 2022). Lastly, the Bank has remarkable financial autonomy (Nielson and Tierney, 2003). Even after the Executive Board approves specific project loans, staff with country experience and good supervisory ability play a key role in recipient performance (Heinzel and Liese, 2021).

At the leadership level, G-7 countries have become more environmentally concerned, pushing for reforms that increase the Executive Board’s involvement in the loan approval process, the reporting requirements for approved projects (with a section devoted to each project’s environmental impact), and the number of environmental personnel hired by the Bank (Nielson and Tierney, 2003). Even if G-7 countries are unwilling to reduce their own emissions, they may support such efforts elsewhere — a different form of hypocrisy, but one that would lead to greater funding for climate projects in the developing world. And ultimately, even “weak” states can wield outsize influence in international climate negotiations, as their climate vulnerability legitimizes their salient positions (Genovese, 2020).

In summary, World Bank staff care about the environment, want to maintain their reputation, have some discretion over how to distribute loans, and can directly influence loan implementation. Therefore, we should expect the World Bank to take climate issues seriously: funding for climate-related initiatives, such as renewable energy and coastal zone management, should increase, coinciding with major announcements from the Climate Summit. The pressure to do so has only intensified as extreme climate events have affected some of the Bank’s poorest borrowers.

2.3 Extractive Industries

In financial terms, extractive industry activity far exceeds multilateral lending. In 2023, the World Bank Executive Board approved 322 projects worth \$72.8 *billion*, whereas mineral fuel and oil exports totaled \$1.89 *trillion*.¹⁰ Natural resources are famously associated with

¹⁰World Bank data, reported by the 2023 Annual Report, correspond to fiscal year 2023 (from July 1, 2022 to June 30, 2023). Export data, reported by the UN Comtrade Database for calendar year 2023, correspond to HS Code 27: “mineral fuels, mineral oils and products of their distillation; bituminous substances; mineral

rent-seeking behavior (Andersen et al., 2017), reduced incentives to collect taxes (McGuirk, 2013), low democratic accountability (Paler, 2013), fewer women in the labor force (Ross, 2008), and a higher onset of civil war (Ross, 2004).

Still, the extractive sector remains a key focus for the IMF and the World Bank (Goes and Chapman, 2024; Goes, 2023). Both institutions, as well as other international financial institutions, consistently recommend joining the Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative (EITI), established in 2002 (Sovacool et al., 2016). EITI adherence was historically an informal requirement to reach Heavily Indebted Poor Country (HIPC) status, which would make countries eligible for special assistance from the World Bank and the IMF (David-Barrett and Okamura, 2016). This reflects the international community’s emphasis on transparency in the extractive sector. Numerous World Bank projects have funded EITI implementation and related good governance initiatives. This continuous support, despite the mixed evidence of EITI’s effectiveness,¹¹ is rooted in pragmatism: if governed properly, extractive industries can fund development projects, improve infrastructure, and diminish poverty (Venables, 2016), in addition to reducing the need for additional borrowing (Goes and Kaplan, 2024). Abandoning these resources could hinder important development progress.

Even IOs committed to climate action likely recognize the realities faced by resource-rich emerging economies, which are not yet diversified enough to abandon the extractive sector. Withdrawing funding or conditioning it on environmental reforms is unlikely to deter these countries from prospecting. Instead, this may simply drive them toward Chinese financing (Zeitz, 2021). If oil and gas projects are to be funded anyway, it might be in the World Bank’s best interest to fund them directly, ensuring that such projects are managed transparently. The Bank may consider that such projects bring more benefits than costs, at least under some circumstances. Some extractive industries, such as mining for critical minerals, do

waxes.”

¹¹For example, EITI has reduced deforestation (Kinda and Thiombiano, 2024) and increased trust in politicians (Fenton Villar, 2020), but it has not increased accountability, political stability, or government effectiveness in compliant countries (Sovacool et al., 2016), though there are benefits at earlier stages of implementation (Papyrakis, Rieger and Gilberthorpe, 2017; Fenton Villar and Papyrakis, 2017).

not necessarily contradict the Bank’s climate goals, though funding for these initiatives is relatively recent.

Furthermore, the Bank must navigate a legitimacy crisis. Recipients are increasingly critical of the notion that they should scale back resource production when major donors like Canada, Norway, and the US have increased their own hydrocarbon output in recent years.¹² High-level civil servants across 121 countries already perceive the World Bank and the IMF as biased and ineffective (Heinzel et al., 2020). By making stringent environmental demands that recipients perceive as hypocritical, these institutions risk eroding their authority and reducing compliance with conditionality or policy advice (Weaver, 2008). For instance, in 2023, Guyana’s president Irfaan Ali stated: “As I speak to you, 53% of the world energy mix comes from oil and gas. Even if we end up in a situation in 2070 and beyond — where, let’s say, 40% of the energy mix comes from oil and gas — who determines who produces that 40%? These are questions that must be answered, because you can’t just decide, ‘You are out, you are in.’ That is colonization in a different way.”¹³ In 2022, Macky Sall, former president of Senegal and former chair of the African Union expressed similar frustrations: “You cannot tell us that renewables alone can develop a continent — it has never been the case anywhere else and it cannot be the case in Africa.”¹⁴

In brief, even if the World Bank is sincerely committed to climate finance, it may continue to finance extractive projects after 2019 due to concerns over pragmatism and legitimacy. Anticipating competition or judging that developmental benefits outweigh climate costs in certain contexts, the Bank may either fund upstream oil and gas projects or provide a separate transparency component for projects already funded by new donors.

¹²Jillian Kestler-D’Amours. 2022. “Canada’s ‘Petro-Provinces’ See Opportunity in Russia-Ukraine War.” *Al Jazeera*. Sam Meredith. 2023. “Norway’s Fossil Fuel Bonanza Stokes Impassioned Debate About How Best to Spend Its ‘War Profits.’ ” *CNBC*. Clifford Krauss. 2023. “Surging US Oil Production Brings Down Prices and Raises Climate Fears.” *The New York Times*.

¹³Gideon Long, “Guyana Scrambles To Make the Most of Oil Wealth,” *BBC News* 10 September 2023.

¹⁴David Pilling, “Africa Resists Pressure To Put Emissions Before Growth,” *Financial Times* 25 August 2022.

2.4 Balancing Climate and Extractive Demands

The tension between the World Bank’s climate rhetoric and its continued support of extractive industries might appear to be an example of organized hypocrisy (Weaver, 2008). Yet we argue that this apparent hypocrisy is, in fact, a necessary institutional survival strategy. The World Bank faces a clear organizational dilemma: it must manage demands from principals, compete with rival lenders, and maintain institutional legitimacy. Navigating these situations is the norm for most IOs. We identify three strategies they pursue in the face of such dilemmas, aiming for symbolic compliance that satisfies external demands while maintaining internal operational stability.

First, IOs bargain directly with principals to set ambitious goals while retaining some operational flexibility. This strategy crafts a compromise solution that is lofty and ambitious, yet soft and flexible. The World Bank has clearly demonstrated this by committing to Paris Agreement goals and eliminating *direct* funding for extractive projects, but strategically reserving the discretion to assist poorer countries manage resource revenues. For example, the 2017 pledge to cease funding upstream oil and gas projects by 2019 had an important caveat: “in exceptional circumstances” and “in the poorest countries,” the Bank would continue to support initiatives that increased energy access and “strengthen[ed] the transparency, governance, institutional capacity and regulatory environment of their energy sectors — including in oil and gas.”¹⁵

Second, IOs engage in public advocacy and rhetorical shifts to manage external perceptions. This involves strategic publicity campaigns that highlight new programs in response to popular demand. The World Bank’s Climate Change Action Plans (2016 and 2020) and related activities served this purpose, underscoring the institutional commitment to sustainable development and climate finance.

Third, and central to our argument, IO bureaucracies may change how they classify and

¹⁵World Bank Group. 2017. *Q&A: The World Bank Group and Upstream Oil and Gas*. See also: World Bank Group. 2017. *Press Release: World Bank Group Announcements at One Planet Summit*.

report their activities. This decoupling strategy signals concrete progress toward specific goals while preserving flexibility in the organizational lending portfolio. The World Bank clearly illustrates this mechanism. Besides pledging to increase climate finance and cease financing upstream oil and gas projects, it changed its project classification and expenditure-tracking system in 2016 to account for climate co-benefits, namely the share of financing dedicated to adaptation or mitigation.¹⁶ According to the Bank’s website, “this new taxonomy reflects corporate goals and priorities,”¹⁷ specifically, the goal of increasing climate finance to 45 percent of its total budget. We argue that this classification change served as a functional survival strategy, allowing the Bank to overstate compliance with its climate agenda while obscuring non-compliance. In adopting a new classification, the Bank can maximize reported compliance across multiple mandates without a substantial (and potentially conflicting) shift in its lending focus. Specifically, we anticipate that the new classification will systematically overstate the climate content of the Bank’s portfolio, while obscuring its ongoing support for extractive industries. This is because project classifications must be flexible enough to satisfy multiple principals — those that support increased climate funding and those that support increased extractive funding.

Our expectation is consistent with other research on politically motivated coding decisions in international assistance. Michaelowa and Michaelowa (2011), for instance, show that donor countries are more likely to overreport the amount of climate aid they provide when their domestic constituencies value environmental objectives and are well informed about climate policy. Although the authors focus on bilateral rather than multilateral assistance, similar dynamics may arise in a multilateral setting. In this context, the principals are more diffuse, but IOs still face pressures from key member states, civil society, and global audiences, creating incentives to strategically classify projects in ways that signal stronger environmental commitments.

¹⁶World Bank. 2021. “What You Need to Know About Climate Co-Benefits.” <https://www.worldbank.org/en/news/feature/2021/03/10/what-you-need-to-know-about-climate-co-benefits>

¹⁷<https://projects.worldbank.org/en/projects-operations/project-theme>

3 Classifying World Bank Projects

To determine how these international organizations respond to competing pressures, we analyze World Bank project content. We begin by describing how the Bank classifies its own projects into *sectors* and *themes*, how these official classifications have evolved over time, and what aspects they may obscure. Next, we conduct a validation exercise using text analysis to produce an alternative classification into *topics* and assess how closely these topics align with the Bank’s own sectors and themes. The resulting dependent variables indicate the share of each project associated with a given *sector*, *theme*, or *topic*. Finally, we examine how these classifications have evolved over time. Like [Michaelowa and Michaelowa \(2011\)](#), we aim to identify potential discrepancies between the official and alternative measures.

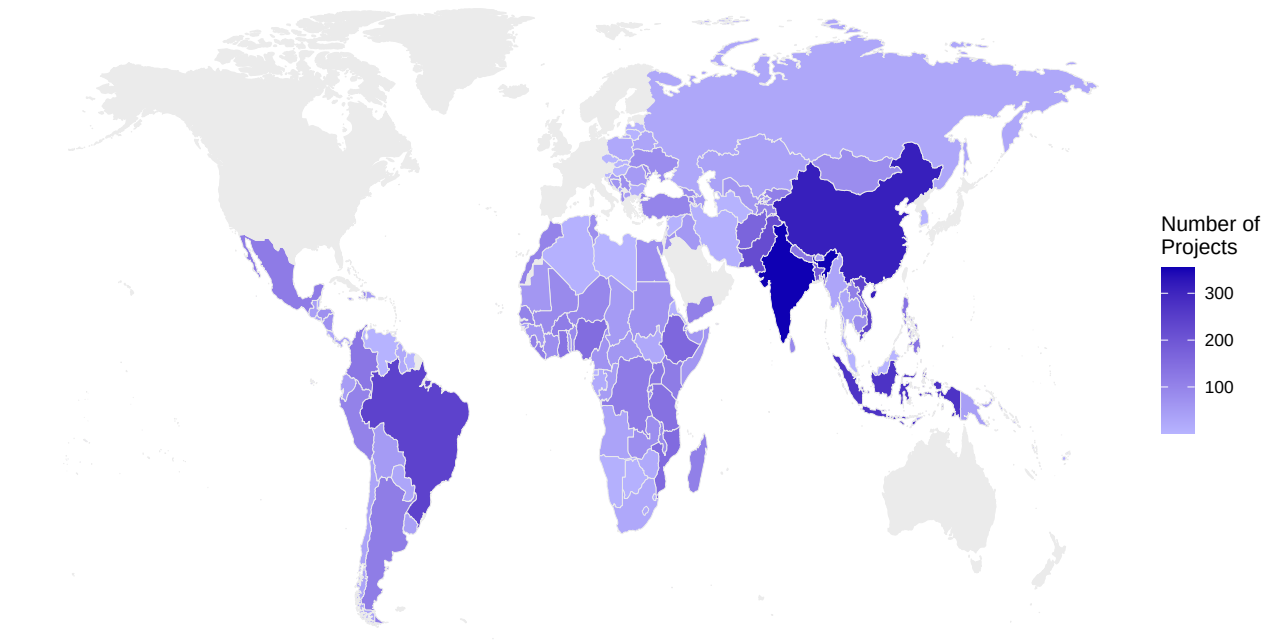
3.1 Project Data

We use data on all projects approved by the World Bank Executive Board from January 2001 to December 2022, excluding projects that cannot be attributed to one single sovereign state or were dropped before securing Executive Board approval.¹⁸ We focus on each project’s *approval* year, rather than the *start* year, because we are interested in the Bank’s internal decision-making and classification processes, not in logistical or bureaucratic factors that may delay implementation. Figure 1 shows the geographic distribution of these projects.

While some projects are grants, most fall under one of three lending instruments the World Bank offers to governments ([Heinzel and Liese, 2021](#)). Investment Project Financing (IPF) has a narrow focus: the Bank commits funds to a specific infrastructure project that the borrowing government implements. Development Policy Financing (DPF) focuses on broader policy reforms and the overall institutional framework. Both IPF and DPF include

¹⁸World Bank project information is available since May 1947, but the control variables (discussed in Section 4.2) are not, hence the restricted time frame. Projects deemed financially unfeasible may be dropped at the concept review stage, whereas others that fail to meet the Bank’s environmental and social requirements may be dropped at the appraisal stage. Only 17 projects were dropped *after* securing Executive Board approval; we include these in the analysis.

Figure 1: Number of Projects by Country, 2001–2022



This map shows the number of projects approved by the World Bank Executive Board, distributed across 150 countries, between 2001 and 2022. This excludes projects that cannot be attributed to one sovereign state or were dropped before securing Executive Board approval. Countries in gray received no projects.

conditionality, though the former is less specific.¹⁹ To increase borrower ownership and donor coordination, a third instrument, Program-for-Results (P4R), is attached to country-specific outcomes and was rolled out in 2012 (Cormier, 2016). Across all multilateral development banks, IPF, DPF, and P4R accounted for 63, 14, and 6 percent, respectively, of all climate finance provided in 2023 (European Investment Bank, 2024).

¹⁹Building on a reform process initiated in 2009, several existing lending instruments were consolidated under the IPF umbrella: Adaptable Program Loan, Emergency Recovery Loan, Financial Intermediary Loan, Learning and Innovation Loan, Rehabilitation Loan, Sector Investment and Maintenance Loan, Specific Investment Loan, and Technical Assistance Loan (World Bank Group, 2012). A similar structural consolidation had occurred in 2004, when other instruments were consolidated under the DPF umbrella: Structural Adjustment Loans, Sector Adjustment Loans, Poverty Reduction Support Credit, and Debt and Debt Service Reduction.

3.2 The Project Cycle

The preparation and appraisal process differs across lending instruments; we focus on IPF, which accounts for most projects in our sample. Its narrower focus allows us to better assess the accuracy of its classification.²⁰ Each project is led by a Task Team Leader (TTL), who serves as the primary liaison with borrowing country representatives. In the first stage, the team generates project ideas that address specific development goals while considering the Bank’s broader priorities and the borrowing country’s implementation capacity.

After selecting the lending instrument, identifying performance goals, and developing an Operational Risk Assessment, the task team then prepares a Project Concept Note (PCN). This internal document includes an initial description of the Project Development Objective (PDO) and the project’s sector and theme classifications. The task team therefore determines how a project is classified, though internal review processes may push these classifications in a systematic direction. A related document, the Project Information Document (PID), is released to the public around the same time. In a concept review meeting, the Country Director decides whether the project should move forward and, if so, whether it qualifies for an expedited process or full assessment.

If approved, the project moves to the preparation stage. Here, the task team develops the Project Appraisal Document (PAD), typically 50 to 150 pages long, detailing the project’s objectives, components, risk assessment, and implementation and monitoring arrangements, with frequent input from the borrower. The PDO is also finalized at this stage, and the PID is updated. Teams are advised to keep the PDO focused and attainable, avoiding overly ambitious projects that lack a clear purpose.

After a positive Decision Review Meeting with the Country Director, Regional Vice President, and Operations Committee, the TTL and task team conduct an Appraisal Mission to finalize project details. The PAD, along with the Operational Risk Assessment Framework,

²⁰The following discussion relies on *Task Team Leader Toolkit: Investment Project Financing — The Project Cycle*, World Bank Group.

the PCN meeting minutes, and supporting legal and financial documents, forms the negotiation package presented to the Executive Board for approval. The Regional Vice President chooses between a streamlined and a full Board presentation depending on the project’s size, complexity, and risk profile. Either way, the Executive Board reviews the negotiated package and votes on whether to approve the project and release the funds.

3.3 Official Project Taxonomies

The World Bank has two official project taxonomies. The most established taxonomy consists of 11 project *sectors*,²¹ ranging from “Agriculture” to “Water/Sanitation/Waste.” Our first dependent variable, *Extractive Sector* captures the percentage of each project that belongs to the subsectors “Mining” or “Oil and Gas” of the “Energy and Extractives” sector. For example, “Support to Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative Compliance Process Project” (Ukraine, 2015) belongs to the subsector “Oil and Gas” (100 percent). Therefore, the value of *Extractive Sector* for this project is 100 percent. An additional dependent variable, *Health Sector*, serves as a benchmark, representing a policy area that is unrelated to energy or extractive issues but coded under the same taxonomy.

This taxonomy does not have a separate sector for climate-related projects. Recognizing this limitation, the Bank introduced a new taxonomy in July 2016 consisting of eight overlapping project *themes*, including “Environment and Natural Resource Management” and its “Climate Change” sub-theme (level 2). The dependent variable *Climate Theme* captures the percentage of each project belonging to this sub-theme, with *Health Theme* serving as a benchmark (as before). Still, this taxonomy also has an important limitation: it lacks a theme for oil, gas, extractive industries, or non-renewable natural resources. Projects related to these topics often lack a theme or are listed under broader themes. For example, the aforementioned “Support to Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative Compliance Process Project” falls under three themes: “Environment and Natural Resource Management,”

²¹<https://projects.worldbank.org/en/projects-operations/project-sector>

“Public Sector Management,” and “Social Development and Protection.” The sub-theme “Energy” refers to energy efficiency, access, policies, and reform, but does not specify the energy source. Rather than phasing out upstream oil and gas investments, the World Bank could have simply stopped classifying projects as such. Projects seemingly unrelated to non-renewable natural resources and not labeled as such could still “hide” a natural resource component, allowing the Bank to support the extractive sector without violating its pledge to stop directly funding oil and gas projects.

In short, the two official taxonomies are incomplete and often contradictory. A project that generates greenhouse gas emission reductions “using flare gas that would have been otherwise flared” (Russia, 2008) is coded as belonging 100 percent to the oil and gas subsector and 100 percent to the climate sub-theme, illustrating how flexibly each taxonomy can be applied. Alternatively, [Zeitz \(2021\)](#) distinguishes between “hard” sectors (such as water supply, sanitation, transportation, agriculture, mining, and industry) and “soft” sectors (such as health and education). Yet disaggregating the “hard” and “soft” categories is difficult, as projects do not always fit neatly into either sector. Because we focus on one specific “hard” sector where there may be an incentive to provide erroneous labels, we validate the official classifications using text analysis. This analysis provides an independent measure of the same underlying concept (the project’s substantive content), allowing us to test whether the Bank’s official sector and theme labels are consistent with what project descriptions actually emphasize.

3.4 Validating the Official Taxonomies

The type of lending instrument determines which documents are publicly available. 94 percent of the 9,967 approved projects have an English-language development objective — for example, to “improve management and conservation of important forest ecosystems” (Papua New Guinea, 2001) or “strengthen the capacity of the Federal Government of Somalia to manage its petroleum sector” (Somalia, 2018). This PDO is our main data source, as

it provides broad coverage across all instrument types; because it is short, it uses topic-specific vocabulary, which is ideal for classification purposes.²² In alternative specifications, reported in Appendix I, we use PIDs and PADs, which are less public-facing than PDOs. PIDs are available for 59.6 percent of all projects. In contrast, PADs are available for 46.4 percent of projects, all IPF.²³ If the Bank strategically frames its public communications, PIDs and especially PADs may offer a less curated picture of project content. However, the length of these documents introduces substantial boilerplate language (about implementation arrangements, safeguard policies, or financing tables) that dilutes the distinctive vocabulary needed for classification, making topic identification less reliable.

We begin by preprocessing the corpus: we lowercase all letters and remove punctuation, numbers, separators, and stopwords, but do not stem words to avoid combining words with substantively different meanings (Denny and Spirling, 2018). Then, we use the preprocessed PDOs to classify projects using Eshima, Imai and Sasaki’s (2024) keyword-assisted topic model (keyATM), which captures the relative importance of different topics within a single project and has already been used to classify conditionality from the World Bank (Cormier and Manger, 2022) and the IMF (Goes, 2023).²⁴ Topic models render this a particularly hard test: in rejecting labels that might align with the Bank’s own narrative, the analysis is deliberately biased against the Bank. This raises the bar for meaningful results.

The goal of any topic model is to uncover a document’s latent themes, or topics, revealing patterns that might not be immediately apparent. The model assumes that each document is a mixture of multiple topics, where each topic is a distribution over words. First, humans specify the desired number of topics. Second, the model randomly assigns words to topics. Third, it iteratively refines these assignments based on the likelihood that each word belongs to a topic, given its distribution across the entire body of text. Each word can belong to multiple topics. What matters is not just how frequently this word occurs, but how

²²If the PDO is missing or uninformative, we use the project abstract, if available.

²³DPF uses Program Documents rather than PADs, and P4R uses Program Appraisal Documents, both of which follow different templates.

²⁴See Appendix B for a detailed model description.

frequently it *co-occurs* with other words. This process continues until the model identifies a set of topics that best explain the word distributions. When identifying topics, the model does not assign documents to topics; rather, it computes the proportion of each document’s vocabulary that corresponds to each topic.

One challenge with traditional topic models like Latent Dirichlet Allocation (LDA) (Blei, Ng and Jordan, 2003) is that they rely heavily on human interpretation and can produce incoherent topics that are difficult to interpret. The top words associated with each topic may not clearly define a meaningful theme, especially when documents are short or few — for example, when there are only a few thousand projects with short summaries, as is the case here (Syed and Spruit, 2017). Researchers must interpret the model output post hoc and manually connect the resulting topics to real-world concepts, a task often akin to “reading tea leaves” (Chang et al., 2009). As a result, topic models may struggle to answer specific research questions directly, returning topics that are neither relevant nor interpretable. Es-hima, Imai and Sasaki’s keyATM circumvents these issues by allowing researchers to specify topic labels and topic-specific keywords *before* model fitting. These pre-specified labels are ideal for researchers who want to measure specific topics rather than conduct an exploratory analysis. The resulting model yields distinct topics with less overlapping vocabulary. We estimate a dynamic keyATM, which uses a Hidden Markov Model to incorporate temporal ordering, allowing researchers to examine how each topic’s prevalence evolves over time.

Table 1: Most Common Words Per Topic (PDO Model)

Extractive Topic	Climate Topic	Health Topic
power	energy	health
gas	climate	services
supply	reduce	strengthen
electricity	resilience	covid-19
eiti	capacity	improve
oil	emissions	respond
mining	electricity	national
generation	renewable	care
plants	increase	emergency
fuel	change	quality

Our PDO model has three pre-specified topics. *Extractive Topic* and *Climate Topic* mirror the sector and theme of interest, whereas the benchmark, *Health Topic*, confirms that the top words associated with each topic define a meaningful theme. Twelve residual topics with no keywords absorb content that does not fall under the pre-specified topics.²⁵ Table 1 presents the top ten words for the pre-specified topics of interest. The pre-specified keywords that correctly match the pre-specified topic are in bold. We use the topic proportions as our final dependent variables. These topic-based dependent variables mirror the official classifications but are generated from text data. For example, the aforementioned “Support to Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative Compliance Process Project” in Ukraine belongs almost entirely to the *Extractive Topic* (98.5 percent), whereas “Vietnam’s Decarbonization and Energy Transition” (2022) belongs almost entirely to the *Climate Topic* (99.9 percent).

3.5 Dependent Variables

In sum, we have two sets of dependent variables: the official World Bank classifications into sectors (*Extractive Sector*) or themes (*Climate Theme*); and the text-derived topic proportions (*Extractive Topic* and *Climate Topic*). Across all classifications, we use health — a major area of the Bank’s portfolio — as a benchmark category (*Health Sector*, *Health Theme*, and *Health Topic*). Each variable measures the share of a project’s content associated with the corresponding category, expressed as a proportion between zero and one. For ease of interpretation, we report descriptive values and predicted values as percentages. The alternative text-based classification is not intended to serve as the absolute truth, as the topic proportions are based on PDO vocabulary rather than actual project implementation. Still, they provide a way to evaluate how accurately the Bank’s official labels reflect the substantive focus of its projects, at least on paper.

To assess how much the official classifications and the text-based proportions overlap, we

²⁵See Appendix C for a list of keywords and Appendix D for a list of all non-keyword topics, including the most common words per topic.

calculate the difference between each official classification (as a percentage of project content) and the corresponding PDO topic proportion (also as a percentage). A positive value indicates that the official classification exceeds the topic proportion; a negative value indicates the reverse. Appendix F shows the full distribution of these differences; we summarize the key patterns here.

For extractives, the mean difference between classifications is virtually zero (0.1 percentage points): *Extractive Sector* averages 1.5 percent and *Extractive Topic* averages 1.4 percent, indicating that the official classification and the topic model agree closely in this domain.²⁶ For the benchmark category, the topic model identifies slightly more health content than the official labels, though the two official health measures broadly coincide, with a discrepancy of -0.6 percentage points.²⁷ For climate, the pattern is reversed: on average, the official *Climate Theme* exceeds the *Climate Topic* by 5.6 percentage points. For the average project, *Climate Topic* is 8.6 percent, while *Climate Theme* is more than 60 percent larger: 14.2 percent. This is the largest discrepancy across all measures and is highly statistically significant ($p < 0.001$). Appendix F provides a formal test of this divergence: regressing the discrepancy on a post-2015 indicator confirms that the climate gap widened by 18.8 percentage points after the Paris Agreement ($p < 0.001$), beyond what recipient and donor characteristics explain. Together, these patterns provide preliminary support for our expectation that the Bank overstates its climate ambitions, even if its extractive classifications align closely with project descriptions.

Appendix I shows that the discrepancy between official and text-based climate classifications grows with document length. The official *Climate Theme* overstates climate content by 5.6 percentage points relative to PDO topics, 6.3 relative to PID topics, and 10.8 relative to PAD topics. This suggests that the PDO-based topic model represents a conservative lower bound on the degree of official overstatement. The pattern runs in the opposite direction

²⁶A paired t-test confirms that the difference is not statistically significant ($p = 0.285$).

²⁷Though pre-July 2016 data were retrofitted from sectors to themes, the Bank warns that the two periods (and the two classifications) are not necessarily comparable.

for extractives: longer documents identify progressively more extractive content than officially classified, with the PAD topic finding 5.2 percentage points more extractive content than the official sector label. Overall, public-facing documents appear to be systematically more aligned with official classifications than less public-facing documents, consistent with strategic framing in the Bank’s external communications.

4 Explaining Variation in World Bank Projects

4.1 Empirical Strategy

Following prior work (Cormier and Manger 2022; Clark and Dolan 2021; Kersting and Kilby 2016), we use World Bank projects as our unit of analysis. The key independent variable is time. Like Kaya and Leblebicioglu (2025), we treat the Paris Agreement as a shock that affected the Bank’s lending. Accordingly, we examine how project sectors, themes, and topics responded to the Paris Agreement (2015) and the Bank’s stated end to upstream oil and gas funding (2019). After each of these events, we expect a modest decline in extractive content (*Extractive Sector* or *Extractive Topic*) and a sharper rise in *Climate Theme*, but not necessarily in *Climate Topic*. This divergence reflects the Bank’s growing incentive, after 2015 and especially after 2019, to frame projects as climate-related to meet institutional climate finance targets, even if their actual climate content (as reflected in the text-based classification) did not increase. The prevalence of the benchmark category, health, should be largely unaffected by climate-related policy shifts and instead reflect events like the Ebola epidemic and the COVID-19 pandemic.

Given the nature of the dependent variables, we estimate fractional logistic regressions that bound predictions within a $[0, 1]$ interval.²⁸ We model time using a natural cubic spline with three degrees of freedom, placing two internal knots at the two years of interest, 2015 and 2019. This functional form allows for a smooth yet flexible relationship between time

²⁸As a robustness check, we also estimate linear regressions in Appendix H.

and the dependent variables, reflecting gradual changes in project content without imposing strict trends. By placing knots at theoretically meaningful points, the spline can flexibly accommodate shifts around periods of expected change while remaining smooth elsewhere.²⁹ Following [Cormier and Manger \(2022\)](#), all models include standard errors clustered two ways: by country and by year. Two-way clustering allows for within-country correlation (as multiple projects in one country are often complementary) and within-year correlation (as the World Bank frequently approves similar projects across countries in the same year).

4.2 Control Variables

Beyond temporal dynamics, existing research tends to focus on the number, size, and conditions of World Bank projects, rather than their content. Yet project content plausibly reflects similar factors: a mix of recipient conditions and donor interests ([Cormier and Manger, 2022](#)), all lagged to avoid simultaneity bias.

Good governance affects the types of loans a country receives: poorly governed countries are less likely to receive broad DPF and more likely to receive narrow, project-specific IPF ([Winters, 2010](#)). To measure the recipient’s quality of governance, we follow [Winters \(2010\)](#) and average the six World Governance Indicators, using linear interpolation for missing years (1997, 1999, and 2001). Given evidence that World Bank lending responds to upcoming elections ([Kersting and Kilby, 2016](#)), the dichotomous indicator *Election Year* reflects the occurrence of a presidential or parliamentary election, using data from V-Dem and the Database of Political Institutions (with additional coding for microstates). Models also include dichotomous indicators for *EITI Membership* (from the EITI website), oil and gas *Field Discovery* (from the Global Energy Monitor), *SIDS* (Small Island Developing States, following the official UN classification), and the occurrence of a biological, climatological, meteorological, hydrological, or geophysical *Disaster* (from the International Disasters

²⁹In Appendix H, we re-estimate the models using year fixed effects and a simpler specification with an *After 2019* dummy, which captures the average change in project composition following the Bank’s 2019 announcement.

Database, EM-DAT). Extractive projects might be more prevalent among EITI members. Climate projects might be more prevalent among SIDS (which tend to be more vulnerable to climate change) or after a drought, wildfire, flood, landslide, or earthquake.

The recipient’s logged *Population*, logged *GDP per Capita* (in constant 2015 US dollars), *Resource Rents* (in percentage of GDP), and *Access to Electricity* (in percent of the population), all from the World Development Indicators 2024, likely affect project content: more populated, poorer countries with large resource wealth and limited access to electricity may attract more extractive projects, even after 2019. *DAC Aid* indicates the total official development assistance received from members of the Development Assistance Committee (disbursements in billions of constant 2022 US dollars, obtained from the OECD Data Explorer in 2024), whereas *Chinese Finance* (Dreher et al., 2022) indicates the equivalent received from China (new disbursements in billions of constant 2021 US dollars). Though both variables have skewed distributions, we do not log them to avoid losing negative values (which represent loan repayments). Since World Bank lending responds to competition with China (Zeitzi, 2021), *Chinese Finance* is crucial for the analysis. However, its coverage is comparatively modest (2000–2022), hence the focus on projects after 2000.

For donor interests, one dichotomous indicator denotes *IMF Program Participation* (Kentikelenis and Stubbs, 2023) and another denotes *UN Security Council Membership* (Dreher, Sturm and Vreeland, 2009a).³⁰ *US Ideal Point Distance* and *China Ideal Point Distance* (Bailey, Strezhnev and Voeten, 2015) measure the distance between the recipient’s voting behavior in the UN General Assembly and the voting behavior of the World Bank’s two largest shareholders. If the World Bank makes exceptions to its climate commitments, funding oil and gas projects “in exceptional circumstances” even after 2019, US allies may be more likely to fall into this category, as they tend to receive more World Bank projects (Dreher, Sturm and Vreeland, 2009a) with fewer conditions (Clark and Dolan, 2021). Following evidence that domestic politics shapes US influence in the World Bank (Kersting and

³⁰Using the IMF and UN websites, respectively, we extend the data coverage to 2022.

Kilby, 2021; Stone, 2011), we include the dichotomous indicators *US President is Republican* and *US Government Is Divided*, defining the US government as divided if the presidency, the Senate, and the House of Representatives are not all controlled by the same party.

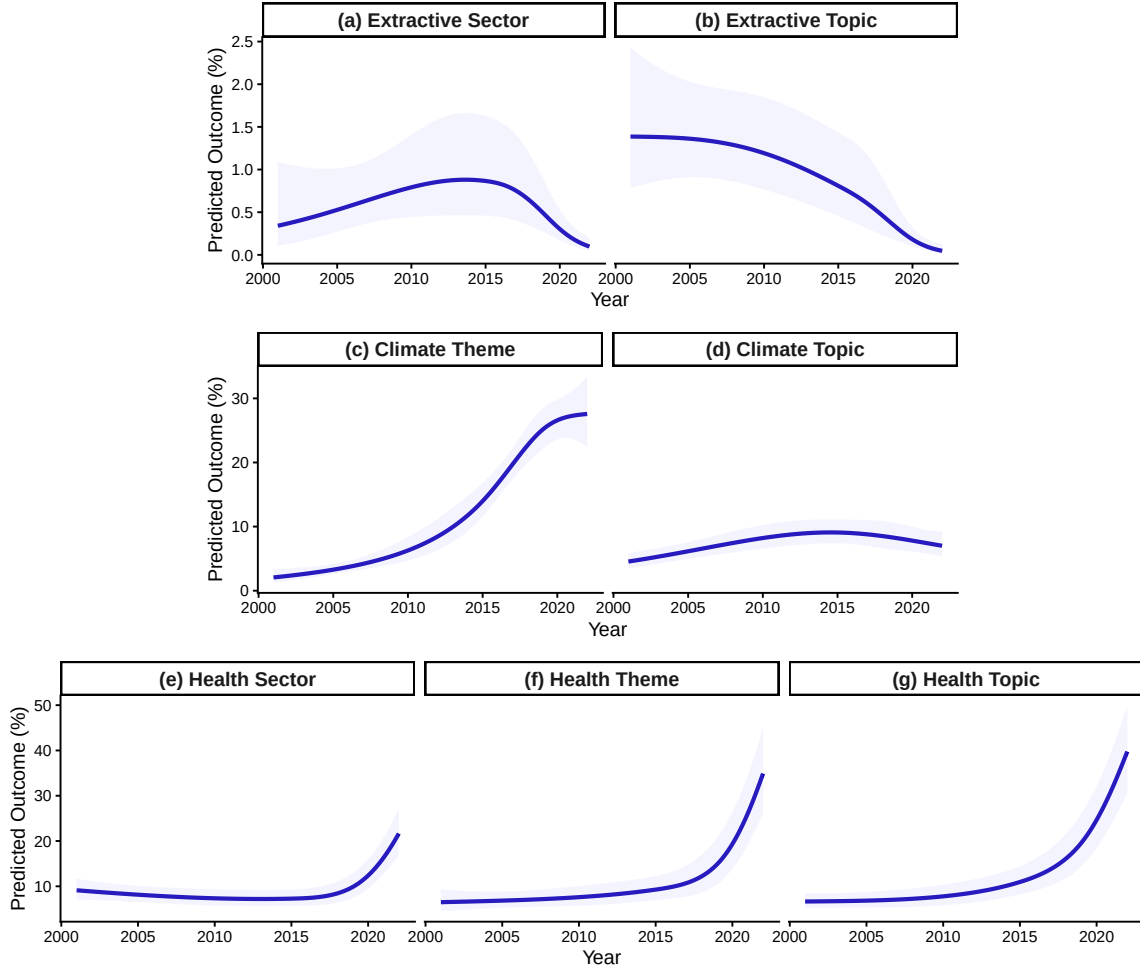
Finally, we include one project-level variable: *TTL Experience*, the number of prior projects led by the same TTL. This variable captures institutional knowledge of the Bank’s procedures and classification practices: more experienced TTLs can plausibly navigate the Bank’s taxonomy better and apply labels strategically to increase the odds of project approval. Unlike project size, duration, or performance (which reflect choices made during project preparation and could thus introduce post-treatment bias), TTL experience is measured *before* the project begins.

4.3 Explaining Project Content

Figure 2 illustrates how the predicted share of World Bank project content related to extractive, renewable, climate, and health issues evolved over time. Each content category is presented using both the Bank’s official classification (sectors or themes) and the alternative, text-derived classification (topics). As a reminder, we report the predictions in percentage terms for ease of interpretation, though the fractional logit models use the underlying shares as dependent variables. These predictions are based on models that use natural cubic splines of year, allowing for flexible, nonlinear trends in issue emphasis. Because the spline coefficients are not directly interpretable and the coefficients of control variables are not the substantive focus of this study, we present the full tables only in Appendix G.

In Figure 2, Panels (a) and (b) show divergent patterns for the official and text-based measures. The official *Extractive Sector* classification follows an inverted U-shape, increasing until around 2015 before declining. This suggests that the Bank continued to label projects as extractive through the mid-2010s, even as the PDO content (captured by the topic model) was already declining. This pattern suggests that the Paris Agreement (2015) was a turning point for official classification practices, rather than the 2019 pledge to cease upstream oil

Figure 2: Predicted Project Content (%)



These panels display the average predicted extractive, climate, and health content of a project each year. These predictions are based on fractional logistic regressions reported in Appendix G, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

and gas financing. By the time the formal deadline came around, the shift was already well underway.

Panels (c) and (d) show the evolution of climate-related projects. The proportion of projects classified under the official climate theme increases sharply after 2015, whereas the topic-based measure continues to increase gradually, with no change in pace. This divergence suggests that the Bank's climate labeling expanded much faster than the climate-related content described in PDOs, consistent with the hypothesis that there was less of an actual

increase in climate finance than an institutional reclassification to align with the Bank’s stated priorities. In other words, the Bank might exaggerate the amount of climate funding it provides: although it assigned the “climate” label more generously in recent years, the actual content of projects did not reflect such change. Our findings mirror those of [Kaya and Leblebicioglu \(2025, 5\)](#): since the Paris Agreement, “the Bank is inserting climate goals where it can when it can,” even in projects that are only tangentially related to climate.

To reiterate, the topic proportions rely on the vocabulary of official project documents, not on actual implementation. The broader classification could be correct, and the topic proportions could be incorrect: projects could include a “hidden” climate component despite not explicitly mentioning it in the project summary. If so, panel (c) would paint a more accurate picture of climate finance than panel (d). However, this is unlikely: given the World Bank’s institutional priorities, the official documents should, if anything, *overstate* a project’s climate relevance rather than obscure it. If a project is in any way related to climate change, the project description should mention it, and the topic proportion should reflect it. The divergence between panels (c) and (d) suggests that recent projects are indeed less climate-centric than the official taxonomy might initially suggest.

Lastly, panels (e), (f), and (g) identify consistent trends in health content. Because health is a benchmark category with no strategic incentive to misclassify, the consistency across panels confirms that our modeling strategy captures genuine variation rather than measurement noise, lending credibility to the divergence we observe for climate.

As reported in Appendix G, the control variables behave as expected. For example, EITI members are more likely to attract extractive projects, as are countries with a large GDP share coming from resource rents. Those under an IMF agreement are less likely to attract climate projects, perhaps because such agreements often come at the expense of the environment ([Forster, Bhandary and Gallagher, 2026](#)). Across both official and text-based measures, Chinese finance is negatively associated with climate content, consistent with the notion that countries receiving more Chinese development finance face less pressure from

Western stakeholders to prioritize environmental goals. Likewise, a divided US government is associated with lower climate content across both measures, suggesting that domestic political constraints on US climate leadership translate into reduced climate emphasis in World Bank lending.

TTL Experience is positively associated with both *Extractive Sector* and *Extractive Topic*, suggesting that more experienced TTLs tend to lead projects with higher extractive content across both measures. In contrast, TTL experience predicts the official *Climate Theme* but not the *Climate Topic*. This divergence is consistent with the expectation that experienced TTLs are more adept at navigating the Bank’s classification system: they apply the climate label more generously, without a corresponding increase in climate-related vocabulary in project descriptions.

Overall, these results suggest that the Bank may not be prioritizing climate change as strongly as its public commitments imply. We interpret this as reflecting the Bank’s “balancing act”: it must respond to growing public attention to climate change while also pleasing principals who believe economic development should be the sole institutional priority. As a result, the official classifications likely exaggerate the actual amount of climate finance provided since 2015.

4.4 Explaining Project Commitments

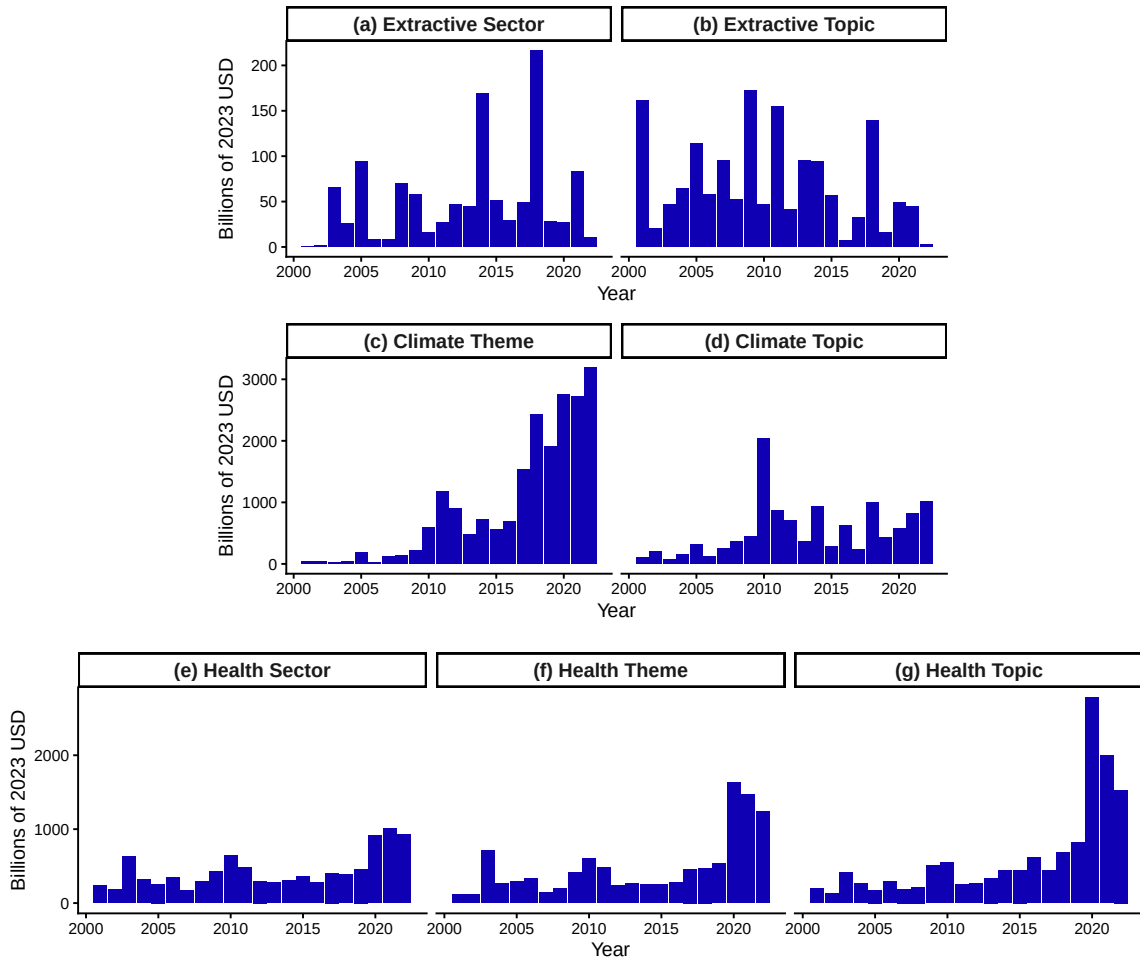
Even if project descriptions do not place greater emphasis on climate finance over time, each climate-related project may mobilize more resources. To test this possibility, we examine new IDA and IBRD commitments at the project level, deflated to constant 2023 USD using the World Development Indicators’ GDP deflator. As noted earlier, the climate theme reflects each project’s climate co-benefits, namely, the share of financing explicitly linked to adaptation or mitigation. For example, if a project’s IDA and IBRD commitments total 1,000,000 USD and 20 percent of the project falls under the climate theme, the climate

co-benefit is 200,000 USD. Correspondingly, for each project i , we calculate

$$\text{Climate Theme Commitment}_i = \text{Project Commitment}_i \times \text{Climate Theme Content Share}_i$$

More generally, we calculate the funding directed to each content category (*Extractive Sector*, *Extractive Topic*, and so on) by weighting each project's total commitment by the share devoted to the corresponding category. The resulting variables capture the expected dollar amount going to a given content category within a project.

Figure 3: Total Commitments



These panels display the total commitment (in billions of 2023 USD) across all projects each year, based on the share of extractive, climate, and health content. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

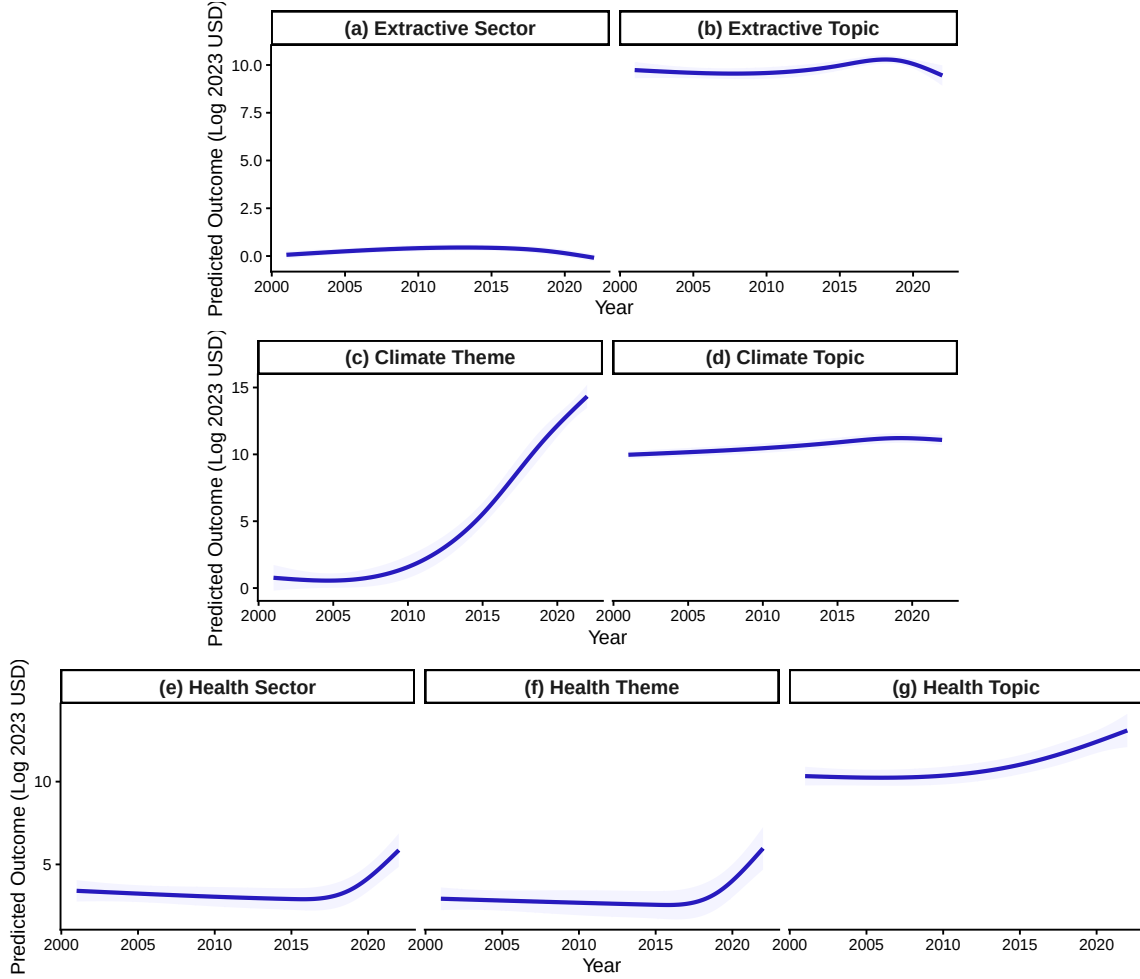
We begin by aggregating all projects by year and discussing general trends in the Bank's

lending portfolio. Figure 3 presents the estimated annual commitment by content category. Each row has its own y-axis scale; while this makes cross-row comparisons more difficult, it lets us visualize within-category variation, particularly for smaller categories like extractives. Panels (a) and (b) show that total commitments associated with extractive activities remain small in absolute terms, even if they increased in 2014 and 2018 due to large gas storage projects in Turkey and Egypt. Following the theme-based classification, climate-related commitments increased sharply after 2015, reaching nearly 30 billion USD by 2022, as shown in panel (c). This pattern could reflect the Bank’s growing integration of climate finance following the Paris Agreement. However, the text-based classification in panel (d) does not mirror this trend. Finally, panels (e), (f), and (g) display a pronounced increase in health-related funding since 2020, consistent with the surge in health financing during the COVID-19 pandemic, which lends credibility to our variable construction.

While these aggregates provide a clear overview of broad trends, they mask variation across individual projects. To capture this heterogeneity and enable formal statistical testing, we next analyze commitments at the project level, using project-specific characteristics to quantify differences in funding allocation beyond what the aggregate figures show. In doing so, we log-transform the dollar amounts to prevent large projects from skewing the analysis. Figure 4 presents the predicted commitments, based on linear regressions reported in Appendix G that use spline functions of year and include the same control variables as before.

For extractive projects, panels (a) and (b) in Figure 4 show that predicted commitment levels remained largely flat throughout the period and are consistent across official and text-based measures. While the Bank has reduced its extractive portfolio in proportional terms, the extractive projects it does fund remain similar in size. The most striking finding concerns climate finance. Panel (c) shows a sharp increase in predicted commitments classified under the official *Climate Theme* after 2015, consistent with the Bank’s public pledges to scale up climate finance, yet panel (d) does not show a comparable increase in commitments associ-

Figure 4: Predicted Project Commitment (Log USD)



These panels display the average predicted new IDA and IBRD commitment (in logged 2023 USD) per project each year, as a function of a project's share of extractive, climate, and health content. These predictions are based on linear regressions reported in Appendix G, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

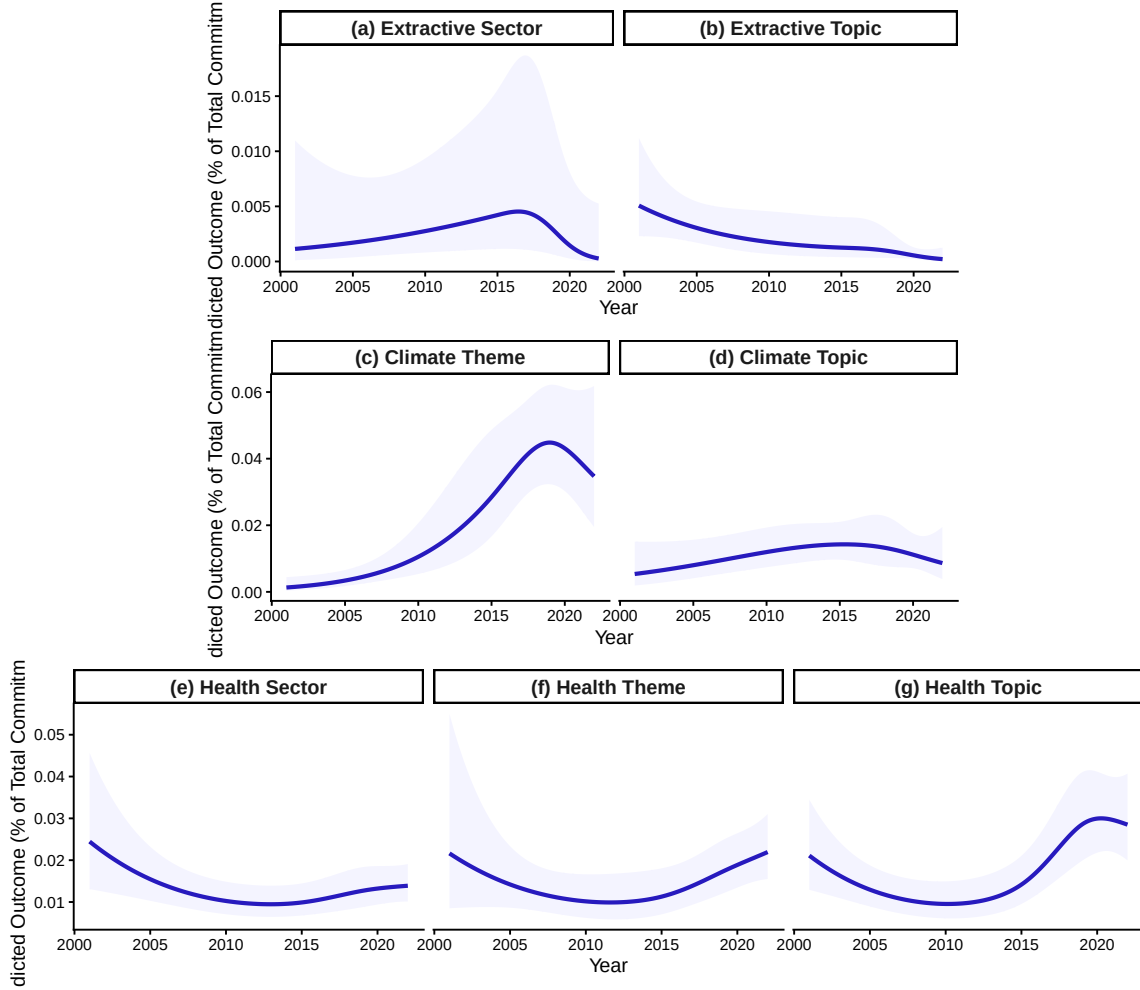
ated with the *Climate Topic*. This divergence mirrors the aggregate pattern in Figure 3 and aligns with our expectation that reported climate finance reflects reclassification rather than reallocation. Put simply, the Bank is using more climate labels, not necessarily increasing climate funding.

While Figure 4 asks whether climate projects are larger, Figure 5 asks whether they matter more within the Bank's overall portfolio. To capture this, we weight each project's commitment by total new annual IDA and IBRD commitments, accounting for changes in

the Bank’s overall lending volume.³¹ For instance, for each project i and year t , we calculate

$$\text{Climate Theme Funding Share}_i = \frac{\text{Project Commitment}_i \times \text{Climate Theme Content Share}_i}{\text{Total Commitment}_t}$$

Figure 5: Predicted Project Commitment (% of Total Commitments)



These panels display the predicted portfolio share of each project (e.g., its climate-relevant commitment as a percentage of total annual IDA and IBRD lending) by year and content category. These predictions are based on fractional logistic regressions reported in Appendix G, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

We do the same for the remaining sectors, themes, and topics. This allows us to under-

³¹The IMF has a formal quota system that determines how much member countries can borrow, so IMF studies tend to examine the total amount committed to each loan divided by the corresponding country’s borrowing quota (Copelovitch, 2010; Nelson, 2014; Chwieroth, 2013). This strategy is not feasible for the World Bank, which has no formal quotas.

stand not how much money went to climate projects, but how much weight each climate-related project carried within the Bank’s annual lending portfolio. A project that receives 100 million USD in a year when the Bank lends 10 billion USD total represents one percent of that year’s portfolio. We further adjust for each project’s content share: a project where 20 percent of activities are climate-related contributes 0.2 percent of its portfolio weight to the climate category. This double adjustment lets us distinguish genuine shifts in the Bank’s priorities from mechanical changes driven by overall lending volume.

We then estimate fractional logistic regressions; in Figure 5, we convert these shares to percentages for ease of interpretation. Each row has its own y-axis scale, enabling us to visualize variation within categories. Across all categories, the average project accounts for less than one percent of total new IDA and IBRD commitments, consistent with the large number of projects the Bank funds each year.

In Figure 5, panels (a) and (b) reveal a divergence for extractive projects: while the official *Extractive Sector* portfolio share peaked around 2014–2016 before declining sharply, the *Extractive Topic* shows a steady decline throughout the period. According to official classifications, extractive projects claimed a growing share of the Bank’s overall lending portfolio, but their text-based extractive content was already declining.

Panel (c) shows that the portfolio share of each project’s funding devoted to the climate theme increased steadily after 2015, consistent with the 2016 Climate Change Action Plan. However, panel (d) shows no comparable increase in the topic-based measure, which remained relatively flat throughout the period. This rules out the possibility that the absolute commitment increase observed in Figure 4 reflects growth in the Bank’s lending volume: even after normalizing the data, the official climate portfolio share grew substantially, while the text-based measure did not. Again, the findings indicate that the increase in climate portfolio shares reflects reclassification rather than reallocation. Finally, the portfolio share models show health increasing consistently across all three measures after 2015, which validates the approach.

5 Conclusion

International organizations often face multiple — and sometimes competing — external pressures, and the World Bank is no exception. On the one hand, civil society and climate-vulnerable states demand a decisive shift toward climate mitigation and adaptation. On the other hand, principals like the US and developing countries that rely on natural resource revenue, want the Bank to support traditional development priorities, including energy generation and natural resource extraction. Our analysis shows how the Bank navigates these tensions not only through external signaling or rhetorical commitments, but also through internal procedural reforms. By adjusting how it labels and classifies projects, the Bank can demonstrate responsiveness to climate mandates without fully abandoning activities that remain politically important to key principals. We found important differences between the official World Bank classifications and a classification based on keywords in project descriptions.

Our point is not to accuse the Bank of circumventing its commitments through so-called “creative accounting,” but to highlight how IOs can adjust internal procedures to signal their commitment to, and progress toward, specific goals. Like [Kaya and Leblebicioglu \(2025\)](#), we observe a combination of “mainstreaming” and “greenwashing”: the Bank is indeed integrating climate objectives into its projects, but it is also exaggerating how much it does so. Although our findings are restricted to multilateral climate funding, evidence suggests similar dynamics in bilateral climate funding ([Michaelowa and Michaelowa, 2011](#)), indicating that states, too, face incentives to interpret and report climate-related activities in ways that satisfy multiple audiences.

Multilateral funding represents a series of trade-offs. In a world of limited budgets, choosing one sector or country necessarily means choosing against another. Explicitly testing these choices is difficult, as IO officials may be reluctant to discuss extractive finance openly, especially when civil society and country principals pressure them not to provide such finance in the first place. In public narratives, the World Bank has an incentive to emphasize its

unconditional commitment to climate and renewable energy funding. As such, our findings are somewhat nuanced — the World Bank appears to have taken concrete steps to reduce the emphasis on extractive projects and increase resources devoted to climate adaptation, but this conclusion depends on how climate co-benefits are measured. In some cases, projects with only a tangential connection to addressing climate change are labeled as featuring climate co-benefits. This pattern supports the public relations narrative the Bank wants its constituencies to see.

Future research will benefit from case studies of specific projects to better understand IOs' climate norms and instances of norm deviation. This approach will allow for a more nuanced understanding of the World Bank's climate policies and their implications for global energy transitions. Finally, future research can distinguish between upstream and downstream finance or turn to IFC projects in the private sector, which have been gradually disclosed in recent years. IOs are prone to policy inertia and status quo bias, so even gradual change can represent significant progress.

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Appendix for Climate Commitments or Creative Accounting: How International Organizations Navigate Conflicting Demands

September 2026

Contents

A Countries Included in the Analysis	2
B Topic Model Description	2
C Keywords	3
D Additional Topics: Prevalence	3
E Summary Statistics	6
F Validating the Classification	7
F.1 T-Tests	7
F.2 Discrepancy Regressions	7
G Main Models	11
G.1 Project Content	11
G.2 Project Commitment	12
H Alternative Specifications	14
H.1 Linear Models	14
H.1.1 Project Content	14
H.1.2 Project Commitment	16
H.2 Year Fixed Effects	18
H.2.1 Project Content	18
H.2.2 Project Commitment	20
H.3 <i>After 2019</i> Dummy	24
H.3.1 Project Content	24
H.3.2 Project Commitment	25
H.4 Excluding 2020–2022	27
H.4.1 Project Content	27
H.4.2 Project Commitment	29
H.5 Excluding DPF and P4R	33
H.5.1 Project Content	33
H.5.2 Project Commitment	35
I Alternative Corpora	39
I.1 Project Information Documents (PID)	39
I.2 Project Appraisal Documents (PAD)	42
I.3 Discrepancy Plots	45

A Countries Included in the Analysis

Afghanistan, Albania, Algeria, Angola, Antigua & Barbuda, Argentina, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Bahamas, Bangladesh, Barbados, Belarus, Belize, Benin, Bhutan, Bolivia, Bosnia & Herzegovina, Botswana, Brazil, Bulgaria, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cambodia, Cameroon, Cape Verde, Central African Republic, Chad, Chile, China, Colombia, Comoros, Costa Rica, Côte d’Ivoire, Croatia, Czechia, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Djibouti, Dominica, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, Egypt, El Salvador, Equatorial Guinea, Eritrea, Eswatini, Ethiopia, Federated States of Micronesia, Fiji, Gabon, Gambia, Georgia, Ghana, Grenada, Guatemala, Guinea, Guinea-Bissau, Guyana, Haiti, Honduras, Hungary, India, Indonesia, Iran, Iraq, Jamaica, Jordan, Kazakhstan, Kenya, Kiribati, Kyrgyzstan, Laos, Latvia, Lebanon, Lesotho, Liberia, Libya, Lithuania, Madagascar, Malawi, Maldives, Mali, Marshall Islands, Mauritania, Mauritius, Mexico, Moldova, Mongolia, Montenegro, Morocco, Mozambique, Myanmar, Namibia, Nepal, Nicaragua, Niger, Nigeria, North Macedonia, Pakistan, Palau, Panama, Papua New Guinea, Paraguay, Peru, Philippines, Poland, Republic of the Congo, Romania, Russia, Rwanda, Samoa, São Tomé & Príncipe, Senegal, Serbia, Seychelles, Sierra Leone, Slovakia, Slovenia, Solomon Islands, Somalia, South Africa, South Korea, South Sudan, Sri Lanka, St. Kitts & Nevis, St. Lucia, St. Vincent & Grenadines, Sudan, Suriname, Syria, Tajikistan, Tanzania, Thailand, Timor-Leste, Togo, Tonga, Trinidad & Tobago, Tunisia, Turkey, Turkmenistan, Tuvalu, Uganda, Ukraine, Uruguay, Uzbekistan, Vanuatu, Venezuela, Vietnam, Yemen, Zambia, Zimbabwe.

B Topic Model Description

To classify World Bank project content, we use the keyword-assisted topic model (keyATM) developed by Eshima, Imai, and Sasaki (2024). Like other topic models, keyATM assumes that each document d (out of D documents) contains N_d words, drawn from V unique words, which in turn belong to K topics. We can observe the words, but not the topics: they are latent, and the model aims to identify the distribution of latent topics underlying each document.

Unlike other topic models, keyATM lets us distinguish between keyword topics, $\tilde{K}$, and no-keyword topics, $K - \tilde{K}$. For each keyword topic k , we provide L_k keywords; the remaining $K - \tilde{K}$ no-keyword topics are “residual” topics that the model identifies on its own. For each word i in document d , each topic $z_{di} \in \{1, 2, \dots, K\}$ follows a categorical distribution

$$z_{di} \sim \text{Categorical}(\theta_d), \quad (1)$$

where θ_d is a K -dimensional vector, following a Dirichlet distribution with parameter α (discussed below), $\sum_{k=1}^K \theta_{dk} = 1$. The value of θ_d is the main outcome of interest: it is a document-topic distribution that represents the relative proportion of each topic for document d . If the sampled topic z_{di} is a no-keyword topic, each word w_{di} is distributed as follows:

$$w_{di}|z_{di} = k \sim \text{Categorical}(\phi_k) \text{ for } k \in \{\tilde{K} + 1, \tilde{K} + 2, \dots, K\}, \quad (2)$$

where ϕ_k is a V -dimensional vector representing the relative frequency of each word within topic z_{di} (Eshima, Imai and Sasaki 2024, 4). If, however, the sampled topic z_{di} is a keyword topic, the distribution of each word w_{di} follows two steps. First, we draw the random variable

$$s_{di}|z_{di} = k \sim \text{Bernoulli}(\pi_k) \text{ for } k \in \{1, 2, \dots, \tilde{K}\}, \quad (3)$$

where π_k is the success probability for word w_{di} (that is, the probability that this word will be sampled). Second, if s_{di} equals 0, the word w_{di} is distributed as follows:

$$w_{di}|s_{di}, z_{di} = k \sim \text{Categorical}(\phi_k) \text{ for } k \in \{1, 2, \dots, \tilde{K}\}. \quad (4)$$

If s_{di} equals 1, w_{di} is distributed as follows:

$$w_{di}|s_{di}, z_{di} = k \sim \text{Categorical}(\tilde{\phi}_k) \text{ for } k \in \{1, 2, \dots, \tilde{K}\}. \quad (5)$$

where $\tilde{\phi}_{z_n}$ is a V -dimensional vector of probabilities for the keyword list V_k . This means that L_k elements (the keywords) have positive values, and the remaining elements in V are 0. A single word w_{di} can belong to multiple topics, since topics are not strictly independent from one another.

The R package **keyATM**, developed by Eshima, Imai and Sasaki (2024), uses the following default values:

$$\pi_k \sim \text{Beta}(1, 1) \text{ for } z_n = \{1, 2, \dots, \tilde{K}\} \quad (6)$$

$$\phi_k \sim \text{Dirichlet}(0.01) \text{ for } z_n = \{1, 2, \dots, \tilde{K}\} \quad (7)$$

$$\tilde{\phi}_k \sim \text{Dirichlet}(0.1) \text{ for } z_n = \{1, 2, \dots, \tilde{K}\} \quad (8)$$

$$\theta_d \sim \text{Dirichlet}(\alpha) \text{ for } d = \{1, 2, \dots, D\} \quad (9)$$

$$\alpha_k \sim \begin{cases} \text{Gamma}(1, 1) & \text{for } k = \{1, 2, \dots, \tilde{K}\} \\ \text{Gamma}(1, 2) & \text{for } k = \{\tilde{K} + 1, \tilde{K} + 2, \dots, K\} \end{cases} \quad (10)$$

As long as the sample size is large, the choice of hyperparameters is not important — except for π_{z_n} , which controls the weight of keywords and has a non-informative prior, $\text{Beta}(1, 1)$.

Compared to the base keyATM described above, the extension we use — the dynamic keyATM — replaces Equation 10 with the following:

$$\alpha_{rk} \sim \text{Gamma}(1, 1) \text{ for } r = \{1, 2, \dots, \tilde{R}\} \text{ and } k = \{1, 2, \dots, \tilde{K}\}, \quad (11)$$

where R is the total number of latent discrete states to which each time period belongs. This allows α to vary across states, and thus the topic proportion to vary over time.

C Keywords

We use the following keywords to generate the $\tilde{K} = 3$ topics of interest:

Extractive Topic: coal, diesel, eiti, extractive, extractives, fossil, fuel, gas, hydrocarbon, mine, mineral, minerals, mining, oil, petroleum

Climate Topic: adaptation, atmosphere, carbon, climate, ghg, greenhouse, hcfc, methane, redd, sequestration, unfccc

Health Topic: care, covid-19, flu, health, healthcare, healthy, hiv, hiv aids, hospital, hospitals, influenza, malaria, maternal, polio, vaccination, vaccine

D Additional Topics: Prevalence

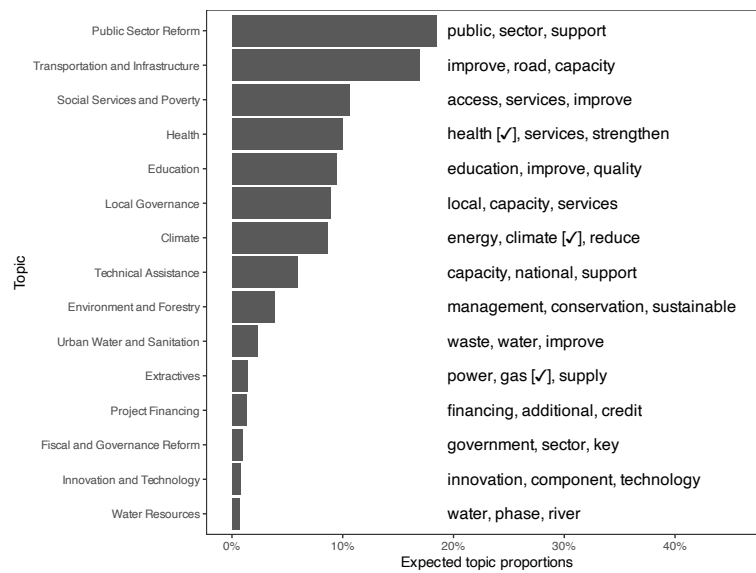
Table D.1: Most Common Words Per Non-Keyword Topic (PDO Model)

Transportation	Local Governance	Social Services	Education	Project Admin.	Technical Assistance
improve	local	access	education	financing	capacity
road	capacity	services	improve	additional	national
capacity	services	improve	quality	credit	support
increase	improve	social	access	new	system
access	rural	poor	increase	board	implementation
transport	management	water	water	original	data
selected	public	support	primary	approved	component
management	communities	rural	learning	economic	technical
services	support	areas	services	loan	information
infrastructure	community	management	management	first	policy

2					
water	public	management	waste	innovation	government
phase	sector	conservation	water	component	sector
river	support	sustainable	improve	technology	key
percentage	management	biodiversity	management	mobile	international
basin	financial	areas	solid	applications	tax
percent	government	forest	municipal	knowledge	compliance
sustainable	improve	environmental	wastewater	cities	credit
improving	growth	global	services	expected	provide
use	policy	land	infrastructure	business	reduce
areas	reforms	natural	environmental	network	needs

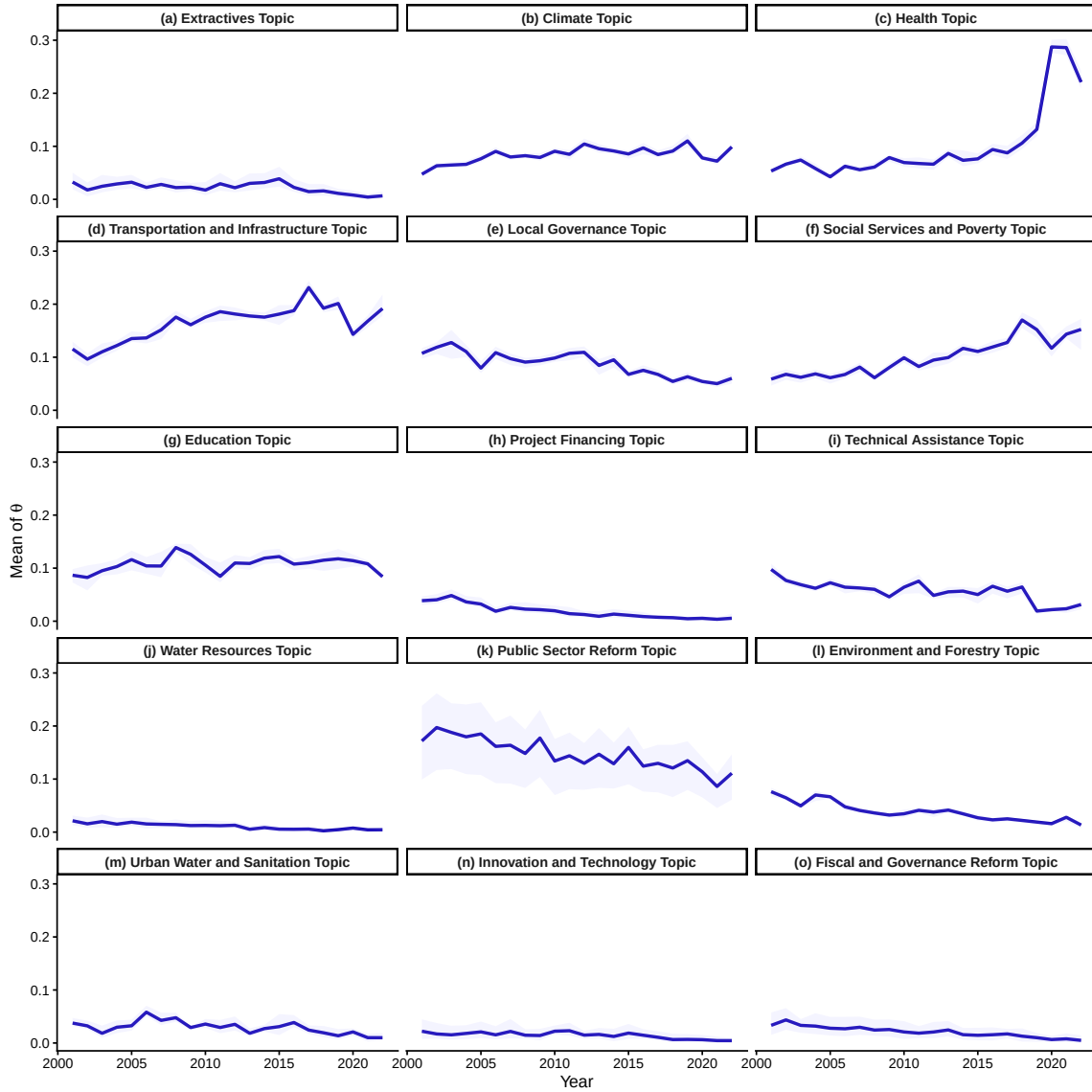
Table D.1 presents the ten most frequent words for all non-keyword topics. Although these topics are all “residual” (meaning the model identified them independently, without any researcher input), we assigned post-hoc labels for ease of interpretation. Figure D.1 shows the expected proportion of the corpus belonging to each topic. In Figure D.2, each panel presents θ , the relative prevalence of each topic. The values of θ are averaged for all projects approved by the Executive Board every year between 2001 and 2022.

Figure D.1: Expected Proportion of the Corpus, by Topic



This plot displays the expected proportion of the corpus for each topic, with checkmarks representing the keywords used to generate the main topics of interest.

Figure D.2: Topic Prevalence Over Time, 2001–2022



This plot displays the prevalence of each topic over time. The x-axis represents the year of project approval by the World Bank Executive Board. The y-axis represents θ , the proportion of words in each project description associated with a topic, averaged across all projects approved each year, with 90 percent confidence intervals.

E Summary Statistics

Table E.1: Summary Statistics

Variable	N	Mean	Std. Dev.	Min	Pctl. 25	Pctl. 75	Max
Extractive Sector, Share	9382	0.0147	0.103	0	0	0	1
Extractive Topic, Share	9382	0.0136	0.0724	0.00000519	0.000164	0.000437	1
Climate Theme, Share	9382	0.142	0.283	0	0	0.12	1
Climate Topic, Share	9382	0.0858	0.231	0.00000643	0.000188	0.000581	1
Health Sector, Share	9382	0.0736	0.214	0	0	0	1
Health Theme, Share	9382	0.0799	0.238	0	0	0	1
Health Topic, Share	9382	0.1	0.264	0.00000483	0.000175	0.000581	1
Extractive Sector, Log USD	9382	0.476	2.7	0	0	0	21.4
Extractive Topic, Log USD	9382	9.43	2.53	0	8.05	10.8	20.9
Climate Theme, Log USD	9382	5.23	7.8	0	0	15	21.6
Climate Topic, Log USD	9382	10.4	3.42	0	8.38	11.6	23.3
Health Sector, Log USD	9382	2.7	6.18	0	0	0	21.5
Health Theme, Log USD	9382	2.43	5.97	0	0	0	21.9
Health Topic, Log USD	9382	10.4	3.63	0	8.23	11.6	21.7
Extractive Sector, Share Commit.	9382	0.0000192	0.000414	0	0	0	0.0301
Extractive Topic, Share Commit.	9382	0.0000294	0.000361	0	0.0000000489	0.000000799	0.0175
Climate Theme, Share Commit.	9382	0.000288	0.00122	0	0	0.000044	0.0353
Climate Topic, Share Commit.	9382	0.000183	0.00192	0	0.0000000701	0.00000173	0.148
Health Sector, Share Commit.	9382	0.000156	0.00103	0	0	0	0.0536
Health Theme, Share Commit.	9382	0.000165	0.00124	0	0	0	0.0794
Health Topic, Share Commit.	9382	0.000197	0.00117	0	0.0000000593	0.00000169	0.0502
Governance	9211	-0.546	0.526	-2.41	-0.866	-0.217	1.33
Election Year	9210						
... 0	6858	74.5%					
... 1	2352	25.5%					
EITI Member	9382						
... 0	7298	77.8%					
... 1	2084	22.2%					
Field Discovery	9382						
... 0	8070	86%					
... 1	1312	14%					
SIDS	9382						
... 0	8572	91.4%					
... 1	810	8.6%					
Disaster	9382						
... 0	1951	20.8%					
... 1	7431	79.2%					
Population	9382	16.8	2.01	9.23	15.6	18.2	21.1
GDP per Capita	9310	7.59	0.955	5.49	6.85	8.28	10.4
Resource Rents	9304	6.94	8.44	0	1.28	9.57	79.4
Access to Electricity	9317	69.7	32.4	1.3	42.4	98.9	100
DAC Aid	9382	0.718	1.11	-0.528	0.154	0.994	27.3
Chinese Finance	9382	1.2	4.13	0	0	0.606	65.7
IMF Program	9382						
... 0	5600	59.7%					
... 1	3782	40.3%					
UNSC Member	9382						
... 0	8731	93.1%					
... 1	651	6.9%					
US Ideal Point Dist.	9211	0.169	0.0897	0	0.111	0.195	0.846
China Ideal Point Dist.	9211	0.795	0.12	0.2	0.753	0.871	1
US Pres. is Republican	9382						
... 0	4571	48.7%					
... 1	4811	51.3%					
US Government Is Divided	9382						
... 0	3810	40.6%					
... 1	5572	59.4%					
TTL Experience	9180	2.27	2.69	0	0	3	20

F Validating the Classification

F.1 T-Tests

Table F.1: Paired T-Tests: Official Classifications vs. PDO Topic Proportions

Comparison	N	Mean (Official)	Mean (Topic)	Mean Diff.	t	p (adjusted)
<i>Extractive</i>						
Sector vs. Topic	9382	1.47%	1.36%	0.11 pp	1.07	0.285
<i>Climate</i>						
Theme vs. Topic	9382	14.20%	8.58%	5.57 pp	20.10	<0.001***
<i>Health</i>						
Sector vs. Theme	9382	7.36%	7.99%	-0.62 pp	-4.42	<0.001***
Sector vs. Topic	9382	7.36%	10.00%	-2.64 pp	-13.40	<0.001***
Theme vs. Topic	9382	7.99%	10.00%	-2.02 pp	-10.30	<0.001***

In Table F.1, paired t-tests compare the official World Bank classification (sector or theme percentage) to the PDO topic proportion for each project. p -values are Bonferroni-corrected within each issue area (one comparison for extractive, one for climate, and three for health). Mean differences are expressed in percentage points (pp). For health, “Official” refers to the sector in rows 3–4 and the theme in row 5. With $N = 9,382$, even small differences are statistically significant. Although all health comparisons are statistically significant, the substantive differences are small relative to the climate discrepancy.

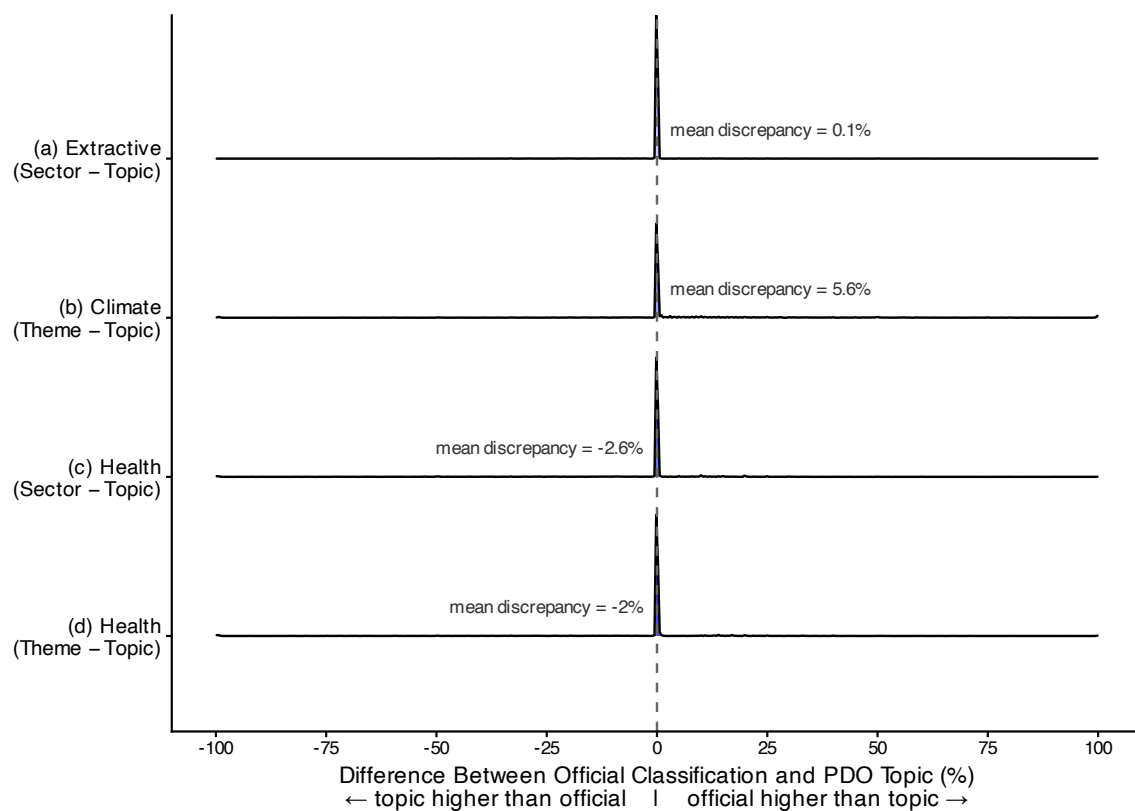
F.2 Discrepancy Regressions

Figure F.1 shows the distribution of discrepancies between the World Bank’s official classifications and the text-based topic proportions. For each project, we compute the discrepancy as the difference between the official classification and the PDO topic proportion, expressed in percentage points. Positive values indicate projects where the official classification exceeds the topic proportion. Tables F.2 and F.3 test whether these discrepancies widened following the Paris Agreement (2015) and the World Bank’s pledge to cease direct financing of upstream oil and gas projects (2019). The low R-squared values are expected, given that classification decisions are driven largely by project-specific factors not captured by country-level covariates. Still, the tables deliver interesting results.

In Table F.2, the post-2015 indicator is large and significant for climate ($p < 0.001$), confirming that the gap between the official *Climate Theme* and the *Climate Topic* widened substantially after the Paris Agreement, beyond what is explained by recipient and donor characteristics. The extractive discrepancy increases slightly, suggesting the official classification marginally overstated extractive content relative to the topic model in the post-2015 period. The health discrepancies also widen, but in the negative direction, meaning the topic model finds more health content than officially labeled.

Table F.3 tells a similar story using the 2019 threshold. The climate discrepancy remains large and significant ($p < 0.001$), confirming that the divergence between official climate labeling and text-based content persisted and intensified after 2019. The extractive discrepancy is not significant post-2019, consistent with the Bank genuinely reducing extractive lending following its formal pledge.

Figure F.1: Discrepancy Plots



These plots show the distribution of discrepancies between the World Bank's official project classifications and the text-based topic proportions derived from PDOs. Positive values indicate projects where the official classification exceeds the topic proportion, whereas negative values indicate projects where the topic model identifies more content than the official classification. The dashed vertical line marks zero (perfect agreement).

Table F.2: Discrepancy Between Official Classifications and PDO Topics: Post-2015

	(a) Extractive Sector – Topic (pp)	(b) Climate Theme – Topic (pp)	(c) Health Sector – Topic (pp)	(d) Health Theme – Topic (pp)
After 2015	0.584* (0.316)	18.782*** (2.493)	-8.064*** (1.753)	-3.333*** (0.833)
Governance	-0.023 (0.267)	0.114 (0.863)	1.772** (0.655)	0.988 (0.610)
Election Year	0.254 (0.320)	0.325 (0.604)	-0.022 (0.477)	-0.331 (0.542)
EITI Member	1.391*** (0.476)	1.129 (0.891)	0.320 (0.692)	0.966* (0.525)
Field Discovery	0.099 (0.400)	1.044 (1.250)	0.134 (0.562)	-0.370 (0.966)
SIDS	0.224 (0.492)	0.881 (1.275)	-0.302 (0.753)	0.025 (0.561)
Disaster	0.187 (0.292)	2.215** (0.955)	-0.739 (0.655)	-0.526 (0.590)
Population	-0.087 (0.083)	0.174 (0.376)	0.531** (0.234)	0.438** (0.201)
GDP per Capita	-0.061 (0.187)	0.648 (0.608)	-0.068 (0.452)	0.549 (0.581)
Resource Rents	0.032 (0.023)	-0.041 (0.035)	0.073 (0.046)	0.058 (0.038)
Access to Electricity	-0.002 (0.008)	0.005 (0.020)	0.007 (0.016)	0.005 (0.017)
DAC Aid	-0.196 (0.164)	0.165 (0.237)	0.117 (0.258)	0.037 (0.258)
Chinese Finance	-0.015 (0.022)	-0.077 (0.141)	-0.001 (0.066)	0.008 (0.062)
IMF Program	0.065 (0.262)	-0.699 (0.653)	-0.584 (0.611)	-0.838 (0.586)
UNSC Member	0.362 (0.313)	0.635 (1.092)	-0.198 (0.775)	0.576 (0.766)
US Ideal Point Dist.	-1.411 (3.549)	7.711 (7.594)	3.936 (5.349)	-0.141 (4.502)
China Ideal Point Dist.	0.763 (2.841)	7.846 (4.815)	-5.059 (3.768)	-6.980* (3.603)
US Pres. is Republican	-0.743*** (0.258)	-0.199 (1.797)	-0.937 (1.393)	0.563 (0.596)
US Government Is Divided	0.278 (0.285)	-1.863 (1.473)	-1.912 (1.166)	-1.426*** (0.480)
TTL Experience	0.051 (0.059)	0.421*** (0.144)	-0.208** (0.085)	-0.172* (0.085)
Intercept	1.042 (2.867)	-18.196*** (5.386)	-2.178 (4.824)	-5.514 (4.531)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915
R2	0.011	0.119	0.049	0.014
R2 Adj.	0.008	0.117	0.047	0.011

This table presents the results of four linear regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Table F.3: Discrepancy Between Official Classifications and PDO Topics: Post-2019

	(a) Extractive Sector – Topic (pp)	(b) Climate Theme – Topic (pp)	(c) Health Sector – Topic (pp)	(d) Health Theme – Topic (pp)
After 2019	−0.108 (0.239)	17.619*** (2.234)	−10.957*** (1.526)	−3.879*** (0.658)
Governance	−0.110 (0.282)	−1.424 (1.048)	2.232*** (0.755)	1.216* (0.655)
Election Year	0.253 (0.321)	−0.052 (0.602)	0.192 (0.468)	−0.252 (0.542)
EITI Member	1.647*** (0.446)	4.242** (1.703)	−0.194 (0.618)	0.596 (0.469)
Field Discovery	0.032 (0.397)	0.531 (1.231)	0.090 (0.714)	−0.338 (1.016)
SIDS	0.353 (0.499)	2.260 (1.315)	−0.447 (0.747)	−0.121 (0.578)
Disaster	0.174 (0.296)	1.472* (0.809)	−0.369 (0.629)	−0.382 (0.570)
Population	−0.081 (0.084)	0.351 (0.403)	0.461* (0.224)	0.408* (0.199)
GDP per Capita	−0.077 (0.187)	0.497 (0.673)	−0.062 (0.473)	0.562 (0.582)
Resource Rents	0.026 (0.024)	−0.133** (0.056)	0.101* (0.052)	0.072* (0.037)
Access to Electricity	0.000 (0.008)	0.010 (0.019)	0.010 (0.016)	0.006 (0.016)
DAC Aid	−0.185 (0.169)	0.301 (0.354)	0.090 (0.260)	0.020 (0.259)
Chinese Finance	−0.012 (0.021)	0.124 (0.195)	−0.101 (0.081)	−0.030 (0.076)
IMF Program	−0.009 (0.264)	−1.943* (1.036)	−0.231 (0.640)	−0.657 (0.588)
UNSC Member	0.317 (0.319)	−0.707 (1.319)	0.365 (0.665)	0.812 (0.765)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−1.103 (3.608)	9.227 (10.673)	4.633 (5.147)	−0.111 (4.629)
China Ideal Point Dist.	0.344 (2.922)	−4.332 (9.379)	−0.043 (3.413)	−4.866 (3.641)
US Pres. is Republican	−0.629** (0.260)	−0.121 (2.761)	−0.393 (0.945)	0.677 (0.493)
US Government Is Divided	0.277 (0.281)	−3.256 (2.639)	−1.095 (0.906)	−1.130** (0.511)
TTL Experience	0.058 (0.060)	0.482*** (0.159)	−0.209** (0.081)	−0.178** (0.081)
Intercept	1.363 (2.964)	−6.659 (11.794)	−7.328 (4.774)	−7.605* (4.342)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915
R2	0.010	0.085	0.057	0.013
R2 Adj.	0.008	0.083	0.055	0.011

This table presents the results of four linear regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

G Main Models

G.1 Project Content

Table G.1 presents the models corresponding to Figure 3 of the main text.

Table G.1: Predictors of Project Content, 2001–2022

	(a) Extractive Sector Share	(b) Extractive Topic Share	(c) Climate Theme Share	(d) Climate Topic Share	(e) Health Sector Share	(f) Health Theme Share	(g) Health Topic Share
Year (Spline Basis 1)	0.436 (0.394)	−1.031*** (0.333)	2.532*** (0.144)	0.432*** (0.167)	−0.086 (0.134)	0.592*** (0.223)	0.997*** (0.174)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	0.397 (1.331)	−2.696*** (0.650)	3.952*** (0.658)	1.281*** (0.276)	0.360 (0.247)	1.737*** (0.447)	1.906*** (0.282)
Year (Spline Basis 3)	−1.987*** (0.407)	−3.377*** (0.440)	2.140*** (0.120)	−0.073 (0.122)	1.222*** (0.130)	1.962*** (0.178)	2.197*** (0.152)
Governance	−0.205 (0.200)	−0.235 (0.227)	0.320*** (0.114)	0.428*** (0.149)	−0.248** (0.101)	−0.324*** (0.099)	−0.354*** (0.110)
Election Year	0.393** (0.169)	0.198 (0.164)	0.036 (0.043)	0.011 (0.083)	−0.001 (0.078)	−0.048 (0.071)	−0.007 (0.059)
EITI Member	1.194*** (0.234)	0.854*** (0.182)	−0.132 (0.090)	−0.234** (0.119)	−0.020 (0.068)	−0.033 (0.068)	−0.152* (0.091)
Field Discovery	0.021 (0.364)	−0.117 (0.235)	0.183 (0.116)	0.074 (0.138)	−0.161 (0.176)	−0.245 (0.174)	−0.163 (0.188)
SIDS	0.375 (0.356)	0.347 (0.389)	0.546*** (0.145)	0.715*** (0.226)	−0.350** (0.166)	−0.321** (0.129)	−0.271** (0.109)
Disaster	0.113 (0.214)	−0.033 (0.153)	0.038 (0.097)	−0.202* (0.120)	0.096 (0.100)	0.089 (0.113)	0.134 (0.091)
Population	−0.066 (0.085)	0.034 (0.069)	0.139*** (0.034)	0.149*** (0.051)	−0.100** (0.045)	−0.101** (0.040)	−0.133*** (0.033)
GDP per Capita	0.023 (0.141)	0.039 (0.140)	0.048 (0.060)	−0.009 (0.100)	0.029 (0.077)	0.110 (0.089)	0.028 (0.080)
Resource Rents	0.018 (0.013)	0.000 (0.011)	−0.007 (0.005)	−0.004 (0.011)	−0.001 (0.005)	−0.003 (0.006)	−0.009** (0.004)
Access to Electricity	0.001 (0.005)	0.004 (0.004)	0.001 (0.002)	0.002 (0.002)	−0.004* (0.002)	−0.005* (0.002)	−0.005** (0.002)
DAC Aid	0.031 (0.050)	0.072** (0.030)	−0.070 (0.060)	−0.066 (0.070)	0.004 (0.023)	−0.012 (0.039)	−0.015 (0.049)
Chinese Finance	−0.017 (0.023)	−0.008 (0.015)	−0.019* (0.010)	−0.031*** (0.011)	0.014 (0.011)	0.019*** (0.007)	0.017** (0.009)
IMF Program	0.291 (0.180)	0.216 (0.132)	−0.181*** (0.068)	−0.223** (0.107)	−0.049 (0.063)	−0.062 (0.067)	0.061 (0.088)
UNSC Member	0.048 (0.236)	−0.325 (0.305)	0.015 (0.104)	−0.066 (0.142)	0.087 (0.116)	0.185** (0.089)	0.070 (0.131)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−1.460 (2.246)	−0.736 (1.756)	1.341* (0.742)	1.699** (0.837)	−0.464 (0.540)	−0.825 (0.734)	−0.779 (0.694)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−1.309 (1.301)	−1.848 (1.322)	0.910 (0.660)	0.949 (0.610)	0.222 (0.598)	−0.172 (0.615)	0.682 (0.566)
US Pres. is Republican	−0.164 (0.211)	−0.017 (0.191)	0.072 (0.124)	0.031 (0.076)	0.156* (0.081)	0.472*** (0.099)	0.289*** (0.110)
US Government Is Divided	0.095 (0.180)	0.043 (0.160)	−0.356*** (0.057)	−0.192*** (0.044)	0.210*** (0.073)	0.227** (0.111)	0.371*** (0.090)
TTL Experience	0.076*** (0.026)	0.072*** (0.025)	0.030** (0.013)	0.005 (0.016)	−0.012 (0.021)	−0.013 (0.024)	0.004 (0.020)
Intercept	−3.903* (2.228)	−4.020** (1.750)	−7.031*** (1.134)	−5.938*** (1.011)	−1.275 (1.006)	−2.148** (0.907)	−1.608* (0.948)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915
AIC	1106.8	690.1	5774.5	4669.9	4089.5	4212.8	5000.7
BIC	1270.0	853.3	5937.7	4833.1	4252.7	4376.0	5163.9

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for natural cubic splines are not directly interpretable on their own; they are used collectively to generate the predicted values shown in the figures. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

G.2 Project Commitment

Tables G.2 and G.3 present the models corresponding to Figures 5 and 6 of the main text, respectively.

Table G.2: Predictors of Project Commitment (Log USD), 2001–2022

	(a) Extractive Sector Log USD	(b) Extractive Topic Log USD	(c) Climate Theme Log USD	(d) Climate Topic Log USD	(e) Health Sector Log USD	(f) Health Theme Log USD	(g) Health Topic Log USD
Year (Spline Basis 1)	0.132 (0.086)	0.953*** (0.174)	10.263*** (0.671)	1.224*** (0.201)	−0.441 (0.362)	−0.372 (0.482)	1.683*** (0.307)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	0.408** (0.186)	−0.324 (0.509)	11.694*** (1.422)	1.607*** (0.221)	1.157 (0.752)	1.739* (0.842)	2.138*** (0.593)
Year (Spline Basis 3)	−0.462*** (0.085)	−0.018 (0.261)	14.138*** (0.332)	0.812*** (0.099)	2.733*** (0.446)	3.223*** (0.567)	2.947*** (0.446)
Governance	−0.032 (0.086)	0.068 (0.127)	1.148*** (0.256)	0.635*** (0.169)	−0.195 (0.215)	−0.311* (0.178)	−0.239* (0.139)
Election Year	0.116* (0.063)	0.051 (0.079)	0.181 (0.175)	−0.006 (0.105)	−0.049 (0.125)	−0.043 (0.120)	0.104 (0.112)
EITI Member	0.458*** (0.115)	−0.050 (0.109)	−0.482 (0.289)	−0.436* (0.157)	−0.240 (0.161)	−0.114 (0.161)	−0.407*** (0.114)
Field Discovery	0.149 (0.126)	0.038 (0.161)	0.380 (0.367)	0.265 (0.225)	−0.028 (0.255)	−0.262 (0.228)	−0.009 (0.137)
SIDS	−0.113 (0.127)	−0.052 (0.161)	1.034* (0.500)	0.727** (0.321)	−0.610* (0.333)	−0.557* (0.321)	−0.390* (0.189)
Disaster	0.181 (0.110)	−0.056 (0.097)	−0.192 (0.204)	−0.212 (0.128)	0.165 (0.182)	0.141 (0.209)	0.098 (0.116)
Population	−0.072** (0.027)	0.316*** (0.035)	0.479*** (0.085)	0.453*** (0.061)	−0.174** (0.082)	−0.130* (0.064)	0.195*** (0.044)
GDP per Capita	0.003 (0.057)	0.056 (0.088)	0.120 (0.183)	−0.013 (0.126)	0.097 (0.167)	0.167 (0.145)	0.099 (0.105)
Resource Rents	0.010* (0.006)	−0.001 (0.006)	−0.001 (0.012)	−0.003 (0.007)	−0.009 (0.011)	−0.019* (0.010)	−0.012 (0.007)
Access to Electricity	−0.001 (0.002)	−0.002 (0.002)	−0.002 (0.006)	−0.001 (0.003)	−0.013** (0.005)	−0.011** (0.004)	−0.006* (0.003)
DAC Aid	−0.008 (0.037)	0.097** (0.041)	−0.049 (0.081)	−0.004 (0.039)	−0.038 (0.054)	−0.042 (0.053)	0.047 (0.038)
Chinese Finance	−0.007 (0.007)	0.007 (0.008)	−0.058 (0.046)	−0.022** (0.009)	0.040 (0.025)	0.043** (0.017)	0.028 (0.019)
IMF Program	0.180** (0.080)	0.065 (0.082)	−0.288 (0.185)	−0.212* (0.104)	0.037 (0.137)	0.087 (0.121)	0.107 (0.108)
UNSC Member	−0.062 (0.096)	−0.174 (0.112)	−0.461 (0.330)	−0.130 (0.123)	0.291 (0.204)	0.400** (0.158)	−0.073 (0.143)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−0.596 (0.713)	−0.079 (0.944)	2.154 (3.079)	1.678 (1.102)	−2.195 (1.371)	−0.973 (1.217)	−0.299 (0.853)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−0.009 (0.494)	−1.031 (0.690)	1.320 (2.217)	0.091 (0.827)	−0.750 (1.174)	−0.287 (0.847)	0.002 (0.689)
US Pres. is Republican	0.017 (0.067)	0.492*** (0.128)	0.712** (0.308)	0.386*** (0.079)	0.706*** (0.208)	0.829*** (0.276)	0.683*** (0.220)
US Government Is Divided	0.010 (0.066)	0.148 (0.089)	−1.307*** (0.299)	−0.131** (0.061)	0.354* (0.193)	0.260 (0.244)	0.458** (0.169)
TTL Experience	0.019 (0.016)	−0.045** (0.021)	0.072* (0.041)	−0.053** (0.023)	−0.074** (0.035)	−0.052 (0.038)	−0.043 (0.027)
Intercept	1.153 (0.756)	4.369*** (1.128)	−8.092** (3.452)	2.522* (1.326)	6.284*** (1.963)	3.794** (1.438)	5.409*** (1.327)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915
R2	0.016	0.085	0.363	0.074	0.026	0.033	0.088
R2 Adj.	0.014	0.082	0.361	0.071	0.024	0.031	0.086

This table presents the results of seven linear regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for natural cubic splines are not directly interpretable on their own; they are used collectively to generate the predicted values shown in the figures. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Table G.3: Predictors of Project Commitment (Share of Total Commitments), 2001–2022

	(a) Extractive Sector Share Commit.	(b) Extractive Topic Share Commit.	(c) Climate Theme Share Commit.	(d) Climate Topic Share Commit.	(e) Health Sector Share Commit.	(f) Health Theme Share Commit.	(g) Health Topic Share Commit.
Year (Spline Basis 1)	1.292*** (0.251)	-1.114 (0.699)	3.033*** (0.394)	0.643 (0.487)	-0.303 (0.217)	0.083 (0.231)	0.811*** (0.225)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	0.403 (1.884)	-3.873*** (1.308)	5.624*** (1.512)	1.560 (1.005)	-1.689*** (0.605)	-1.080 (1.108)	-0.862 (0.569)
Year (Spline Basis 3)	-2.101 (1.494)	-2.330*** (0.892)	1.722*** (0.301)	-0.188 (0.238)	0.207 (0.171)	0.731*** (0.207)	1.146*** (0.189)
Governance	-1.373* (0.777)	-0.626 (0.438)	-0.008 (0.170)	0.389 (0.462)	-0.414** (0.199)	-0.566** (0.244)	-0.714*** (0.226)
Election Year	-0.254 (0.388)	0.019 (0.379)	0.060 (0.113)	0.419 (0.255)	0.059 (0.139)	0.027 (0.130)	-0.012 (0.124)
EITI Member	-0.386 (0.430)	-0.454 (0.324)	0.056 (0.141)	-0.203 (0.239)	0.093 (0.137)	0.107 (0.168)	0.070 (0.160)
Field Discovery	-0.567 (0.775)	-0.373 (0.386)	-0.034 (0.206)	-0.487 (0.422)	-0.337 (0.258)	-0.496 (0.345)	-0.434** (0.191)
SIDS	-1.779*** (0.643)	-0.505 (0.702)	-0.286 (0.203)	-0.470 (0.527)	-0.718** (0.337)	-0.819*** (0.249)	-0.676*** (0.186)
Disaster	-0.430 (0.763)	0.018 (0.453)	-0.009 (0.180)	-0.077 (0.324)	0.046 (0.233)	0.084 (0.218)	0.057 (0.199)
Population	0.443** (0.181)	0.480*** (0.134)	0.313*** (0.041)	0.323*** (0.070)	0.358*** (0.067)	0.348*** (0.071)	0.327*** (0.072)
GDP per Capita	1.135* (0.641)	0.498 (0.508)	0.259*** (0.089)	0.315 (0.263)	0.582** (0.230)	0.666** (0.273)	0.506*** (0.160)
Resource Rents	-0.009 (0.024)	-0.001 (0.025)	-0.006 (0.011)	-0.022 (0.019)	-0.025** (0.012)	-0.029*** (0.011)	-0.035*** (0.010)
Access to Electricity	-0.018 (0.017)	-0.003 (0.013)	0.000 (0.005)	0.001 (0.008)	-0.013** (0.006)	-0.012** (0.005)	-0.009** (0.005)
DAC Aid	0.004 (0.156)	0.046 (0.075)	0.086* (0.046)	0.090 (0.069)	0.056 (0.057)	0.054 (0.049)	0.080 (0.052)
Chinese Finance	-0.077 (0.064)	-0.004 (0.024)	0.000 (0.016)	-0.030 (0.028)	0.002 (0.017)	0.000 (0.013)	-0.001 (0.017)
IMF Program	0.378 (0.264)	0.280 (0.301)	-0.017 (0.132)	-0.058 (0.296)	0.365* (0.219)	0.429* (0.235)	0.326* (0.176)
UNSC Member	-0.882 (0.736)	-1.252** (0.545)	0.193 (0.226)	0.200 (0.337)	0.326* (0.195)	0.585*** (0.183)	0.418** (0.211)
US Ideal Point Dist.	2.004 (3.513)	2.436 (2.550)	1.189 (1.241)	1.384 (1.999)	-0.967 (1.715)	-1.377 (2.440)	-2.926* (1.513)
China Ideal Point Dist.	-2.854 (2.544)	-2.815 (2.161)	0.238 (0.789)	1.672 (1.337)	-2.231** (1.005)	-2.388* (1.307)	-2.501** (1.161)
US Pres. is Republican	1.090*** (0.419)	-0.185 (0.489)	0.205 (0.168)	-0.159 (0.251)	0.103 (0.149)	0.323** (0.164)	0.231 (0.183)
US Government Is Divided	0.096 (0.464)	-0.255 (0.363)	-0.429*** (0.139)	-0.407* (0.216)	0.106 (0.170)	0.136 (0.193)	0.267*** (0.100)
TTL Experience	-0.077 (0.086)	0.017 (0.040)	-0.015 (0.021)	-0.087** (0.042)	-0.065* (0.034)	-0.062* (0.033)	0.009 (0.035)
Intercept	-25.521*** (6.919)	-19.684*** (5.379)	-18.646*** (1.387)	-18.252*** (1.973)	-16.174*** (2.367)	-17.039*** (2.116)	-15.460*** (2.050)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915
AIC	46.4	46.5	51.3	49.3	48.9	49.0	49.6
BIC	209.6	209.7	214.5	212.5	212.1	212.2	212.8

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for natural cubic splines are not directly interpretable on their own; they are used collectively to generate the predicted values shown in the figures. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

H Alternative Specifications

H.1 Linear Models

Since the sector, theme, and topic proportions are bounded between 0 and 1, our main empirical approach uses fractional logit regressions. The same applies to each project's commitment as a share of total new IDA and IBRD commitments: it is also bounded between 0 and 1. As a robustness check, we estimate linear regressions for simplicity and interpretability, rescaling the dependent variables to percentages (0 to 100) to make coefficients more readable. Table H.1 confirms the main results. Tables H.1 and H.2 and the corresponding Figures H.1 and H.2 confirm the main results. One limitation of this alternative approach is that predicted values from a linear regression may occasionally fall slightly outside the $[0, 100]$ range, as visible in panels (a) and (b) of each figure.

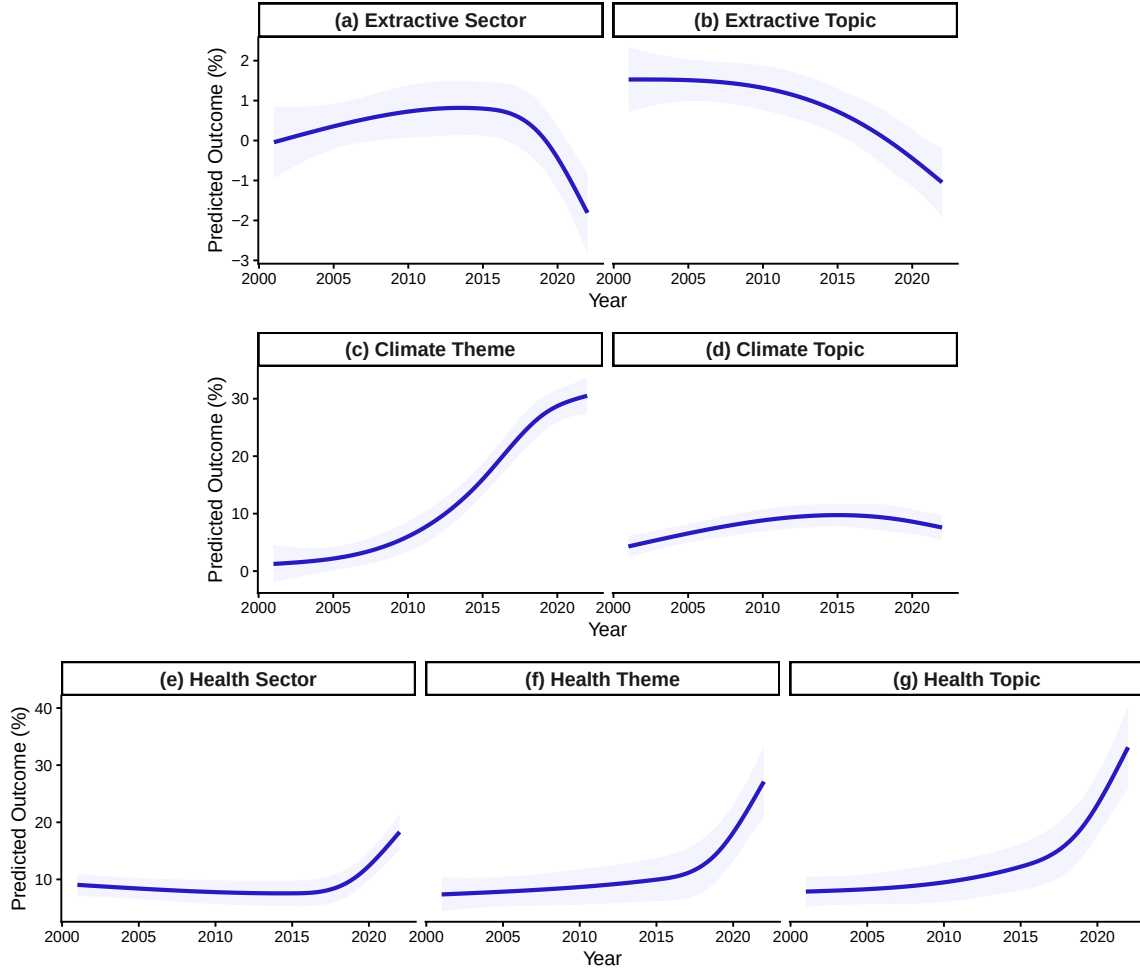
H.1.1 Project Content

Table H.1: Predictors of Project Content, 2001–2022 (Linear Models)

	(a) Extractive Sector %	(b) Extractive Topic %	(c) Climate Theme %	(d) Climate Topic %	(e) Health Sector %	(f) Health Theme %	(g) Health Topic %
Year (Spline Basis 1)	0.374 (0.447)	−1.554*** (0.338)	26.432*** (1.823)	3.451** (1.282)	−0.841 (0.963)	3.609 (2.189)	7.342*** (2.528)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	−0.086 (1.056)	−2.262** (0.872)	30.056*** (4.344)	9.236*** (2.128)	4.552** (1.761)	16.066*** (3.429)	20.773*** (3.777)
Year (Spline Basis 3)	−2.436*** (0.520)	−2.578*** (0.380)	28.204*** (1.233)	−0.485 (0.897)	10.342*** (1.339)	19.013*** (2.710)	24.702*** (3.172)
Governance	−0.242 (0.290)	−0.302 (0.275)	3.700*** (1.146)	3.318*** (1.161)	−1.802** (0.676)	−2.475*** (0.643)	−3.404*** (0.935)
Election Year	0.542 (0.316)	0.260 (0.247)	0.366 (0.449)	0.052 (0.630)	0.029 (0.505)	−0.290 (0.481)	0.033 (0.436)
EITI Member	2.326*** (0.619)	1.108*** (0.346)	−2.621** (0.955)	−1.979** (0.830)	−0.251 (0.524)	−0.255 (0.604)	−1.608* (0.909)
Field Discovery	−0.072 (0.493)	−0.165 (0.298)	1.889 (1.374)	0.663 (1.285)	−0.781 (0.915)	−1.116 (0.853)	−0.674 (0.996)
SIDS	0.532 (0.541)	0.335 (0.486)	6.376*** (2.084)	6.346** (2.313)	−2.459** (1.133)	−2.446** (1.088)	−2.669** (1.151)
Disaster	0.154 (0.338)	−0.065 (0.215)	0.459 (0.928)	−1.567 (0.943)	0.673 (0.705)	0.770 (0.780)	1.243 (0.753)
Population	−0.081 (0.087)	−0.005 (0.090)	1.506*** (0.392)	1.241** (0.491)	−0.652** (0.303)	−0.713** (0.317)	−1.136*** (0.357)
GDP per Capita	0.019 (0.194)	0.113 (0.178)	0.902 (0.773)	0.128 (0.776)	0.244 (0.513)	0.833 (0.604)	0.306 (0.661)
Resource Rents	0.039 (0.030)	0.003 (0.014)	−0.037 (0.039)	−0.012 (0.050)	−0.013 (0.027)	−0.029 (0.035)	−0.085** (0.038)
Access to Electricity	0.003 (0.007)	0.005 (0.006)	−0.001 (0.018)	0.009 (0.015)	−0.027* (0.013)	−0.033** (0.016)	−0.042** (0.019)
DAC Aid	0.088 (0.139)	0.304*** (0.090)	−0.176 (0.353)	−0.310 (0.243)	−0.019 (0.169)	−0.137 (0.262)	−0.184 (0.303)
Chinese Finance	−0.035 (0.027)	−0.010 (0.023)	−0.225** (0.103)	−0.233** (0.086)	0.091 (0.064)	0.138** (0.059)	0.150* (0.078)
IMF Program	0.423 (0.291)	0.263 (0.190)	−1.965** (0.698)	−1.614** (0.772)	−0.334 (0.416)	−0.389 (0.475)	0.531 (0.767)
UNSC Member	−0.025 (0.267)	−0.426 (0.318)	−0.282 (1.153)	−0.740 (1.283)	0.461 (0.704)	1.079* (0.565)	0.449 (0.854)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−2.011 (3.648)	−1.358 (2.507)	18.122* (9.810)	15.667* (7.552)	−2.559 (3.485)	−5.101 (5.559)	−5.621 (6.258)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−1.821 (2.202)	−2.964 (2.068)	12.251 (8.176)	9.134 (5.667)	2.075 (3.872)	0.126 (4.360)	6.436 (5.038)
US Pres. is Republican	−0.523* (0.265)	−0.134 (0.234)	1.303 (0.992)	0.291 (0.643)	1.003 (0.677)	3.397** (1.264)	3.087* (1.545)
US Government Is Divided	0.163 (0.226)	0.043 (0.211)	−4.098*** (0.787)	−1.417*** (0.367)	1.504** (0.591)	2.076* (1.114)	3.434** (1.259)
TTL Experience	0.148** (0.069)	0.109** (0.044)	0.395* (0.219)	0.056 (0.129)	−0.076 (0.139)	−0.086 (0.162)	0.068 (0.170)
Intercept	2.371 (2.891)	2.653 (2.187)	−39.083** (15.617)	−23.069* (11.995)	14.721** (5.955)	8.768 (6.041)	14.293* (7.401)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915
R2	0.019	0.016	0.153	0.028	0.024	0.059	0.083
R2 Adj.	0.017	0.013	0.151	0.026	0.021	0.057	0.080

This table presents the results of seven linear regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for natural cubic splines are not directly interpretable on their own; they are used collectively to generate the predicted values shown in the figures. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure H.1: Predicted Project Content (% , Linear Models)



These panels display the average predicted extractive, climate, and health content of a project each year. These predictions are based on the linear regression models reported in Table H.1, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Because the estimates are based on linear regression models, some of the predicted values in panels (a) and (b) exceed the $[0, 100]$ bounds. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

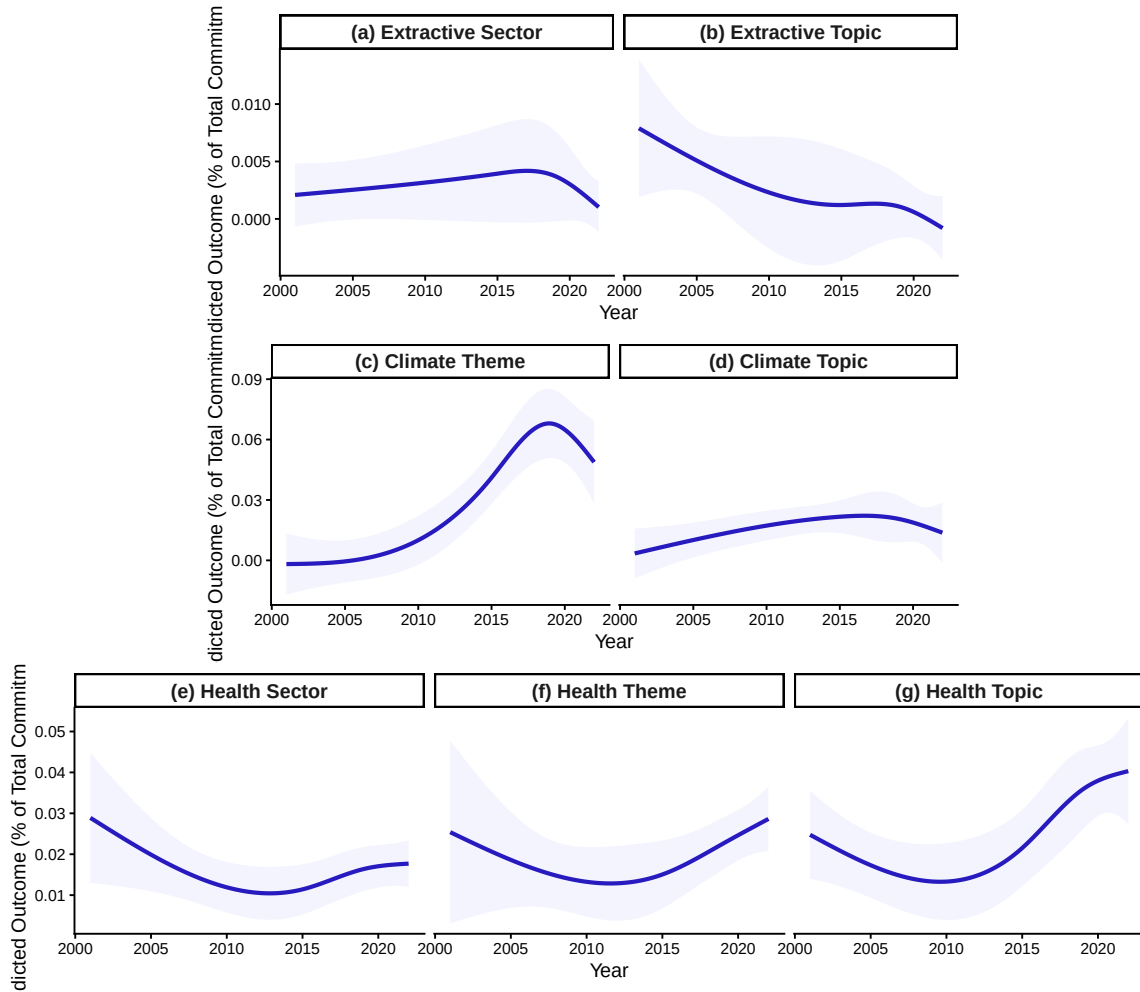
H.1.2 Project Commitment

Table H.2: Predictors of Project Commitment (% of Total Commitments), 2001–2022 (Linear Models)

	(a) Extractive Sector % Commit.	(b) Extractive Topic % Commit.	(c) Climate Theme % Commit.	(d) Climate Topic % Commit.	(e) Health Sector % Commit.	(f) Health Theme % Commit.	(g) Health Topic % Commit.
Year (Spline Basis 1)	0.002 (0.002)	−0.004** (0.002)	0.082*** (0.012)	0.015 (0.010)	−0.005 (0.005)	0.002 (0.005)	0.018*** (0.006)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	0.001 (0.002)	−0.015 (0.009)	0.061*** (0.020)	0.029** (0.013)	−0.033* (0.016)	−0.015 (0.024)	−0.004 (0.013)
Year (Spline Basis 3)	−0.002 (0.002)	−0.004** (0.002)	0.050*** (0.008)	−0.001 (0.005)	0.004 (0.003)	0.015*** (0.004)	0.029*** (0.006)
Governance	−0.002 (0.002)	−0.001 (0.001)	0.006 (0.005)	0.010 (0.008)	−0.004 (0.003)	−0.006 (0.004)	−0.009* (0.005)
Election Year	−0.001 (0.001)	0.000 (0.001)	0.001 (0.003)	0.007 (0.006)	0.000 (0.002)	0.000 (0.003)	−0.001 (0.003)
EITI Member	−0.001 (0.001)	−0.001 (0.001)	−0.004 (0.005)	−0.007 (0.004)	0.002 (0.002)	0.003 (0.003)	0.003 (0.004)
Field Discovery	−0.001 (0.002)	−0.001 (0.002)	−0.003 (0.007)	−0.011 (0.010)	−0.006 (0.005)	−0.009 (0.007)	−0.009** (0.004)
SIDS	0.000 (0.001)	0.002 (0.001)	0.006 (0.004)	0.005 (0.007)	0.003 (0.004)	0.002 (0.004)	0.003 (0.005)
Disaster	−0.001 (0.002)	0.000 (0.001)	−0.003 (0.004)	−0.002 (0.004)	0.000 (0.003)	0.001 (0.003)	0.000 (0.003)
Population	0.001 (0.001)	0.001* (0.001)	0.011*** (0.002)	0.008*** (0.002)	0.005*** (0.001)	0.005*** (0.001)	0.006*** (0.001)
GDP per Capita	0.002 (0.002)	0.001 (0.002)	0.007** (0.003)	0.005 (0.005)	0.007 (0.004)	0.010 (0.006)	0.008** (0.004)
Resource Rents	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000** (0.000)	0.000*** (0.000)	0.000*** (0.000)
Access to Electricity	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000* (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)
DAC Aid	0.000 (0.001)	0.000 (0.000)	0.002 (0.002)	0.001 (0.002)	0.001 (0.001)	0.001 (0.001)	0.002 (0.002)
Chinese Finance	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.001)	−0.001* (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.001)
IMF Program	0.000 (0.000)	0.001 (0.001)	−0.001 (0.004)	−0.002 (0.004)	0.005 (0.004)	0.006 (0.005)	0.005 (0.004)
UNSC Member	−0.002 (0.001)	−0.003* (0.002)	0.003 (0.007)	0.004 (0.009)	0.007 (0.005)	0.015*** (0.005)	0.011 (0.007)
US Ideal Point Dist.	0.006 (0.013)	0.008 (0.012)	0.067 (0.041)	0.040 (0.035)	−0.012 (0.026)	−0.015 (0.037)	−0.039 (0.031)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−0.003 (0.004)	−0.007 (0.007)	0.037 (0.025)	0.037* (0.021)	−0.028 (0.018)	−0.031 (0.022)	−0.033 (0.024)
US Pres. is Republican	0.002 (0.001)	−0.001 (0.002)	0.008 (0.005)	−0.003 (0.005)	0.001 (0.003)	0.005 (0.003)	0.006 (0.004)
US Government Is Divided	0.000 (0.001)	−0.001 (0.001)	−0.014** (0.005)	−0.008* (0.004)	0.002 (0.003)	0.002 (0.004)	0.005* (0.003)
TTL Experience	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.000)	0.000 (0.001)	−0.001** (0.001)	−0.001* (0.000)	−0.001 (0.001)	0.000 (0.001)
Intercept	−0.024 (0.023)	−0.018 (0.022)	−0.268*** (0.051)	−0.183*** (0.042)	−0.079* (0.042)	−0.107** (0.041)	−0.106** (0.048)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915
R2	0.002	0.008	0.071	0.009	0.011	0.012	0.020
R2 Adj.	0.000	0.006	0.068	0.006	0.009	0.009	0.018

This table presents the results of seven linear regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for natural cubic splines are not directly interpretable on their own; they are used collectively to generate the predicted values shown in the figures. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure H.2: Predicted Project Commitment (% of Total Commitments, Linear Models)



These panels display the predicted portfolio share of each project (e.g., its climate-relevant commitment as a percentage of total annual IDA and IBRD lending) by year and content category. These predictions are based on the linear regression models reported in Table H.2, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

H.2 Year Fixed Effects

Our main analysis models time with splines rather than year fixed effects because we are interested in gradual evolution, not discrete jumps. The World Bank's project portfolio does not change abruptly from one year to the next; it evolves continuously. Splines capture this smooth adjustment more parsimoniously than fixed effects, which assume unrelated year-by-year shocks and reduce the degrees of freedom. Still, the results are robust to using year fixed effects instead of splines, though the variables *Republican* and *US Government Is Divided* drop out due to perfect collinearity: since US political conditions change only annually and are constant within each year, they are perfectly collinear with the year fixed effects.

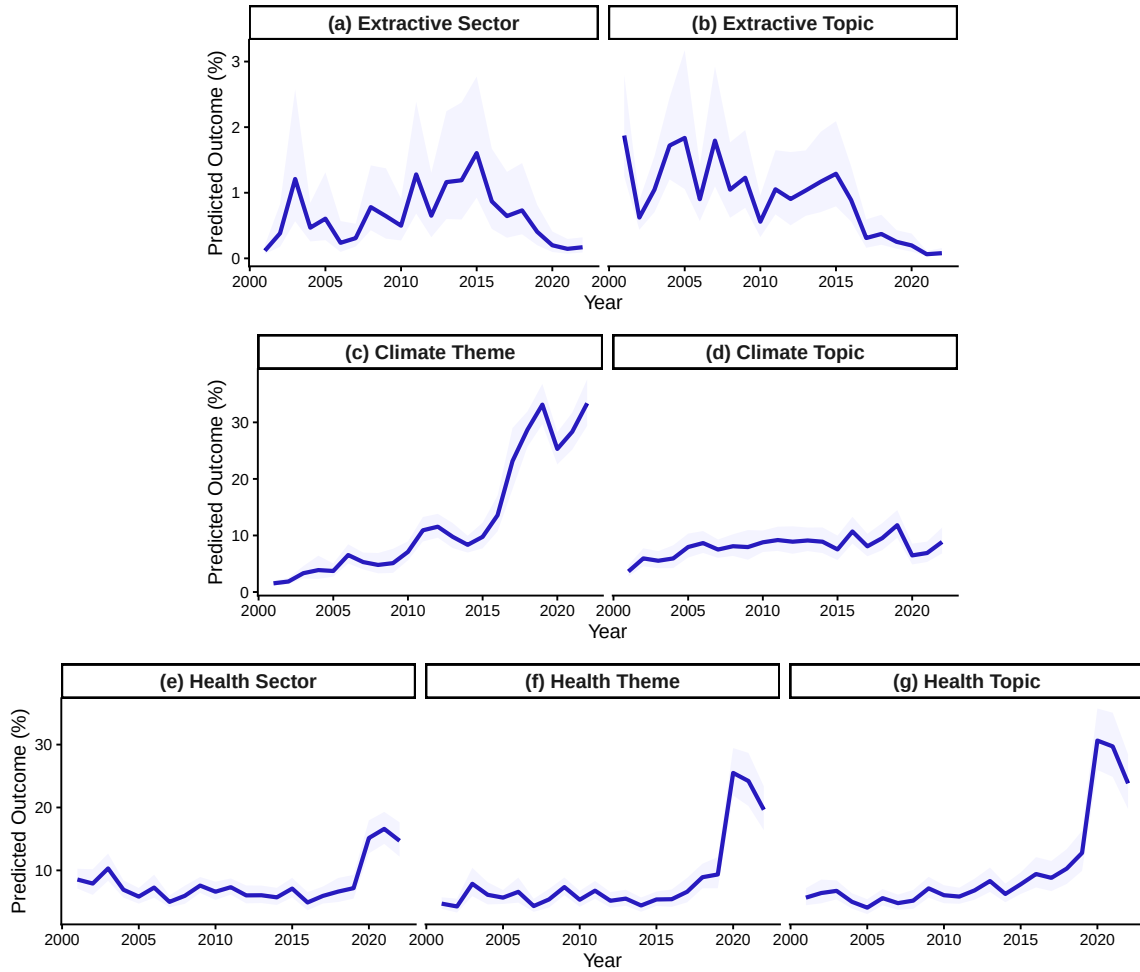
H.2.1 Project Content

Table H.3: Predictors of Project Content, 2001–2022 (Year Fixed Effects)

	(a) Extractive Sector Share	(b) Extractive Topic Share	(c) Climate Theme Share	(d) Climate Topic Share	(e) Health Sector Share	(f) Health Theme Share	(g) Health Topic Share
Governance	−0.191 (0.229)	−0.225 (0.234)	0.315*** (0.116)	0.439*** (0.152)	−0.255** (0.108)	−0.332*** (0.102)	−0.363*** (0.111)
Election Year	0.410** (0.202)	0.205 (0.185)	0.037 (0.052)	0.019 (0.085)	−0.006 (0.083)	−0.057 (0.079)	−0.011 (0.065)
EITI Member	1.186*** (0.256)	0.862*** (0.192)	−0.127 (0.102)	−0.230* (0.127)	−0.033 (0.075)	−0.029 (0.073)	−0.152 (0.094)
Field Discovery	−0.024 (0.388)	−0.134 (0.227)	0.205 (0.136)	0.080 (0.152)	−0.184 (0.202)	−0.276 (0.186)	−0.183 (0.220)
SIDS	0.395 (0.369)	0.380 (0.388)	0.542*** (0.145)	0.719*** (0.226)	−0.349** (0.167)	−0.319** (0.133)	−0.266** (0.112)
Disaster	0.122 (0.255)	−0.049 (0.168)	0.042 (0.094)	−0.194 (0.125)	0.085 (0.106)	0.087 (0.116)	0.131 (0.097)
Population	−0.056 (0.091)	0.039 (0.070)	0.134*** (0.036)	0.147*** (0.052)	−0.094** (0.044)	−0.096** (0.040)	−0.129*** (0.032)
GDP per Capita	0.043 (0.149)	0.043 (0.141)	0.061 (0.066)	−0.015 (0.103)	0.030 (0.081)	0.111 (0.095)	0.026 (0.079)
Resource Rents	0.020 (0.017)	0.000 (0.010)	−0.009 (0.006)	−0.004 (0.011)	0.000 (0.005)	−0.001 (0.006)	−0.007 (0.005)
Access to Electricity	0.001 (0.005)	0.003 (0.005)	0.001 (0.002)	0.002 (0.002)	−0.004 (0.002)	−0.004 (0.003)	−0.005* (0.003)
DAC Aid	0.054 (0.070)	0.080** (0.035)	−0.075 (0.067)	−0.064 (0.075)	−0.001 (0.022)	−0.017 (0.038)	−0.020 (0.046)
Chinese Finance	−0.018 (0.033)	−0.006 (0.016)	−0.020* (0.012)	−0.029*** (0.010)	0.013 (0.013)	0.017 (0.012)	0.015* (0.009)
IMF Program	0.273 (0.200)	0.223 (0.141)	−0.171*** (0.064)	−0.218* (0.119)	−0.057 (0.058)	−0.073 (0.070)	0.054 (0.103)
UNSC Member	0.086 (0.273)	−0.319 (0.303)	−0.008 (0.115)	−0.073 (0.142)	0.095 (0.124)	0.204** (0.094)	0.082 (0.135)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−1.905 (2.312)	−1.020 (1.883)	0.929 (0.603)	1.899* (0.991)	−0.746 (0.549)	−1.136 (0.700)	−0.947 (0.686)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−1.795 (1.266)	−1.996 (1.280)	0.851 (0.557)	1.134 (0.733)	−0.118 (0.571)	−0.513 (0.564)	0.439 (0.516)
TTL Experience	0.075** (0.031)	0.072*** (0.026)	0.029* (0.015)	0.005 (0.018)	−0.013 (0.025)	−0.012 (0.025)	0.006 (0.021)
Intercept	−4.904** (2.127)	−3.611** (1.819)	−7.504*** (0.766)	−6.427*** (1.024)	−0.775 (0.969)	−1.572** (0.802)	−0.972 (0.897)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915
AIC	1116.7	702.9	5778.5	4690.2	4114.8	4213.4	5011.7
BIC	1393.4	979.6	6055.2	4966.9	4391.5	4490.1	5288.5

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The variables *Republican* and *US Government Is Divided* drop out due to perfect collinearity. The coefficients for year fixed effects are omitted from the table for brevity. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure H.3: Predicted Project Content (% , Year Fixed Effects)



These panels display the average predicted extractive, climate, and health content of a project each year. These predictions are based on fractional logistic regressions reported in Table H.3, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

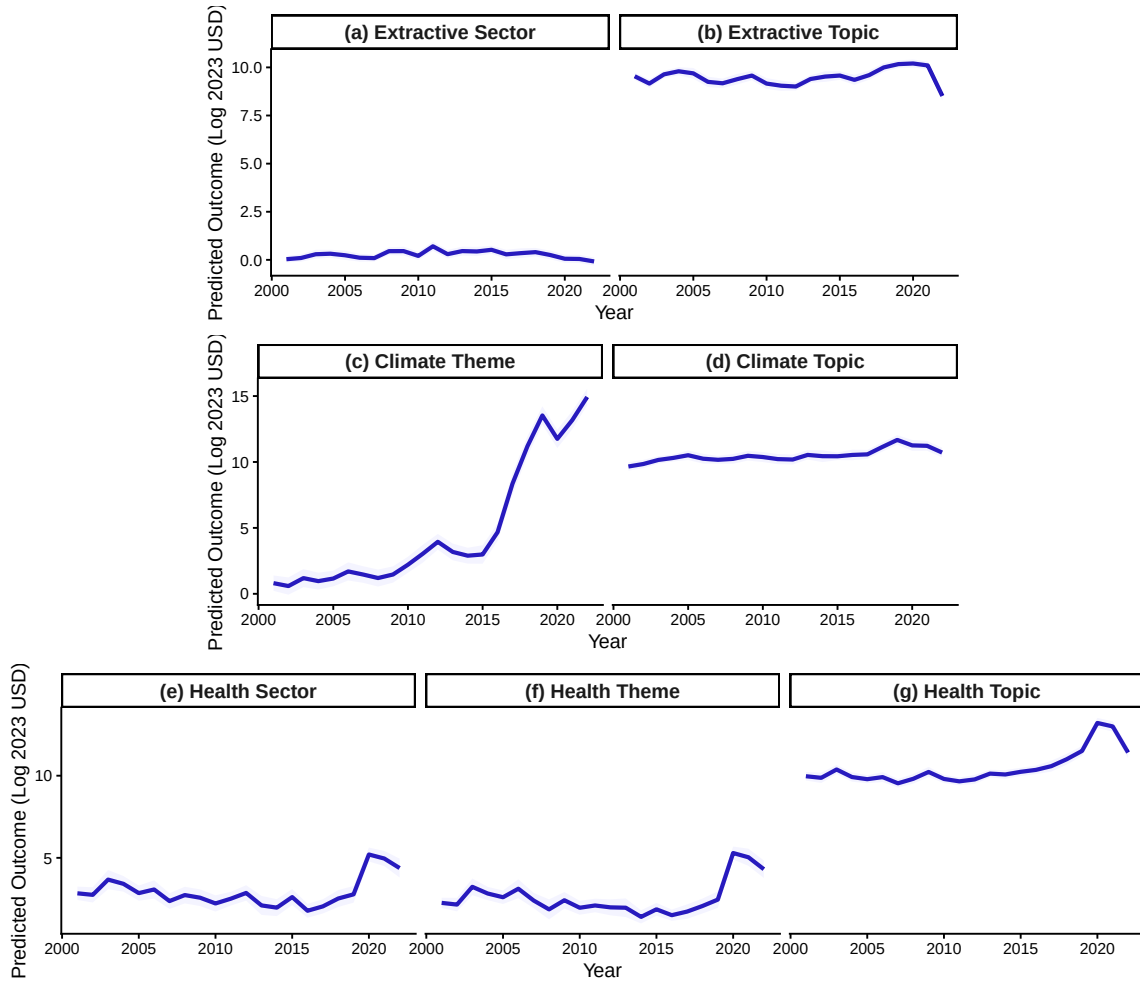
H.2.2 Project Commitment

Table H.4: Predictors of Project Commitment (Log USD), 2001–2022 (Year Fixed Effects)

	(a) Extractive Sector Log USD	(b) Extractive Topic Log USD	(c) Climate Theme Log USD	(d) Climate Topic Log USD	(e) Health Sector Log USD	(f) Health Theme Log USD	(g) Health Topic Log USD
Governance	−0.038 (0.094)	0.071 (0.131)	1.078*** (0.255)	0.641*** (0.170)	−0.214 (0.221)	−0.315 (0.190)	−0.240 (0.141)
Election Year	0.118 (0.069)	0.056 (0.084)	0.168 (0.179)	−0.004 (0.116)	−0.083 (0.157)	−0.078 (0.153)	0.087 (0.115)
EITI Member	0.453*** (0.129)	−0.069 (0.130)	−0.450 (0.303)	−0.441** (0.168)	−0.257 (0.172)	−0.132 (0.173)	−0.430*** (0.123)
Field Discovery	0.142 (0.129)	0.022 (0.177)	0.364 (0.400)	0.253 (0.236)	−0.051 (0.298)	−0.288 (0.247)	−0.032 (0.166)
SIDS	−0.123 (0.128)	−0.057 (0.162)	0.967* (0.489)	0.721** (0.320)	−0.584* (0.337)	−0.525 (0.333)	−0.381* (0.188)
Disaster	0.175 (0.113)	−0.076 (0.103)	−0.208 (0.224)	−0.217 (0.133)	0.146 (0.194)	0.135 (0.208)	0.082 (0.115)
Population	−0.071** (0.027)	0.319*** (0.037)	0.459*** (0.095)	0.452*** (0.063)	−0.160* (0.079)	−0.117* (0.061)	0.205*** (0.041)
GDP per Capita	0.012 (0.061)	0.054 (0.089)	0.188 (0.199)	−0.017 (0.130)	0.121 (0.170)	0.172 (0.148)	0.093 (0.106)
Resource Rents	0.010 (0.006)	0.001 (0.007)	−0.009 (0.014)	−0.002 (0.007)	−0.007 (0.014)	−0.015 (0.012)	−0.008 (0.008)
Access to Electricity	−0.001 (0.002)	−0.002 (0.003)	−0.002 (0.007)	−0.001 (0.003)	−0.013*** (0.005)	−0.011** (0.004)	−0.005* (0.003)
DAC Aid	−0.005 (0.041)	0.103** (0.046)	−0.040 (0.096)	0.002 (0.043)	−0.042 (0.061)	−0.059 (0.058)	0.042 (0.044)
Chinese Finance	−0.007 (0.008)	0.007 (0.012)	−0.054 (0.045)	−0.021 (0.013)	0.036 (0.025)	0.038* (0.022)	0.024 (0.015)
IMF Program	0.170* (0.086)	0.042 (0.086)	−0.248 (0.191)	−0.227* (0.110)	0.029 (0.146)	0.070 (0.141)	0.088 (0.115)
UNSC Member	−0.050 (0.100)	−0.170 (0.133)	−0.522 (0.316)	−0.133 (0.134)	0.288 (0.224)	0.398** (0.190)	−0.066 (0.164)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−0.729 (0.757)	0.004 (0.948)	0.943 (2.024)	1.995 (1.263)	−3.852** (1.395)	−1.963 (1.227)	−0.345 (0.844)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−0.111 (0.527)	−1.108 (0.689)	1.084 (1.643)	0.252 (0.912)	−2.063* (1.159)	−1.094 (0.855)	−0.288 (0.616)
TTL Experience	0.019 (0.017)	−0.045** (0.019)	0.070 (0.042)	−0.052** (0.023)	−0.073* (0.042)	−0.049 (0.049)	−0.043 (0.031)
Intercept	1.176 (0.747)	4.838*** (1.057)	−8.366*** (2.917)	2.330 (1.371)	7.687*** (1.904)	4.744*** (1.396)	6.290*** (1.190)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915
R2	0.018	0.092	0.374	0.075	0.031	0.040	0.097
R2 Adj.	0.014	0.088	0.371	0.071	0.027	0.036	0.093

This table presents the results of seven linear regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The variables *Republican* and *US Government Is Divided* drop out due to perfect collinearity. The coefficients for year fixed effects are omitted from the table for brevity. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure H.4: Predicted Project Commitment (Log USD, Year Fixed Effects)



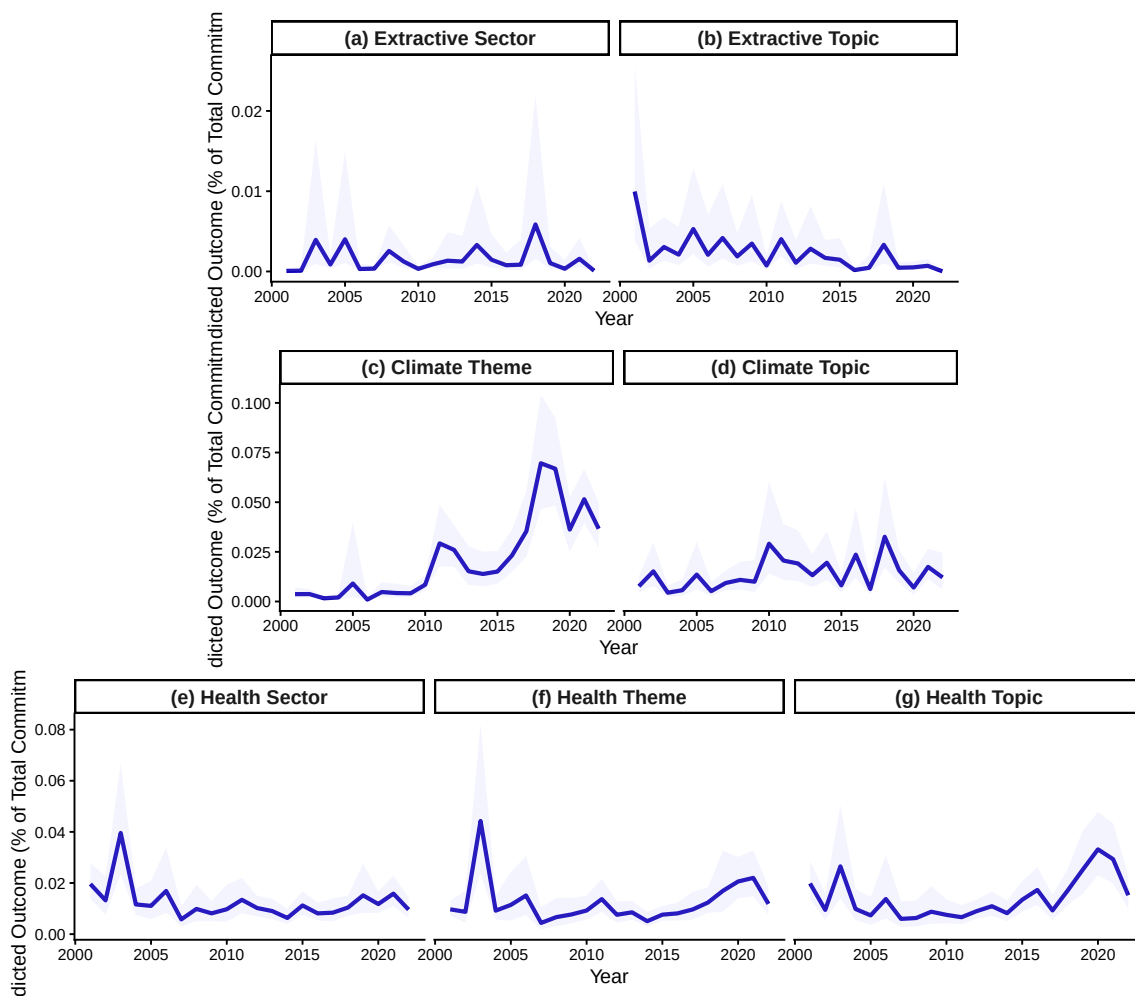
These panels display the average predicted new IDA and IBRD commitment (in logged 2023 USD) per project each year, as a function of a project's share of extractive, renewable, climate, and health content. These predictions are based on linear regressions reported in Table H.4, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

Table H.5: Predictors of Project Commitment (Share of Total Commitments), 2001–2022 (Year Fixed Effects)

	(a) Extractive Sector Share Commit.	(b) Extractive Topic Share Commit.	(c) Climate Theme Share Commit.	(d) Climate Topic Share Commit.	(e) Health Sector Share Commit.	(f) Health Theme Share Commit.	(g) Health Topic Share Commit.
Governance	−1.269 (0.793)	−0.660 (0.447)	−0.016 (0.187)	0.381 (0.472)	−0.428** (0.217)	−0.564** (0.252)	−0.719*** (0.239)
Election Year	−0.160 (0.387)	0.004 (0.361)	0.093 (0.127)	0.436 (0.272)	0.006 (0.166)	−0.041 (0.172)	−0.055 (0.151)
EITI Member	−0.445 (0.420)	−0.463 (0.374)	0.016 (0.160)	−0.269 (0.254)	0.076 (0.155)	0.095 (0.187)	0.071 (0.180)
Field Discovery	−0.508 (0.794)	−0.402 (0.444)	0.019 (0.201)	−0.425 (0.482)	−0.359 (0.269)	−0.521 (0.365)	−0.446* (0.228)
SIDS	−1.809*** (0.662)	−0.566 (0.715)	−0.294 (0.213)	−0.476 (0.549)	−0.676* (0.356)	−0.769*** (0.279)	−0.618*** (0.189)
Disaster	−0.436 (0.727)	−0.096 (0.485)	−0.035 (0.199)	−0.063 (0.338)	0.052 (0.267)	0.120 (0.260)	0.046 (0.225)
Population	0.445** (0.182)	0.503*** (0.149)	0.311*** (0.056)	0.319*** (0.076)	0.372*** (0.075)	0.361*** (0.079)	0.340*** (0.079)
GDP per Capita	1.099* (0.636)	0.505 (0.490)	0.319*** (0.121)	0.318 (0.256)	0.590** (0.242)	0.669** (0.297)	0.494*** (0.175)
Resource Rents	−0.009 (0.033)	−0.004 (0.026)	−0.006 (0.012)	−0.018 (0.016)	−0.023* (0.012)	−0.026** (0.011)	−0.034*** (0.012)
Access to Electricity	−0.019 (0.017)	−0.004 (0.013)	−0.001 (0.006)	0.002 (0.007)	−0.013** (0.007)	−0.011** (0.005)	−0.009* (0.005)
DAC Aid	0.070 (0.177)	0.063 (0.076)	0.123* (0.073)	0.109 (0.078)	0.047 (0.065)	0.045 (0.058)	0.070 (0.054)
Chinese Finance	−0.063 (0.044)	−0.001 (0.022)	−0.003 (0.019)	−0.030 (0.028)	−0.002 (0.019)	−0.007 (0.020)	−0.003 (0.020)
IMF Program	0.345 (0.317)	0.277 (0.359)	0.017 (0.164)	−0.003 (0.325)	0.376 (0.233)	0.441* (0.263)	0.330 (0.202)
UNSC Member	−0.873 (0.641)	−1.247** (0.583)	0.126 (0.273)	0.182 (0.354)	0.299 (0.247)	0.566** (0.277)	0.384 (0.244)
US Ideal Point Dist.	1.960 (4.191)	2.572 (3.000)	−0.242 (0.985)	1.518 (2.127)	−1.386 (1.868)	−1.606 (2.614)	−3.105* (1.709)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−3.176 (2.267)	−3.074 (2.089)	−0.487 (0.693)	1.535 (1.652)	−2.715** (1.064)	−2.713* (1.400)	−2.784** (1.223)
TTL Experience	−0.076 (0.076)	0.019 (0.044)	−0.017 (0.024)	−0.089* (0.047)	−0.065 (0.042)	−0.062 (0.045)	0.010 (0.042)
Intercept	−26.560*** (7.401)	−19.544*** (5.833)	−17.387*** (0.980)	−18.413*** (2.283)	−16.064*** (2.433)	−17.401*** (2.351)	−14.914*** (2.092)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915
AIC	78.4	78.5	83.3	81.3	80.9	81.0	81.6
BIC	355.1	355.3	360.0	358.1	357.6	357.8	358.3

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for year fixed effects are omitted from the table for brevity. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure H.5: Predicted Project Commitment (% of Total Commitments, Year Fixed Effects)



These panels display the predicted portfolio share of each project (e.g., its climate-relevant commitment as a percentage of total annual IDA and IBRD lending) by year and content category. These predictions are based on fractional logistic regressions reported in Table H.5, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

H.3 *After 2019* Dummy

We also estimate alternative models that replace the cubic splines with a single post-2019 indicator, capturing potential shifts associated with the World Bank’s pledge to cease direct financing of upstream oil and gas projects after 2019. Unlike the spline specification, which allows for flexible nonlinear trends, this specification is more restrictive because it imposes a single step change. The main findings are robust to this alternative specification: the official *Climate Theme* shows a significant increase after 2019 that the *Climate Topic* does not mirror, while the *Extractive* measures decline consistently with the pledge.

H.3.1 Project Content

Table H.6: Predictors of Project Content, 2001–2022 (With *After 2019* Dummy)

	(a) Extractive Sector Share	(b) Extractive Topic Share	(c) Climate Theme Share	(d) Climate Topic Share	(e) Health Sector Share	(f) Health Theme Share	(g) Health Topic Share
After 2019	−1.443*** (0.175)	−2.038*** (0.328)	1.098*** (0.230)	−0.132* (0.071)	0.934*** (0.068)	1.472*** (0.078)	1.556*** (0.108)
Governance	−0.228 (0.204)	−0.157 (0.230)	0.106 (0.122)	0.376** (0.148)	−0.235** (0.103)	−0.363*** (0.101)	−0.430*** (0.117)
Election Year	0.382** (0.173)	0.212 (0.169)	−0.004 (0.052)	0.003 (0.078)	0.000 (0.077)	−0.062 (0.069)	−0.023 (0.052)
EITI Member	1.270*** (0.206)	0.553** (0.227)	0.334* (0.174)	−0.126 (0.119)	−0.054 (0.057)	0.052 (0.055)	−0.005 (0.076)
Field Discovery	0.033 (0.365)	−0.069 (0.240)	0.097 (0.087)	0.052 (0.135)	−0.165 (0.182)	−0.269 (0.181)	−0.188 (0.211)
SIDS	0.378 (0.345)	0.183 (0.384)	0.719*** (0.161)	0.751*** (0.224)	−0.350** (0.164)	−0.295** (0.128)	−0.221** (0.109)
Disaster	0.111 (0.204)	−0.006 (0.149)	−0.015 (0.096)	−0.212* (0.120)	0.100 (0.098)	0.090 (0.111)	0.125 (0.085)
Population	−0.077 (0.084)	0.022 (0.071)	0.129*** (0.038)	0.145*** (0.051)	−0.095** (0.044)	−0.100** (0.040)	−0.133*** (0.032)
GDP per Capita	0.040 (0.133)	0.061 (0.134)	0.048 (0.082)	0.013 (0.104)	0.018 (0.078)	0.102 (0.086)	0.016 (0.077)
Resource Rents	0.017 (0.011)	0.004 (0.009)	−0.020*** (0.005)	−0.006 (0.008)	0.000 (0.004)	−0.003 (0.007)	−0.011** (0.005)
Access to Electricity	0.001 (0.004)	0.002 (0.004)	0.003 (0.002)	0.002 (0.002)	−0.004 (0.002)	−0.004* (0.002)	−0.004* (0.002)
DAC Aid	0.037 (0.052)	0.070*** (0.027)	−0.007 (0.070)	−0.042 (0.062)	−0.003 (0.021)	−0.012 (0.032)	−0.012 (0.040)
Chinese Finance	−0.015 (0.019)	−0.013 (0.020)	−0.005 (0.015)	−0.027*** (0.009)	0.011 (0.011)	0.021*** (0.007)	0.021** (0.010)
IMF Program	0.275 (0.174)	0.295** (0.120)	−0.370*** (0.102)	−0.282*** (0.100)	−0.034 (0.043)	−0.101 (0.066)	−0.002 (0.097)
UNSC Member	0.056 (0.238)	−0.297 (0.302)	−0.143 (0.115)	−0.084 (0.138)	0.097 (0.112)	0.178** (0.081)	0.045 (0.129)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−1.890 (2.205)	−0.913 (1.777)	1.680 (1.082)	1.324 (0.819)	−0.346 (0.462)	−1.054* (0.596)	−0.883 (0.588)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−1.306 (1.364)	−1.464 (1.438)	0.159 (0.924)	0.669 (0.590)	0.177 (0.546)	−0.626 (0.497)	0.062 (0.463)
US Pres. is Republican	−0.363* (0.194)	0.057 (0.199)	−0.072 (0.277)	−0.123* (0.068)	0.095* (0.055)	0.252*** (0.070)	0.079 (0.114)
US Government Is Divided	0.259 (0.191)	0.125 (0.201)	−0.368 (0.261)	−0.153*** (0.058)	0.030 (0.050)	−0.040 (0.066)	0.128 (0.112)
TTL Experience	0.080*** (0.024)	0.063** (0.031)	0.047*** (0.014)	0.012 (0.014)	−0.015 (0.022)	−0.009 (0.022)	0.011 (0.019)
Intercept	−3.074 (2.231)	−4.549*** (1.714)	−4.905*** (1.430)	−5.185*** (1.005)	−1.307 (0.995)	−1.245 (0.820)	−0.502 (0.760)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915
AIC	1103.2	693.0	6059.0	4680.7	4094.3	4209.4	5018.8
BIC	1252.2	842.0	6208.0	4829.7	4243.3	4358.4	5167.8

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

H.3.2 Project Commitment

Table H.7: Predictors of Project Commitment (Log USD), 2001–2022 (With *After 2019* Dummy)

	(a) Extractive Sector Log USD	(b) Extractive Topic Log USD	(c) Climate Theme Log USD	(d) Climate Topic Log USD	(e) Health Sector Log USD	(f) Health Theme Log USD	(g) Health Topic Log USD
After 2019	−0.330*** (0.055)	−0.020 (0.277)	8.736*** (1.098)	0.508*** (0.155)	2.235*** (0.159)	2.678*** (0.191)	2.185*** (0.319)
Governance	−0.049 (0.087)	0.008 (0.127)	0.313 (0.409)	0.532*** (0.165)	−0.146 (0.218)	−0.267 (0.178)	−0.357** (0.148)
Election Year	0.113* (0.063)	0.040 (0.078)	0.008 (0.250)	−0.028 (0.100)	−0.056 (0.134)	−0.056 (0.124)	0.069 (0.103)
EITI Member	0.495*** (0.106)	0.099 (0.103)	1.779** (0.828)	−0.177 (0.161)	−0.365** (0.172)	−0.236 (0.172)	−0.108 (0.115)
Field Discovery	0.144 (0.126)	0.029 (0.160)	0.040 (0.347)	0.229 (0.225)	−0.011 (0.264)	−0.245 (0.231)	−0.043 (0.144)
SIDS	−0.109 (0.125)	0.005 (0.168)	2.067*** (0.635)	0.828** (0.329)	−0.634* (0.330)	−0.580* (0.316)	−0.252 (0.198)
Disaster	0.179 (0.108)	−0.084 (0.102)	−0.431 (0.256)	−0.241* (0.137)	0.175 (0.179)	0.150 (0.206)	0.055 (0.121)
Population	−0.076** (0.027)	0.317*** (0.034)	0.517*** (0.102)	0.453*** (0.061)	−0.165** (0.077)	−0.120* (0.060)	0.203*** (0.042)
GDP per Capita	0.015 (0.057)	0.047 (0.092)	0.010 (0.287)	−0.008 (0.131)	0.080 (0.169)	0.153 (0.146)	0.080 (0.107)
Resource Rents	0.009 (0.006)	−0.005 (0.006)	−0.049** (0.023)	−0.008 (0.006)	−0.004 (0.010)	−0.014 (0.009)	−0.018** (0.007)
Access to Electricity	−0.001 (0.002)	−0.002 (0.002)	0.008 (0.009)	0.000 (0.003)	−0.013*** (0.004)	−0.011** (0.004)	−0.004 (0.003)
DAC Aid	−0.001 (0.038)	0.102** (0.042)	0.034 (0.164)	0.012 (0.044)	−0.054 (0.053)	−0.058 (0.054)	0.055 (0.036)
Chinese Finance	−0.005 (0.006)	0.014 (0.011)	−0.008 (0.061)	−0.014 (0.009)	0.033 (0.021)	0.037** (0.017)	0.036* (0.019)
IMF Program	0.157* (0.079)	0.018 (0.086)	−1.044** (0.394)	−0.313*** (0.110)	0.082 (0.138)	0.125 (0.123)	0.002 (0.118)
UNSC Member	−0.064 (0.097)	−0.226** (0.100)	−0.968** (0.452)	−0.184 (0.127)	0.313 (0.209)	0.421** (0.157)	−0.156 (0.142)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−0.933 (0.673)	0.379 (0.954)	4.380 (4.829)	1.495 (1.088)	−2.123 (1.278)	−1.062 (1.130)	0.043 (0.806)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−0.136 (0.500)	−1.118 (0.722)	−2.486 (3.601)	−0.436 (0.833)	−0.813 (1.076)	−0.465 (0.700)	−0.629 (0.655)
US Pres. is Republican	−0.053 (0.077)	0.536*** (0.168)	−0.043 (1.221)	0.220 (0.138)	0.608*** (0.126)	0.657*** (0.141)	0.502** (0.208)
US Government Is Divided	0.061 (0.073)	0.249 (0.149)	−1.719 (1.197)	−0.106 (0.127)	0.018 (0.113)	−0.130 (0.123)	0.308 (0.201)
TTL Experience	0.022 (0.015)	−0.042* (0.023)	0.143** (0.052)	−0.042* (0.022)	−0.080** (0.036)	−0.057 (0.040)	−0.034 (0.027)
Intercept	1.549* (0.807)	4.351*** (1.020)	−2.794 (4.923)	3.519** (1.414)	6.213*** (1.929)	3.971** (1.459)	6.266*** (1.049)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915
R2	0.016	0.076	0.241	0.066	0.029	0.038	0.082
R2 Adj.	0.013	0.074	0.239	0.064	0.027	0.036	0.080

This table presents the results of seven linear regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Table H.8: Predictors of Project Commitment (Share of Total Commitments), 2001–2022 (With *After 2019* Dummy)

	(a) Extractive Sector Share Commit.	(b) Extractive Topic Share Commit.	(c) Climate Theme Share Commit.	(d) Climate Topic Share Commit.	(e) Health Sector Share Commit.	(f) Health Theme Share Commit.	(g) Health Topic Share Commit.
After 2019	-1.253* (0.691)	-1.601*** (0.431)	0.590** (0.277)	-0.197 (0.277)	0.013 (0.162)	0.428** (0.184)	0.643*** (0.158)
Governance	-1.500* (0.812)	-0.440 (0.489)	-0.255 (0.177)	0.324 (0.457)	-0.361* (0.191)	-0.552** (0.223)	-0.774*** (0.251)
Election Year	-0.288 (0.431)	0.071 (0.429)	0.041 (0.131)	0.418* (0.248)	0.068 (0.133)	0.026 (0.126)	-0.020 (0.114)
EITI Member	-0.149 (0.411)	-0.829*** (0.308)	0.546*** (0.183)	-0.077 (0.243)	0.005 (0.151)	0.102 (0.180)	0.198 (0.167)
Field Discovery	-0.611 (0.769)	-0.281 (0.369)	-0.094 (0.186)	-0.507 (0.410)	-0.321 (0.261)	-0.487 (0.336)	-0.434** (0.178)
SIDS	-1.697*** (0.641)	-0.667 (0.699)	-0.074 (0.232)	-0.427 (0.523)	-0.747** (0.353)	-0.828*** (0.259)	-0.676*** (0.221)
Disaster	-0.456 (0.800)	0.038 (0.406)	-0.122 (0.225)	-0.107 (0.342)	0.065 (0.231)	0.087 (0.221)	0.030 (0.205)
Population	0.446** (0.176)	0.470*** (0.136)	0.344*** (0.032)	0.325*** (0.066)	0.365*** (0.068)	0.356*** (0.073)	0.338*** (0.074)
GDP per Capita	1.188* (0.687)	0.406 (0.500)	0.239** (0.096)	0.337 (0.253)	0.550** (0.226)	0.639** (0.266)	0.468*** (0.157)
Resource Rents	-0.016 (0.025)	0.009 (0.024)	-0.029*** (0.011)	-0.027* (0.015)	-0.023** (0.011)	-0.029*** (0.011)	-0.041*** (0.011)
Access to Electricity	-0.019 (0.016)	-0.002 (0.012)	0.002 (0.005)	0.002 (0.008)	-0.013** (0.005)	-0.011** (0.005)	-0.008* (0.004)
DAC Aid	0.015 (0.129)	0.020 (0.071)	0.096* (0.052)	0.103 (0.065)	0.042 (0.054)	0.044 (0.045)	0.068 (0.051)
Chinese Finance	-0.054 (0.056)	-0.013 (0.033)	0.009 (0.013)	-0.024 (0.022)	-0.002 (0.019)	-0.002 (0.014)	0.003 (0.016)
IMF Program	0.233 (0.269)	0.519 (0.359)	-0.248 (0.167)	-0.151 (0.278)	0.459* (0.260)	0.477 (0.292)	0.302 (0.190)
UNSC Member	-0.951 (0.747)	-1.191** (0.526)	0.001 (0.192)	0.163 (0.332)	0.335* (0.199)	0.577*** (0.182)	0.371* (0.210)
US Ideal Point Dist.	1.902 (3.957)	3.366 (2.117)	2.571 (1.665)	1.203 (2.070)	0.015 (1.343)	-0.609 (2.034)	-1.721 (1.404)
China Ideal Point Dist.	-3.048 (2.495)	-2.089 (2.491)	-0.029 (1.141)	1.490 (1.406)	-1.820** (0.911)	-2.206** (1.123)	-2.485** (1.095)
US Pres. is Republican	0.753* (0.436)	0.215 (0.371)	0.113 (0.303)	-0.351 (0.277)	0.337* (0.172)	0.459*** (0.156)	0.371** (0.185)
US Government Is Divided	0.184 (0.436)	-0.110 (0.339)	-0.380 (0.288)	-0.330* (0.199)	0.118 (0.212)	0.078 (0.247)	0.179 (0.166)
TTL Experience	-0.061 (0.073)	-0.011 (0.044)	0.004 (0.019)	-0.078* (0.043)	-0.077** (0.035)	-0.069* (0.037)	0.009 (0.039)
Intercept	-24.824*** (6.780)	-20.788*** (5.010)	-16.565*** (1.276)	-17.492*** (1.950)	-17.330*** (2.563)	-17.797*** (2.460)	-15.994*** (1.964)
Num.Obs.	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915	8915
AIC	42.4	42.5	47.3	45.3	44.9	45.0	45.6
BIC	191.4	191.5	196.3	194.4	193.9	194.0	194.6

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

H.4 Excluding 2020–2022

H.4.1 Project Content

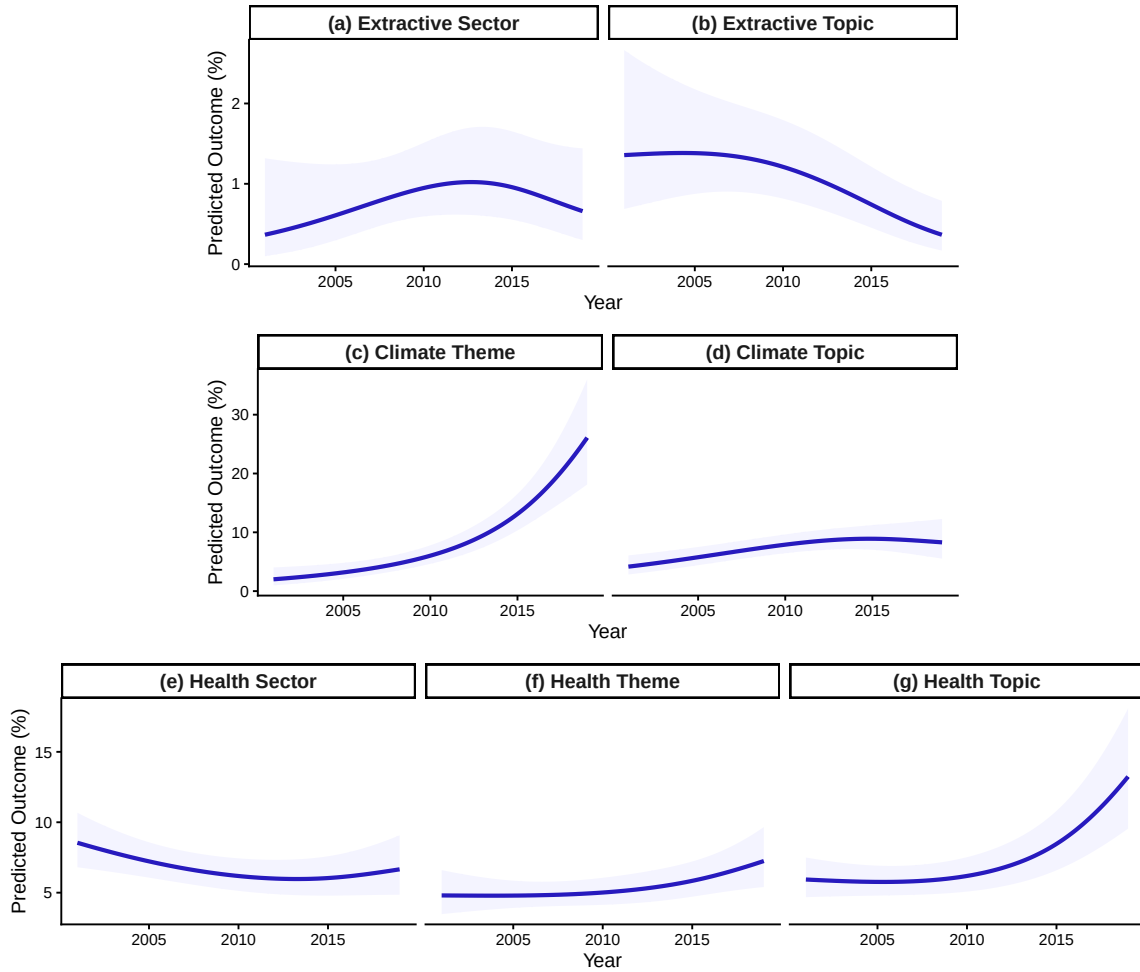
We also re-estimate our main models using a sample restricted to 2001–2019, excluding the COVID-19 pandemic period. This addresses the concern that the post-2019 surge in health financing could confound the main results. We use a single spline knot for 2015 to capture the Paris Agreement. The additional 2019 knot in the main specification was designed to capture post-pandemic dynamics that are absent from this restricted sample.

Table H.9: Predictors of Project Content, 2001–2019 (Reduced Temporal Scope)

	(a) Extractive Sector Share	(b) Extractive Topic Share	(c) Climate Theme Share	(d) Climate Topic Share	(e) Health Sector Share	(f) Health Theme Share	(g) Health Topic Share
Year (Spline Basis 1)	1.794 (1.180)	−0.995* (0.549)	3.467*** (0.545)	1.468*** (0.234)	−0.687*** (0.203)	0.338 (0.316)	0.616*** (0.235)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	−0.268 (0.295)	−1.379*** (0.303)	2.097*** (0.183)	0.162 (0.173)	0.037 (0.111)	0.450*** (0.132)	0.954*** (0.127)
Governance	−0.266 (0.212)	−0.205 (0.233)	0.485*** (0.121)	0.460*** (0.159)	−0.309** (0.135)	−0.453*** (0.117)	−0.473*** (0.140)
Election Year	0.350** (0.173)	0.205 (0.165)	0.054 (0.061)	0.054 (0.078)	0.025 (0.112)	−0.004 (0.117)	−0.054 (0.095)
EITI Member	1.263*** (0.248)	0.881*** (0.186)	−0.150 (0.130)	−0.204 (0.148)	0.039 (0.097)	−0.032 (0.115)	−0.176 (0.150)
Field Discovery	0.066 (0.386)	−0.109 (0.237)	0.158 (0.128)	0.052 (0.156)	−0.139 (0.220)	−0.305 (0.231)	−0.148 (0.251)
SIDS	0.455 (0.378)	0.433 (0.396)	0.606*** (0.185)	0.720*** (0.267)	−0.329 (0.247)	−0.314 (0.234)	−0.299 (0.193)
Disaster	0.034 (0.228)	−0.090 (0.152)	−0.003 (0.120)	−0.224* (0.134)	0.032 (0.115)	0.090 (0.126)	0.179* (0.098)
Population	−0.063 (0.094)	0.047 (0.071)	0.162*** (0.038)	0.162*** (0.053)	−0.068 (0.059)	−0.071 (0.056)	−0.092** (0.042)
GDP per Capita	−0.004 (0.149)	0.025 (0.133)	0.041 (0.079)	−0.013 (0.110)	0.061 (0.100)	0.212** (0.097)	0.055 (0.115)
Resource Rents	0.012 (0.013)	0.000 (0.011)	−0.004 (0.006)	−0.002 (0.010)	−0.001 (0.005)	−0.006 (0.006)	−0.009 (0.006)
Access to Electricity	0.001 (0.006)	0.003 (0.004)	0.001 (0.002)	0.001 (0.002)	−0.005* (0.003)	−0.007** (0.003)	−0.008*** (0.002)
DAC Aid	0.046 (0.046)	0.072** (0.031)	−0.053 (0.079)	−0.053 (0.069)	0.007 (0.024)	0.013 (0.027)	−0.024 (0.057)
Chinese Finance	−0.015 (0.022)	−0.007 (0.016)	−0.023* (0.013)	−0.036*** (0.011)	0.007 (0.009)	0.014* (0.008)	0.010 (0.009)
IMF Program	0.271 (0.190)	0.253* (0.140)	−0.247*** (0.088)	−0.260** (0.124)	−0.059 (0.072)	−0.122* (0.072)	0.025 (0.111)
UNSC Member	0.067 (0.260)	−0.290 (0.306)	−0.055 (0.116)	−0.179 (0.139)	0.171 (0.118)	0.252** (0.113)	0.094 (0.171)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−0.792 (2.372)	−0.886 (1.842)	1.767* (0.908)	2.210** (0.934)	−0.880 (0.543)	−1.112* (0.578)	−1.263 (0.894)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−1.028 (1.408)	−1.957 (1.359)	0.912 (0.756)	1.140 (0.747)	−0.112 (0.650)	−0.389 (0.619)	0.326 (0.566)
US Pres. is Republican	−0.041 (0.232)	−0.049 (0.199)	0.036 (0.137)	0.144 (0.098)	−0.020 (0.089)	0.211** (0.103)	0.020 (0.092)
US Government Is Divided	0.230 (0.223)	0.100 (0.185)	−0.357*** (0.086)	−0.125** (0.053)	0.025 (0.092)	−0.071 (0.102)	0.108 (0.070)
TTL Experience	0.071*** (0.026)	0.073*** (0.025)	0.024 (0.021)	0.005 (0.019)	−0.029 (0.025)	−0.024 (0.025)	−0.001 (0.023)
Intercept	−4.224* (2.438)	−4.012** (1.660)	−7.304*** (1.289)	−6.440*** (1.197)	−1.330 (1.234)	−2.674*** (0.984)	−1.629 (1.256)
Num.Obs.	7462	7462	7462	7462	7462	7462	7462
AIC	1038.1	668.9	4181.9	3985.4	3041.5	2734.7	3376.3
BIC	1190.3	821.0	4334.1	4137.6	3193.7	2886.9	3528.5

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for natural cubic splines are not directly interpretable on their own; they are used collectively to generate the predicted values shown in the figures. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure H.6: Predicted Project Content (% , Reduced Temporal Scope)



These panels display the average predicted extractive, climate, and health content of a project each year. These predictions are based on fractional logistic regressions reported in Table H.9, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

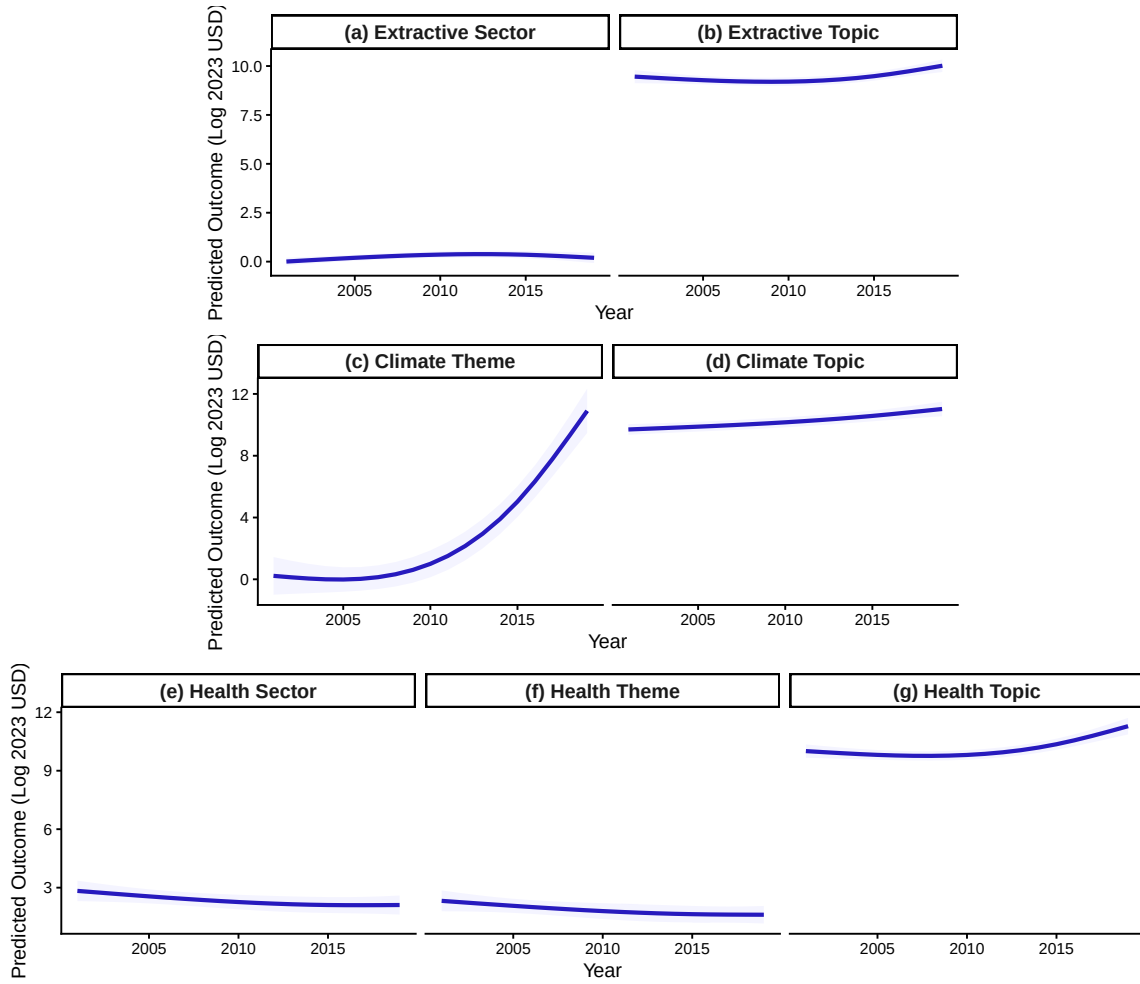
H.4.2 Project Commitment

Table H.10: Predictors of Project Commitment (Log USD), 2001–2019 (Reduced Temporal Scope)

	(a) Extractive Sector Log USD	(b) Extractive Topic Log USD	(c) Climate Theme Log USD	(d) Climate Topic Log USD	(e) Health Sector Log USD	(f) Health Theme Log USD	(g) Health Topic Log USD
Year (Spline Basis 1)	0.648*** (0.158)	−0.034 (0.320)	7.808*** (1.185)	1.511*** (0.229)	−1.302** (0.516)	−1.224** (0.571)	0.502* (0.281)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	−0.133 (0.109)	0.879*** (0.150)	11.297*** (0.627)	1.043*** (0.198)	−0.258 (0.198)	−0.289 (0.193)	1.636*** (0.180)
Governance	−0.079 (0.086)	0.082 (0.145)	1.253*** (0.289)	0.671*** (0.169)	−0.208 (0.245)	−0.340* (0.194)	−0.230 (0.146)
Election Year	0.095 (0.075)	0.018 (0.090)	0.116 (0.178)	0.006 (0.105)	0.034 (0.146)	0.006 (0.136)	0.011 (0.123)
EITI Member	0.609*** (0.117)	−0.166 (0.118)	−0.655** (0.300)	−0.527*** (0.179)	−0.181 (0.222)	−0.128 (0.208)	−0.486*** (0.136)
Field Discovery	0.210 (0.131)	0.036 (0.183)	0.292 (0.388)	0.217 (0.248)	0.021 (0.283)	−0.275 (0.244)	0.017 (0.174)
SIDS	−0.114 (0.164)	−0.012 (0.173)	0.955 (0.577)	0.672* (0.352)	−0.409 (0.409)	−0.335 (0.397)	−0.382* (0.217)
Disaster	0.120 (0.122)	−0.085 (0.112)	−0.071 (0.235)	−0.200 (0.153)	0.109 (0.169)	0.046 (0.195)	0.081 (0.106)
Population	−0.075** (0.031)	0.321*** (0.038)	0.444*** (0.088)	0.471*** (0.060)	−0.116 (0.074)	−0.078 (0.060)	0.238*** (0.040)
GDP per Capita	0.007 (0.067)	0.054 (0.090)	0.102 (0.180)	−0.029 (0.130)	0.088 (0.195)	0.237 (0.154)	0.094 (0.118)
Resource Rents	0.006 (0.007)	0.005 (0.006)	0.007 (0.015)	0.003 (0.006)	−0.003 (0.011)	−0.018* (0.009)	−0.005 (0.007)
Access to Electricity	−0.002 (0.002)	−0.002 (0.003)	0.001 (0.006)	−0.001 (0.003)	−0.013*** (0.004)	−0.012** (0.005)	−0.006* (0.003)
DAC Aid	−0.002 (0.037)	0.079* (0.042)	−0.066 (0.079)	−0.019 (0.039)	−0.034 (0.054)	−0.013 (0.048)	0.028 (0.036)
Chinese Finance	−0.007 (0.008)	0.004 (0.009)	−0.055 (0.039)	−0.027** (0.011)	0.028 (0.025)	0.031 (0.020)	0.016 (0.012)
IMF Program	0.192* (0.094)	0.034 (0.096)	−0.453** (0.188)	−0.308*** (0.101)	−0.043 (0.147)	−0.003 (0.124)	0.013 (0.109)
UNSC Member	−0.078 (0.111)	−0.074 (0.118)	−0.428 (0.349)	−0.144 (0.144)	0.414* (0.205)	0.496** (0.191)	0.065 (0.148)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−0.491 (0.855)	−0.664 (1.008)	3.538 (3.020)	1.899* (1.043)	−2.100 (1.473)	−1.169 (0.905)	−1.017 (0.939)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−0.005 (0.591)	−1.505** (0.696)	1.957 (2.214)	−0.001 (0.808)	−1.082 (1.208)	−0.665 (0.739)	−0.926 (0.567)
US Pres. is Republican	0.062 (0.096)	0.198** (0.092)	0.792** (0.286)	0.297*** (0.098)	0.390*** (0.113)	0.385** (0.158)	0.204* (0.105)
US Government Is Divided	0.038 (0.094)	0.032 (0.064)	−1.195*** (0.312)	−0.173** (0.066)	−0.061 (0.129)	−0.260* (0.139)	0.099 (0.075)
TTL Experience	0.014 (0.019)	−0.054** (0.020)	0.064 (0.055)	−0.066** (0.026)	−0.080** (0.036)	−0.050 (0.036)	−0.059** (0.025)
Intercept	1.166 (0.921)	5.143*** (1.185)	−8.325** (3.337)	2.540 (1.516)	6.187** (2.158)	3.589** (1.314)	6.341*** (1.352)
Num.Obs.	7462	7462	7462	7462	7462	7462	7462
R2	0.017	0.067	0.244	0.080	0.014	0.012	0.048
R2 Adj.	0.014	0.064	0.242	0.077	0.011	0.009	0.045

This table presents the results of seven linear regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The variables *Republican* and *US Government Is Divided* drop out due to perfect collinearity. The coefficients for year fixed effects are omitted from the table for brevity. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure H.7: Predicted Project Commitment (Log USD, Reduced Temporal Scope)



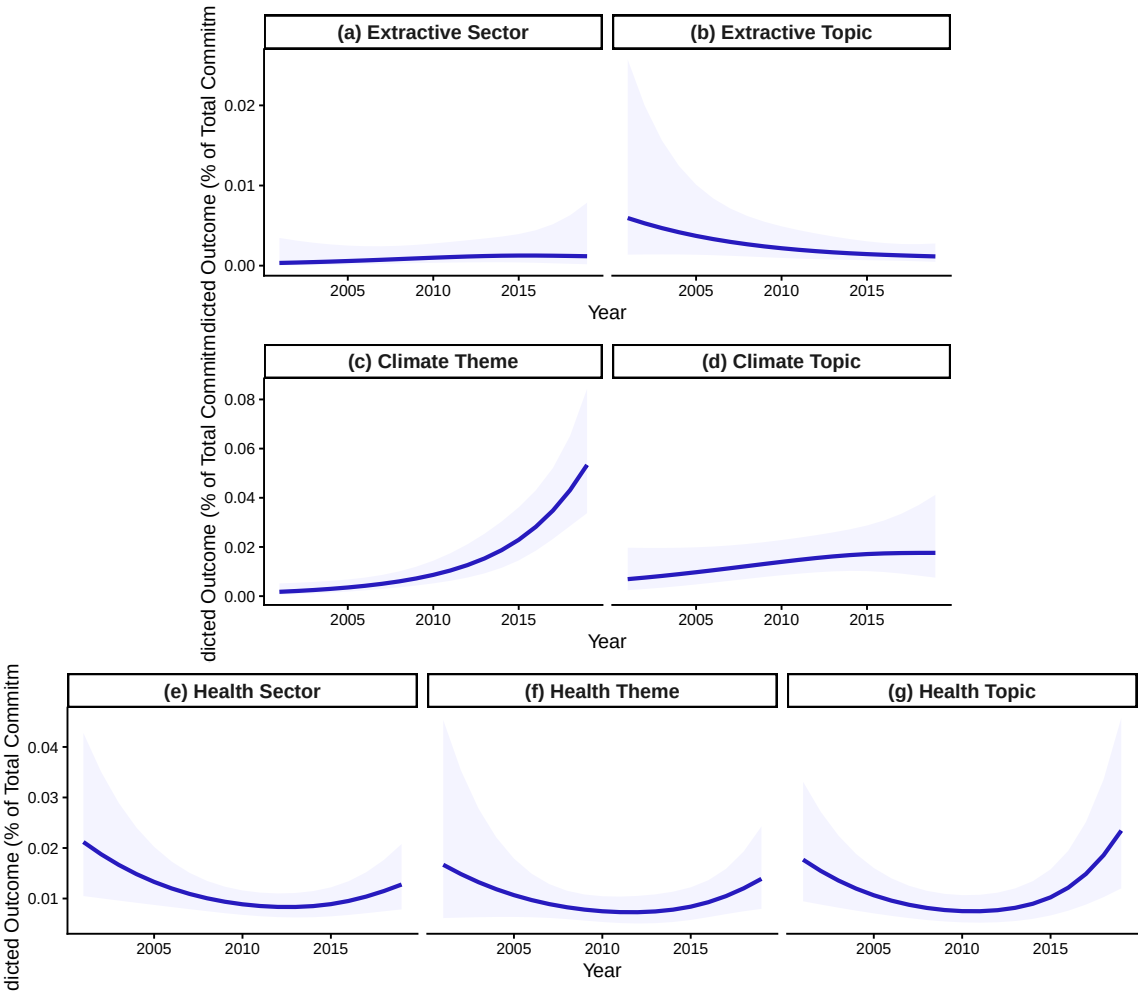
These panels display the average predicted new IDA and IBRD commitment (in logged 2023 USD) per project each year, as a function of a project's share of extractive, renewable, climate, and health content. These predictions are based on linear regressions reported in Table H.10, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

Table H.11: Predictors of Project Commitment (Share of Total Commitments), 2001–2019 (Reduced Temporal Scope)

	(a) Extractive Sector Share Commit.	(b) Extractive Topic Share Commit.	(c) Climate Theme Share Commit.	(d) Climate Topic Share Commit.	(e) Health Sector Share Commit.	(f) Health Theme Share Commit.	(g) Health Topic Share Commit.
Year (Spline Basis 1)	2.373 (1.517)	−2.516* (1.299)	4.494*** (1.071)	1.626** (0.775)	−1.612*** (0.571)	−1.307 (0.922)	−1.100** (0.469)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	0.356 (0.596)	−0.868* (0.489)	2.295*** (0.323)	0.370 (0.386)	0.281* (0.159)	0.578*** (0.205)	1.156*** (0.238)
Governance	−1.354 (0.870)	−0.483 (0.467)	0.176 (0.209)	0.530 (0.477)	−0.446* (0.235)	−0.725** (0.287)	−1.003*** (0.214)
Election Year	−0.313 (0.513)	−0.005 (0.392)	0.098 (0.150)	0.515** (0.240)	0.019 (0.158)	−0.084 (0.154)	−0.119 (0.149)
EITI Member	−0.222 (0.475)	−0.447 (0.355)	−0.067 (0.170)	−0.351 (0.270)	−0.082 (0.148)	−0.205 (0.170)	−0.135 (0.169)
Field Discovery	−0.485 (0.780)	−0.411 (0.376)	−0.072 (0.264)	−0.500 (0.469)	−0.379 (0.298)	−0.713* (0.421)	−0.583** (0.268)
SIDS	−1.728** (0.692)	−0.394 (0.683)	−0.176 (0.270)	−0.517 (0.618)	−0.644 (0.433)	−0.852** (0.402)	−0.759** (0.302)
Disaster	−0.560 (0.786)	−0.029 (0.455)	−0.092 (0.229)	−0.104 (0.359)	−0.065 (0.270)	−0.023 (0.275)	−0.013 (0.282)
Population	0.458** (0.184)	0.487*** (0.137)	0.330*** (0.052)	0.331*** (0.072)	0.409*** (0.072)	0.411*** (0.086)	0.428*** (0.066)
GDP per Capita	1.160* (0.687)	0.457 (0.533)	0.162 (0.099)	0.268 (0.293)	0.668*** (0.256)	0.874*** (0.309)	0.631*** (0.217)
Resource Rents	−0.017 (0.027)	0.001 (0.026)	0.005 (0.017)	−0.018 (0.019)	−0.019 (0.015)	−0.027* (0.014)	−0.031*** (0.011)
Access to Electricity	−0.019 (0.018)	−0.001 (0.013)	0.003 (0.006)	0.002 (0.008)	−0.017*** (0.006)	−0.017*** (0.005)	−0.015*** (0.004)
DAC Aid	0.029 (0.145)	0.046 (0.076)	0.072 (0.060)	0.093 (0.068)	0.029 (0.059)	0.029 (0.060)	0.007 (0.053)
Chinese Finance	−0.062 (0.050)	−0.005 (0.024)	−0.005 (0.017)	−0.041 (0.034)	−0.005 (0.021)	−0.008 (0.017)	−0.007 (0.019)
IMF Program	0.361 (0.287)	0.353 (0.301)	−0.132 (0.171)	−0.088 (0.335)	0.450* (0.236)	0.543* (0.287)	0.364 (0.263)
UNSC Member	−0.878 (0.752)	−1.242** (0.561)	0.450** (0.224)	0.257 (0.365)	0.404* (0.226)	0.576** (0.253)	0.376 (0.268)
US Ideal Point Dist.	2.896 (4.027)	2.428 (2.698)	1.805 (1.480)	1.229 (2.249)	−1.254 (1.912)	−2.289 (2.776)	−3.071 (1.880)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−2.645 (2.964)	−2.744 (2.304)	0.382 (1.042)	1.859 (1.655)	−2.765*** (0.915)	−3.325*** (1.159)	−3.514*** (1.087)
US Pres. is Republican	1.135*** (0.438)	−0.295 (0.489)	−0.278 (0.282)	−0.294 (0.299)	0.019 (0.191)	0.112 (0.229)	0.030 (0.204)
US Government Is Divided	0.248 (0.507)	−0.284 (0.356)	−0.665** (0.262)	−0.453** (0.217)	0.057 (0.229)	0.023 (0.339)	0.119 (0.156)
TTL Experience	−0.137 (0.090)	−0.003 (0.041)	−0.033 (0.028)	−0.105* (0.061)	−0.078 (0.050)	−0.069 (0.057)	0.025 (0.055)
Intercept	−26.286*** (7.179)	−19.529*** (5.568)	−17.794*** (1.418)	−17.966*** (2.317)	−16.871*** (2.641)	−18.199*** (2.724)	−16.762*** (2.361)
Num.Obs.	7462	7462	7462	7462	7462	7462	7462
AIC	44.3	44.5	47.8	46.9	46.3	46.2	46.4
BIC	196.5	196.7	199.9	199.1	198.5	198.4	198.6

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for year fixed effects are omitted from the table for brevity. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure H.8: Predicted Project Commitment (% of Total Commitments, Reduced Temporal Scope)



These panels display the predicted portfolio share of each project (e.g., its climate-relevant commitment as a percentage of total annual IDA and IBRD lending) by year and content category. These predictions are based on fractional logistic regressions reported in Table H.11, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

H.5 Excluding DPF and P4R

About 80 percent of all projects in our sample fall under Investment Project Financing (IPF), rather than Development Project Financing (DPF) or Program-for-Results (P4R). As discussed in the main text, IPF projects focus more narrowly on specific investments, making the official sector and theme classifications more directly comparable to project content. In contrast, classifications are less straightforward for DPF projects (which support broad policy reform programs) or P4R projects (which disburse against outcomes rather than inputs). Below, we restrict the analysis to IPF projects.

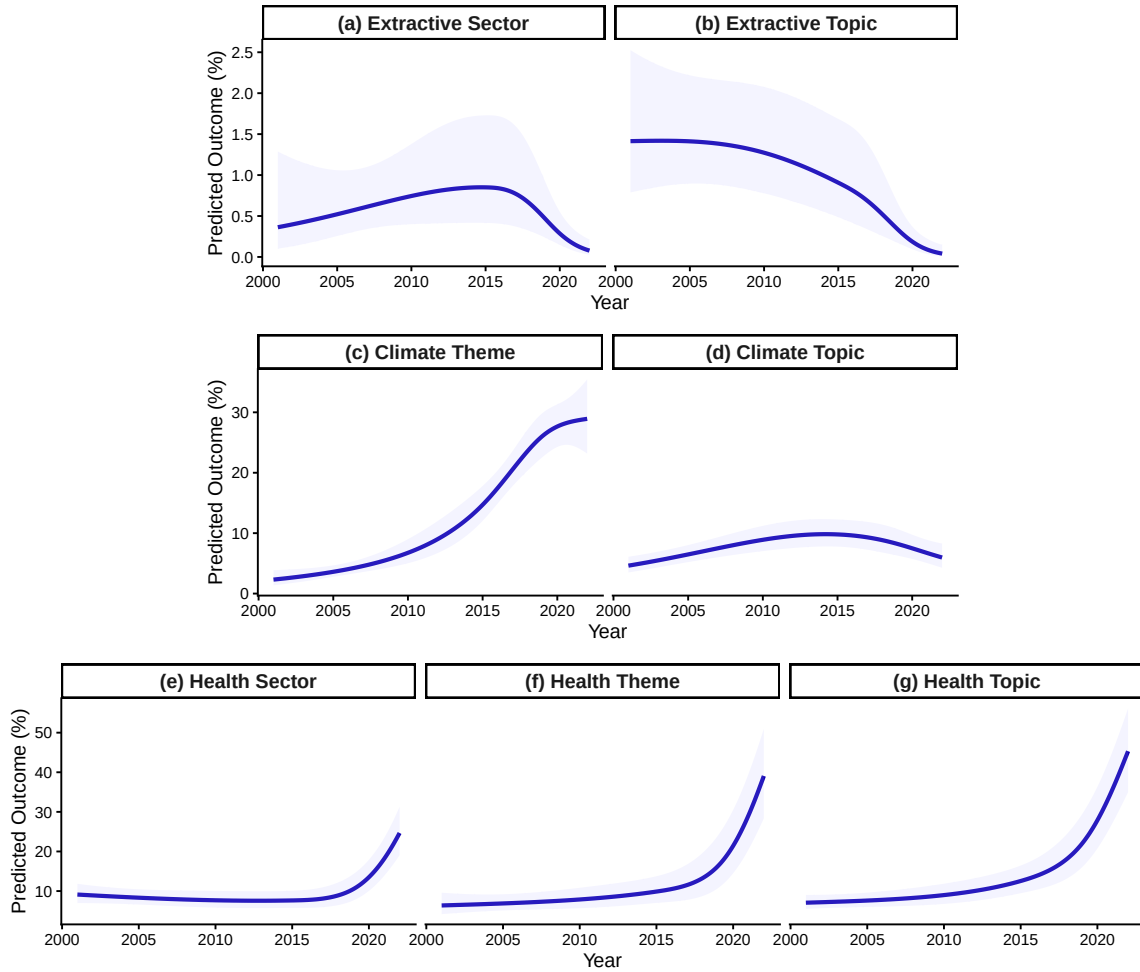
H.5.1 Project Content

Table H.12: Predictors of Project Content, 2001–2022 (IPF Only)

	(a) Extractive Sector Share	(b) Extractive Topic Share	(c) Climate Theme Share	(d) Climate Topic Share	(e) Health Sector Share	(f) Health Theme Share	(g) Health Topic Share
Year (Spline Basis 1)	0.516 (0.456)	−0.896*** (0.319)	2.474*** (0.149)	0.438*** (0.149)	−0.059 (0.168)	0.685*** (0.262)	1.011*** (0.196)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	0.016 (1.469)	−2.735*** (0.651)	3.862*** (0.692)	1.251*** (0.321)	0.548* (0.293)	1.971*** (0.492)	2.154*** (0.310)
Year (Spline Basis 3)	−2.157*** (0.566)	−3.574*** (0.590)	2.120*** (0.119)	−0.328** (0.145)	1.351*** (0.158)	2.118*** (0.205)	2.275*** (0.169)
Governance	−0.194 (0.215)	−0.223 (0.241)	0.411*** (0.124)	0.516*** (0.159)	−0.279** (0.115)	−0.349*** (0.123)	−0.283** (0.122)
Election Year	0.434** (0.186)	0.191 (0.179)	0.017 (0.054)	0.012 (0.090)	0.026 (0.077)	0.001 (0.076)	0.015 (0.059)
EITI Member	1.204*** (0.281)	0.861*** (0.208)	−0.128 (0.095)	−0.260* (0.136)	−0.035 (0.096)	−0.040 (0.095)	−0.205* (0.118)
Field Discovery	−0.028 (0.422)	−0.121 (0.244)	0.194 (0.126)	0.108 (0.160)	−0.134 (0.210)	−0.214 (0.193)	−0.155 (0.205)
SIDS	0.518 (0.381)	0.208 (0.384)	0.595*** (0.155)	0.733*** (0.246)	−0.336* (0.196)	−0.265* (0.148)	−0.349*** (0.114)
Disaster	0.056 (0.226)	−0.054 (0.155)	−0.033 (0.101)	−0.266* (0.137)	0.080 (0.109)	0.058 (0.132)	0.115 (0.109)
Population	−0.034 (0.093)	0.035 (0.073)	0.147*** (0.037)	0.155*** (0.055)	−0.111** (0.052)	−0.118** (0.049)	−0.161*** (0.035)
GDP per Capita	0.034 (0.155)	0.041 (0.145)	0.015 (0.072)	−0.046 (0.113)	0.023 (0.085)	0.135 (0.090)	0.007 (0.083)
Resource Rents	0.018 (0.014)	−0.001 (0.013)	−0.009 (0.005)	−0.002 (0.009)	−0.002 (0.004)	−0.003 (0.006)	−0.010** (0.004)
Access to Electricity	0.003 (0.005)	0.003 (0.004)	0.001 (0.002)	0.002 (0.003)	−0.004 (0.002)	−0.005** (0.003)	−0.005** (0.002)
DAC Aid	0.031 (0.050)	0.068* (0.035)	−0.071 (0.063)	−0.097 (0.077)	0.002 (0.024)	−0.007 (0.038)	−0.010 (0.053)
Chinese Finance	−0.019 (0.027)	−0.007 (0.017)	−0.020* (0.011)	−0.029** (0.012)	0.019** (0.010)	0.025*** (0.008)	0.019** (0.009)
IMF Program	0.271 (0.190)	0.232* (0.140)	−0.149** (0.074)	−0.141 (0.115)	−0.052 (0.076)	−0.040 (0.079)	0.103 (0.093)
UNSC Member	0.162 (0.264)	−0.216 (0.317)	0.102 (0.128)	0.050 (0.167)	0.126 (0.138)	0.178 (0.154)	0.071 (0.167)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−1.238 (2.375)	−0.309 (1.852)	1.217 (0.853)	1.776** (0.806)	−0.452 (0.693)	−0.873 (0.835)	−0.791 (0.710)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−1.639 (1.444)	−1.977 (1.384)	0.854 (0.730)	0.906 (0.626)	0.477 (0.674)	0.190 (0.675)	0.844 (0.581)
US Pres. is Republican	−0.238 (0.252)	0.034 (0.196)	0.066 (0.135)	0.084 (0.082)	0.191* (0.103)	0.542*** (0.115)	0.333*** (0.117)
US Government Is Divided	0.062 (0.205)	−0.038 (0.169)	−0.334*** (0.060)	−0.180*** (0.031)	0.260*** (0.085)	0.286** (0.125)	0.381*** (0.095)
TTL Experience	0.068** (0.027)	0.064** (0.030)	0.027** (0.013)	0.004 (0.016)	−0.010 (0.022)	−0.012 (0.025)	0.000 (0.018)
Intercept	−4.175* (2.410)	−3.900** (1.819)	−6.638*** (1.255)	−5.663*** (1.035)	−1.326 (1.087)	−2.450*** (0.877)	−1.015 (0.932)
Num.Obs.	7484	7484	7484	7484	7484	7484	7484
AIC	1058.3	655.6	5079.6	4137.1	3711.7	3775.2	4507.6
BIC	1217.4	814.8	5238.8	4296.3	3870.9	3934.4	4666.8

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for natural cubic splines are not directly interpretable on their own; they are used collectively to generate the predicted values shown in the figures. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure H.9: Predicted Project Content (% , IPF Only)



These panels display the average predicted extractive, climate, and health content of a project each year. These predictions are based on fractional logistic regressions reported in Table H.12, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

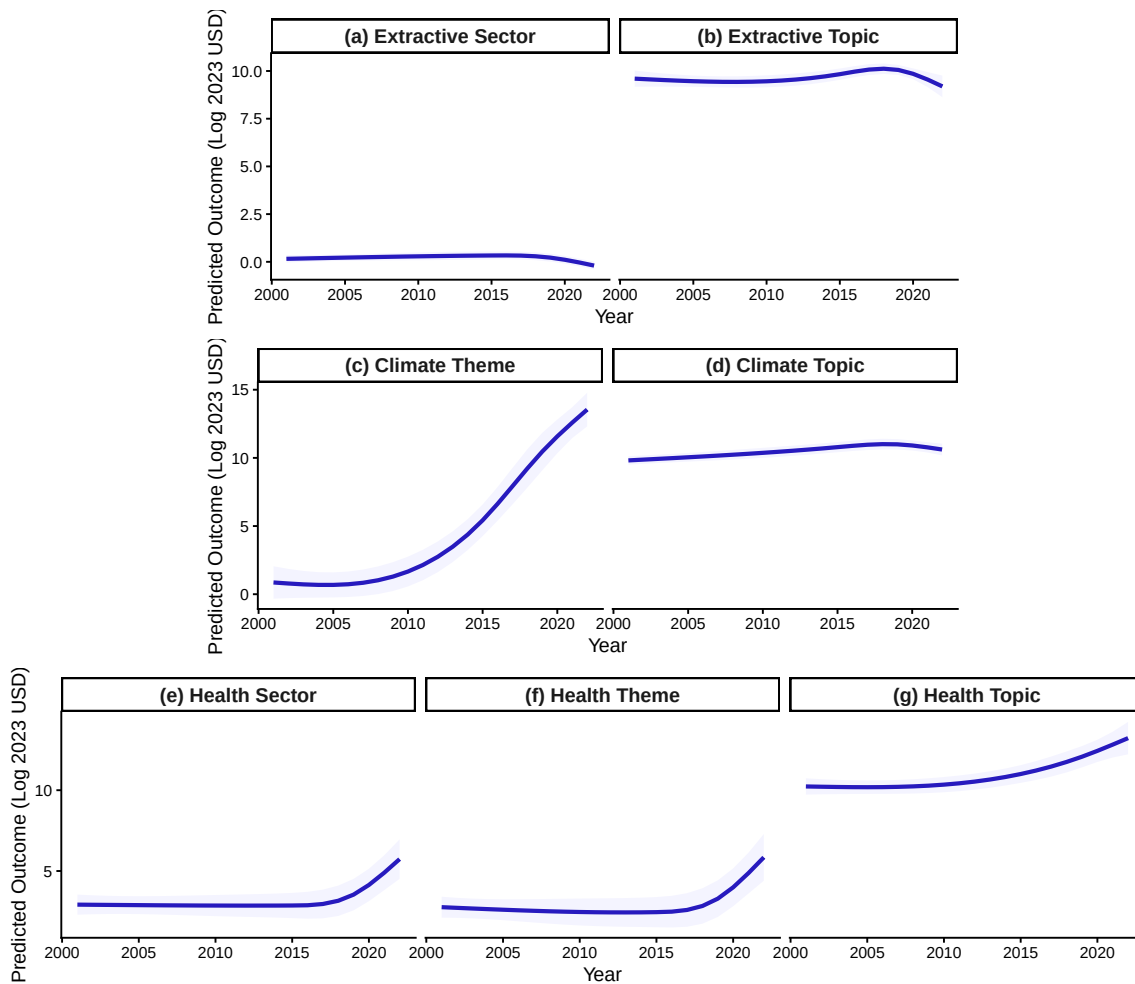
H.5.2 Project Commitment

Table H.13: Predictors of Project Commitment (Log USD), 2001–2022 (IPF Only)

	(a) Extractive Sector Log USD	(b) Extractive Topic Log USD	(c) Climate Theme Log USD	(d) Climate Topic Log USD	(e) Health Sector Log USD	(f) Health Theme Log USD	(g) Health Topic Log USD
Year (Spline Basis 1)	0.145 (0.087)	0.913*** (0.184)	9.734*** (0.754)	1.195*** (0.223)	−0.004 (0.409)	−0.098 (0.541)	1.695*** (0.319)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	−0.042 (0.221)	−0.394 (0.477)	11.015*** (1.352)	1.483*** (0.279)	1.889** (0.703)	1.716* (0.850)	2.427*** (0.566)
Year (Spline Basis 3)	−0.457*** (0.082)	−0.159 (0.270)	13.186*** (0.386)	0.434*** (0.110)	2.870*** (0.537)	3.349*** (0.645)	3.104*** (0.457)
Governance	−0.050 (0.074)	0.008 (0.132)	1.171*** (0.303)	0.633*** (0.166)	−0.583** (0.207)	−0.571*** (0.177)	−0.264* (0.152)
Election Year	0.084 (0.063)	0.036 (0.084)	0.010 (0.208)	−0.025 (0.127)	−0.116 (0.122)	−0.006 (0.130)	0.108 (0.126)
EITI Member	0.340*** (0.118)	−0.122 (0.120)	−0.399 (0.334)	−0.565*** (0.179)	−0.220 (0.201)	−0.043 (0.202)	−0.539*** (0.145)
Field Discovery	0.045 (0.114)	0.006 (0.170)	0.463 (0.364)	0.254 (0.250)	−0.060 (0.271)	−0.239 (0.251)	−0.007 (0.158)
SIDS	−0.050 (0.125)	0.006 (0.165)	1.257** (0.570)	0.793** (0.358)	−0.540* (0.269)	−0.308 (0.318)	−0.381* (0.219)
Disaster	0.056 (0.092)	−0.093 (0.096)	−0.311 (0.229)	−0.316* (0.167)	0.142 (0.168)	0.194 (0.191)	0.072 (0.129)
Population	−0.026 (0.026)	0.303*** (0.032)	0.470*** (0.100)	0.457*** (0.063)	−0.163* (0.087)	−0.117 (0.072)	0.152*** (0.046)
GDP per Capita	0.033 (0.048)	−0.058 (0.099)	0.011 (0.201)	−0.141 (0.134)	0.160 (0.168)	0.160 (0.140)	−0.077 (0.114)
Resource Rents	0.008 (0.005)	0.002 (0.006)	−0.005 (0.011)	0.002 (0.009)	−0.004 (0.009)	−0.010 (0.009)	−0.009 (0.007)
Access to Electricity	−0.001 (0.002)	−0.002 (0.002)	−0.001 (0.007)	0.000 (0.003)	−0.013*** (0.004)	−0.010** (0.004)	−0.004 (0.003)
DAC Aid	0.010 (0.035)	0.082** (0.037)	−0.041 (0.086)	−0.026 (0.041)	−0.039 (0.058)	−0.046 (0.055)	0.029 (0.037)
Chinese Finance	−0.005 (0.008)	0.011 (0.011)	−0.055 (0.043)	−0.019 (0.015)	0.050** (0.020)	0.052*** (0.013)	0.034 (0.022)
IMF Program	0.049 (0.070)	0.002 (0.100)	−0.284 (0.195)	−0.183 (0.123)	−0.074 (0.152)	0.023 (0.129)	0.101 (0.125)
UNSC Member	−0.034 (0.097)	−0.330** (0.131)	−0.474 (0.371)	−0.253* (0.138)	0.308 (0.197)	0.286 (0.191)	−0.220 (0.200)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−0.126 (0.720)	0.577 (1.000)	1.984 (3.189)	2.209* (1.166)	−1.594 (1.465)	−0.423 (1.406)	0.103 (0.783)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−0.241 (0.470)	−0.979 (0.756)	1.156 (2.407)	0.202 (0.952)	0.194 (1.257)	0.935 (0.996)	0.442 (0.654)
US Pres. is Republican	−0.003 (0.064)	0.515*** (0.127)	0.530 (0.317)	0.456*** (0.093)	0.779*** (0.253)	0.871** (0.312)	0.719*** (0.215)
US Government Is Divided	−0.049 (0.058)	0.069 (0.094)	−1.216*** (0.301)	−0.163** (0.070)	0.513** (0.201)	0.399 (0.253)	0.429** (0.158)
TTL Experience	0.007 (0.013)	−0.043* (0.023)	0.062 (0.046)	−0.042* (0.024)	−0.052 (0.039)	−0.034 (0.042)	−0.048 (0.033)
Intercept	0.494 (0.624)	5.190*** (1.023)	−6.630 (3.948)	3.121* (1.635)	4.089** (1.842)	1.853 (1.162)	6.856*** (1.115)
Num.Obs.	7484	7484	7484	7484	7484	7484	7484
R2	0.009	0.075	0.316	0.065	0.032	0.038	0.084
R2 Adj.	0.006	0.072	0.314	0.063	0.029	0.035	0.081

This table presents the results of seven linear regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The variables *Republican* and *US Government Is Divided* drop out due to perfect collinearity. The coefficients for year fixed effects are omitted from the table for brevity. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure H.10: Predicted Project Commitment (Log USD, IPF Only)



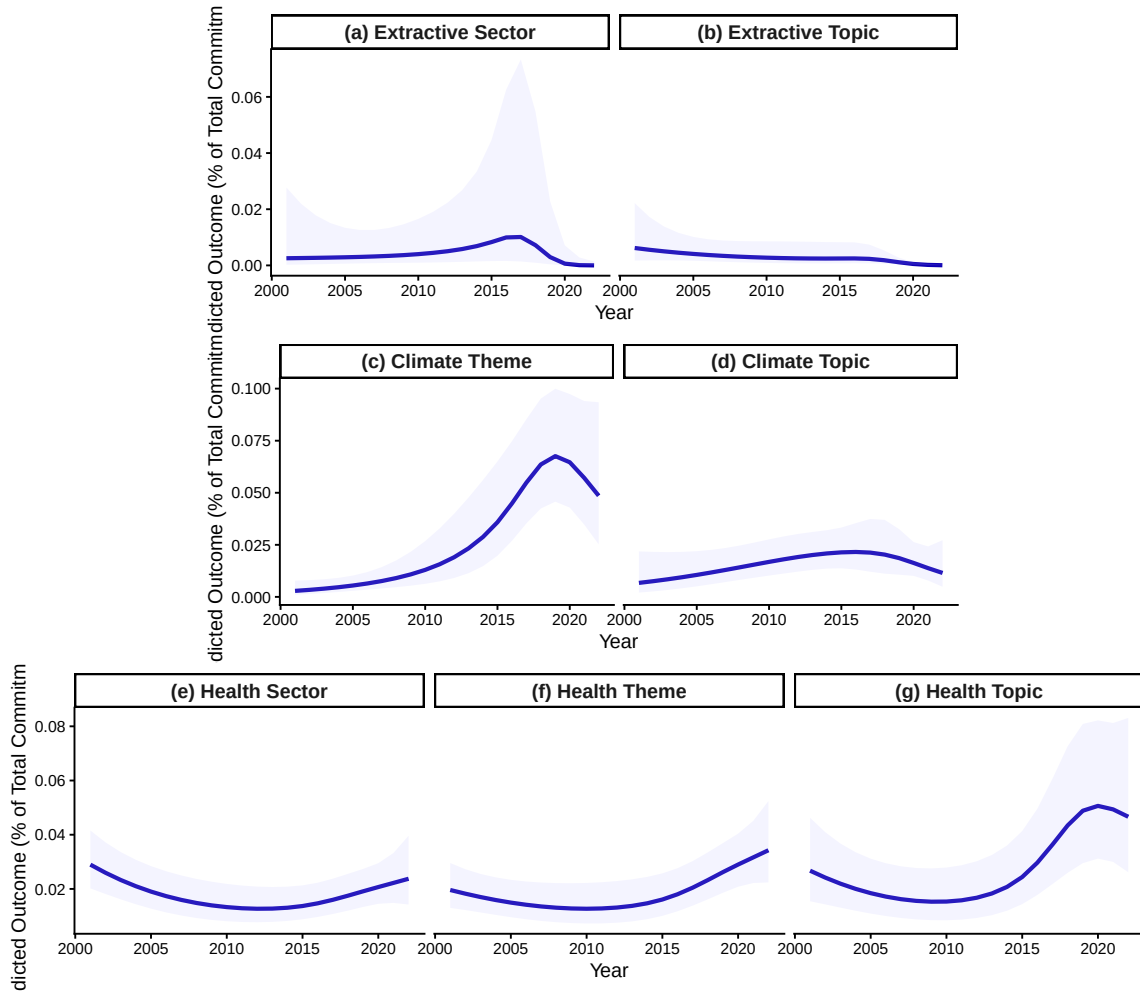
These panels display the average predicted new IDA and IBRD commitment (in logged 2023 USD) per project each year, as a function of a project's share of extractive, renewable, climate, and health content. These predictions are based on linear regressions reported in Table H.13, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

Table H.14: Predictors of Project Commitment (Share of Total Commitments), 2001–2022 (IPF Only)

	(a) Extractive Sector Share Commit.	(b) Extractive Topic Share Commit.	(c) Climate Theme Share Commit.	(d) Climate Topic Share Commit.	(e) Health Sector Share Commit.	(f) Health Theme Share Commit.	(g) Health Topic Share Commit.
Year (Spline Basis 1)	1.959*** (0.617)	−0.481 (0.689)	2.951*** (0.357)	0.835 (0.518)	−0.114 (0.190)	0.497*** (0.170)	1.042*** (0.236)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	−3.161 (2.711)	−4.488*** (1.466)	4.458*** (1.263)	1.790 (1.147)	−1.282*** (0.353)	−0.192 (0.385)	−0.313 (0.493)
Year (Spline Basis 3)	−5.902** (2.580)	−3.959*** (0.814)	1.802*** (0.301)	−0.211 (0.299)	0.514** (0.254)	1.028*** (0.287)	1.209*** (0.215)
Governance	−1.391 (0.932)	−0.628 (0.511)	0.001 (0.174)	0.417 (0.522)	−0.520** (0.210)	−0.643*** (0.205)	−0.692*** (0.252)
Election Year	−0.247 (0.480)	−0.125 (0.418)	0.013 (0.132)	0.478 (0.293)	0.226 (0.177)	0.162 (0.166)	0.062 (0.107)
EITI Member	−0.984* (0.590)	−0.770* (0.430)	−0.028 (0.127)	−0.410 (0.278)	0.067 (0.195)	0.112 (0.223)	−0.066 (0.215)
Field Discovery	−1.494 (1.006)	−0.521 (0.549)	−0.098 (0.214)	−0.494 (0.497)	−0.340 (0.250)	−0.454 (0.304)	−0.455** (0.223)
SIDS	−2.228** (0.988)	−1.818*** (0.674)	−0.107 (0.224)	−0.372 (0.582)	−0.754** (0.344)	−0.688** (0.301)	−0.777*** (0.207)
Disaster	−0.824 (0.938)	−0.078 (0.501)	−0.156 (0.187)	−0.242 (0.337)	−0.110 (0.241)	−0.171 (0.213)	−0.045 (0.197)
Population	0.597*** (0.176)	0.499*** (0.153)	0.339*** (0.043)	0.315*** (0.068)	0.360*** (0.064)	0.343*** (0.064)	0.300*** (0.071)
GDP per Capita	1.514*** (0.549)	0.391 (0.597)	0.153* (0.089)	0.210 (0.295)	0.341** (0.148)	0.375*** (0.113)	0.382*** (0.130)
Resource Rents	−0.033 (0.032)	−0.006 (0.028)	−0.013 (0.012)	−0.017 (0.019)	−0.026** (0.012)	−0.031*** (0.011)	−0.038*** (0.013)
Access to Electricity	−0.032 (0.021)	−0.005 (0.014)	−0.001 (0.005)	0.002 (0.008)	−0.012* (0.006)	−0.011** (0.005)	−0.010** (0.004)
DAC Aid	0.064 (0.161)	0.056 (0.075)	0.087** (0.042)	0.070 (0.070)	0.055 (0.060)	0.060 (0.047)	0.092* (0.051)
Chinese Finance	−0.128 (0.086)	−0.003 (0.025)	0.010 (0.014)	−0.016 (0.027)	0.016 (0.017)	0.014 (0.022)	0.000 (0.021)
IMF Program	0.211 (0.388)	0.159 (0.348)	0.017 (0.143)	0.076 (0.307)	0.214 (0.159)	0.236* (0.133)	0.304** (0.152)
UNSC Member	−2.902*** (0.695)	−1.500** (0.616)	0.277 (0.206)	0.443 (0.378)	0.285 (0.254)	0.466* (0.268)	0.429* (0.244)
US Ideal Point Dist.	3.171 (3.605)	3.922* (2.384)	1.676 (1.564)	1.396 (2.328)	−0.145 (1.450)	0.190 (1.416)	−2.862** (1.178)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−2.896 (3.385)	−3.043 (2.303)	0.731 (0.916)	2.120 (1.540)	−1.179 (1.204)	−0.780 (0.975)	−2.188** (1.033)
US Pres. is Republican	1.732*** (0.618)	0.010 (0.533)	0.167 (0.199)	−0.009 (0.284)	0.261 (0.208)	0.532*** (0.185)	0.310 (0.203)
US Government Is Divided	0.153 (0.580)	−0.541 (0.470)	−0.345** (0.147)	−0.384* (0.229)	0.132 (0.110)	0.041 (0.103)	0.281*** (0.106)
TTL Experience	−0.159 (0.126)	−0.044 (0.066)	−0.016 (0.026)	−0.086* (0.049)	−0.036 (0.035)	−0.025 (0.033)	0.017 (0.032)
Intercept	−29.486*** (5.863)	−18.688*** (5.726)	−17.752*** (1.363)	−17.531*** (2.222)	−15.426*** (2.383)	−16.433*** (1.897)	−14.035*** (2.053)
Num.Obs.	7484	7484	7484	7484	7484	7484	7484
AIC	46.4	46.6	51.9	49.8	49.1	49.1	50.5
BIC	205.6	205.8	211.1	209.0	208.2	208.3	209.6

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for year fixed effects are omitted from the table for brevity. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure H.11: Predicted Project Commitment (% of Total Commitments, IPF Only)



These panels display the predicted portfolio share of each project (e.g., its climate-relevant commitment as a percentage of total annual IDA and IBRD lending) by year and content category. These predictions are based on fractional logistic regressions reported in Table H.14, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

I Alternative Corpora

I.1 Project Information Documents (PID)

Project Information Documents (PIDs) are prepared at the concept stage and updated at the appraisal stage, making them the most temporally proximate document to the sector and theme classifications, which are also assigned at the concept stage. Unlike PDOs, which are a single concise sentence, PIDs are typically 5 to 15 pages long and include a country and sector background section, a project description, safeguard policies, and contact information. They are available for 59.6 percent of all projects across all lending instruments. We use the latest available PID for each project, typically the appraisal-stage version, the most developed project description before Executive Board approval.

The PID model follows the same specification as the PDO model: three keyword topics (*Extractive Topic*, *Climate Topic*, and *Health Topic*) and 12 non-keyword topics, estimated using a dynamic keyATM. Because PIDs are longer than PDOs, they contain more boilerplate language that dilutes topic-specific vocabulary. Thus, we apply a more aggressive stopword list, removing terms that appear uniformly across PIDs regardless of content. This includes generic development finance vocabulary, such as “implementation,” “appraisal,” and “support.”

Table I.1: Most Common Words Per Topic (PID)

Extractive Topic	Climate Topic	Health Topic
energy	management	health
power	climate	covid-19
electricity	agricultural	care
generation	land	response
gas	agriculture	services
efficiency	forest	emergency
mining	natural	financing
distribution	environmental	national
supply	areas	management
transmission	sustainable	hiv

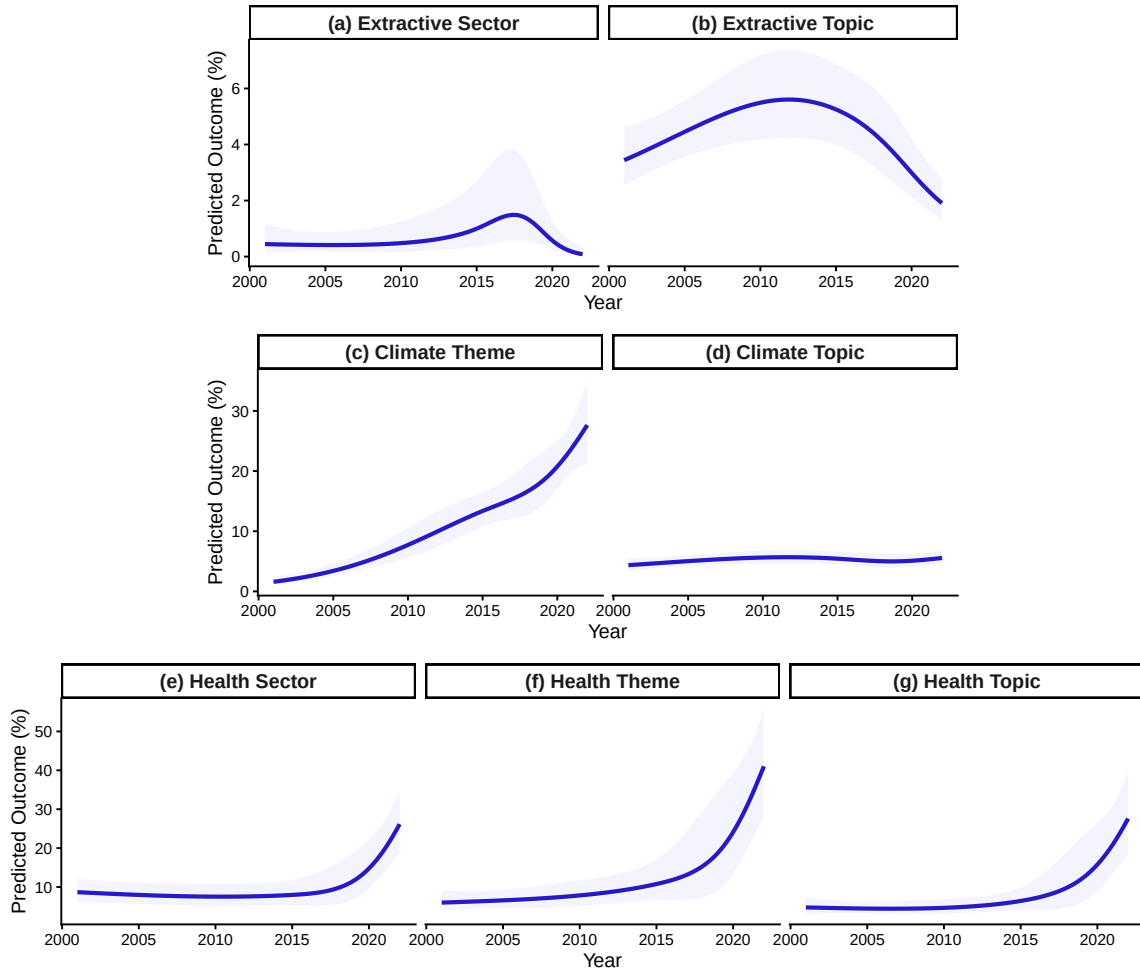
Table I.1 presents the most common words for the three topics of interest, as indicated by a topic model based on PID texts. Table I.2 and Figure I.1 replicate the main content analysis using these PID topics. The key finding is robust: the official *Climate Theme* shows significant time trends that the *Climate Topic* does not mirror, confirming that the divergence between official and text-based climate classifications is not an artifact of the PDO text source. Most control variables behave consistently across both specifications.

Table I.2: Predictors of Project Content, 2001–2022 (PID)

	(a) Extractive Sector Share	(b) Extractive Topic Share	(c) Climate Theme Share	(d) Climate Topic Share	(e) Health Sector Share	(f) Health Theme Share	(g) Health Topic Share
Year (Spline Basis 1)	1.881*** (0.499)	0.000 (0.196)	1.952*** (0.254)	−0.027 (0.134)	0.121 (0.353)	0.958* (0.565)	0.858 (0.531)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	−0.855 (1.220)	0.287 (0.383)	4.792*** (0.580)	0.566** (0.272)	0.708** (0.318)	2.186*** (0.559)	1.473*** (0.542)
Year (Spline Basis 3)	−1.480* (0.781)	−1.061*** (0.135)	1.879*** (0.129)	0.001 (0.087)	1.476*** (0.138)	2.244*** (0.232)	2.164*** (0.226)
Governance	−0.406 (0.280)	0.199 (0.141)	0.299** (0.147)	0.325*** (0.079)	−0.085 (0.106)	−0.117 (0.125)	0.020 (0.094)
Election Year	0.512** (0.219)	0.160* (0.094)	0.000 (0.067)	−0.036 (0.069)	0.084 (0.104)	−0.044 (0.088)	−0.029 (0.069)
EITI Member	0.920** (0.365)	0.202** (0.088)	−0.025 (0.106)	−0.023 (0.045)	−0.030 (0.095)	0.009 (0.084)	0.045 (0.096)
Field Discovery	−0.061 (0.410)	−0.141 (0.145)	0.061 (0.149)	0.108 (0.085)	−0.088 (0.230)	−0.129 (0.214)	−0.092 (0.137)
SIDS	0.117 (0.524)	−0.048 (0.223)	0.445** (0.186)	0.139 (0.119)	−0.181 (0.236)	−0.052 (0.180)	−0.009 (0.136)
Disaster	−0.020 (0.369)	−0.264** (0.109)	−0.051 (0.128)	0.131 (0.114)	0.052 (0.119)	0.091 (0.142)	0.061 (0.104)
Population	0.038 (0.114)	0.129*** (0.048)	0.127*** (0.045)	0.005 (0.023)	−0.098* (0.053)	−0.109** (0.048)	−0.118*** (0.036)
GDP per Capita	−0.036 (0.166)	−0.053 (0.096)	−0.002 (0.077)	−0.059 (0.068)	−0.120 (0.087)	−0.039 (0.082)	−0.113 (0.071)
Resource Rents	0.027 (0.017)	0.001 (0.007)	−0.014** (0.006)	−0.001 (0.006)	0.003 (0.005)	0.002 (0.006)	0.002 (0.005)
Access to Electricity	0.006 (0.006)	0.002 (0.003)	0.003 (0.002)	−0.002 (0.002)	−0.001 (0.002)	−0.001 (0.003)	−0.003 (0.003)
DAC Aid	−0.022 (0.082)	−0.037 (0.037)	−0.072 (0.065)	−0.086** (0.035)	−0.005 (0.033)	0.002 (0.037)	−0.007 (0.032)
Chinese Finance	−0.008 (0.026)	−0.024*** (0.009)	−0.020* (0.011)	−0.005 (0.008)	0.015* (0.009)	0.016* (0.008)	0.014 (0.009)
IMF Program	0.127 (0.323)	−0.046 (0.076)	−0.149 (0.105)	−0.124* (0.073)	−0.006 (0.057)	0.040 (0.081)	0.067 (0.066)
UNSC Member	−0.008 (0.522)	−0.238* (0.133)	0.168 (0.169)	0.103 (0.091)	0.185 (0.133)	0.220* (0.128)	0.097 (0.157)
US Ideal Point Dist.	−0.740 (1.920)	0.317 (0.859)	1.922** (0.908)	−0.712 (0.497)	−0.421 (0.692)	−1.077 (1.005)	−0.613 (0.865)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−2.464* (1.352)	−0.550 (0.537)	1.244 (0.791)	−0.308 (0.342)	0.226 (0.732)	−0.178 (0.710)	0.633 (0.657)
US Pres. is Republican	0.158 (0.364)	0.189* (0.113)	0.052 (0.116)	−0.280*** (0.067)	0.303*** (0.107)	0.643*** (0.159)	0.678*** (0.151)
US Government Is Divided	−0.050 (0.236)	−0.129* (0.072)	−0.245*** (0.092)	0.027 (0.085)	0.285** (0.113)	0.289 (0.185)	0.251 (0.169)
TTL Experience	0.103*** (0.035)	0.046** (0.019)	0.045** (0.018)	0.050*** (0.015)	0.003 (0.027)	0.001 (0.027)	0.015 (0.019)
Intercept	−4.704* (2.576)	−4.581*** (0.816)	−7.255*** (1.157)	−1.872*** (0.555)	−0.547 (1.190)	−1.299 (0.990)	−1.371 (0.926)
Num.Obs.	5623	5623	5623	5623	5623	5623	5623
AIC	578.9	939.2	3352.4	915.7	2885.9	2847.2	1600.5
BIC	731.4	1091.8	3504.9	1068.3	3038.5	2999.8	1753.1

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for natural cubic splines are not directly interpretable on their own; they are used collectively to generate the predicted values shown in the figures. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Figure I.1: Predicted Project Content (% , PID)



These panels display the average predicted extractive, climate, and health content of a project each year. These predictions are based on fractional logistic regressions reported in Table I.2, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

I.2 Project Appraisal Documents (PAD)

Project Appraisal Documents (PADs) are the full technical documents underlying each IPF project and are typically 50 to 150 pages long. They detail the project’s objectives, components, risk assessment, and implementation and monitoring arrangements. PADs are available for 46.4 percent of all projects, restricted to IPF; DPF projects use Program Documents and P4R projects use Program Appraisal Documents, both of which follow different templates.

Though the previous analysis uses the *latest* available PID, this analysis uses the *earliest* available PAD for each project. The logic is that we want to approximate what the Executive Board reviews and approves. The appraisal-stage PID is the most recent public description of the project prior to Board approval, while the earliest PAD corresponds to the document submitted as part of the negotiation package (projects that are subsequently restructured, for example, may produce revised PADs).

The PAD model follows the same specification as the PDO and PID models, but boilerplate language is an even more significant concern. All PADs contain the expression “Public Disclosure Authorized” in the header, and most include standardized expressions like “proposed grant,” “implementing agency,” “recipient country,” “contact name,” and so on. We apply the most aggressive stopword removal of the three models. Despite this preprocessing, the PAD extractive and climate topics are less coherent than in the PDO and PID models, for two related reasons. First, PADs are substantially longer than PDOs and PIDs, meaning that topic-specific vocabulary represents a smaller fraction of each document’s total vocabulary. In other words, there is considerably more noise than signal. Second, PADs cover only IPF projects, so the PAD analysis has a smaller sample: 4,794 projects, only 81 of which belong to the *Extractive Sector*. This provides insufficient signal for the topic model to identify a coherent extractive cluster. This is less of a problem for the climate topic (1,695 projects belong to the *Climate Theme*), but climate vocabulary in PADs tends to appear in environmental safeguard sections that are present across many project types, diluting its discriminating power. For these reasons, we interpret the PAD analysis with caution.

Table I.3: Most Common Words Per Topic (PAD Model)

Extractive Topic	Climate Topic	Health Topic
energy	management	health
power	land	services
electricity	forest	care
generation	areas	hiv
gas	conservation	aids
transmission	sustainable	national
distribution	environmental	system
supply	natural	nutrition
system	resources	children
efficiency	national	facilities

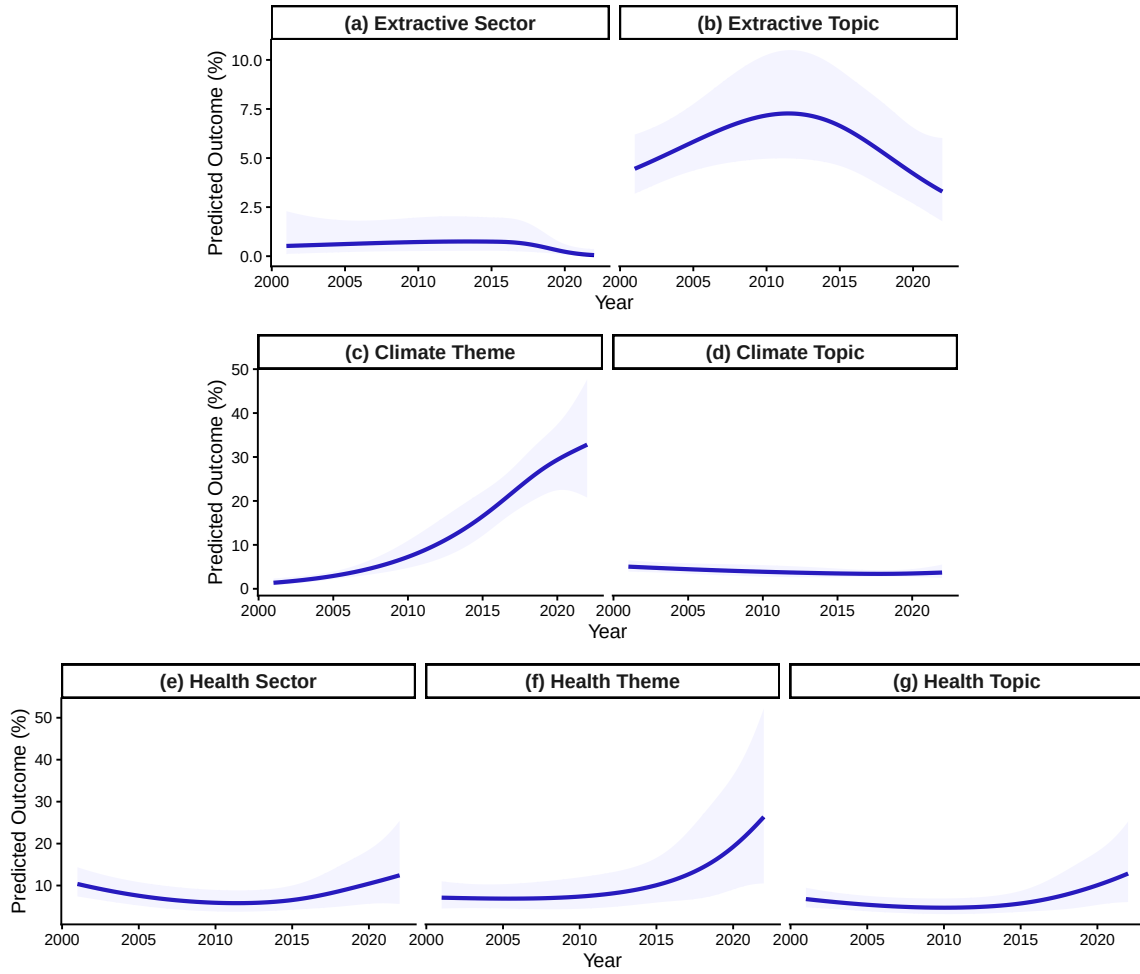
Table I.3 presents the most common words for the three topics of interest, as indicated by the topic model based on PAD texts. Table I.4 replicates the main content analysis using PAD texts. Despite the smaller samples and the known limitations of the PAD extractive and climate topics discussed above, the key finding is robust: the official *Climate Theme* shows large and significant time trends across all spline bases, while the *Climate Topic* is flat. Visually, this discrepancy is even more pronounced in the PAD model than in the PDO or PID models, suggesting the reclassification pattern is not an artifact of the text source.

Table I.4: Predictors of Project Content, 2001–2022 (PAD)

	(a) Extractive Sector Share	(b) Extractive Topic Share	(c) Climate Theme Share	(d) Climate Topic Share	(e) Health Sector Share	(f) Health Theme Share	(g) Health Topic Share
Year (Spline Basis 1)	0.148 (0.431)	−0.086 (0.203)	2.772*** (0.143)	−0.343*** (0.121)	0.134 (0.302)	0.880** (0.440)	0.425 (0.324)
Year (Spline Basis 2)	−1.097 (1.532)	0.506 (0.471)	5.276*** (0.840)	−0.661** (0.321)	−0.736* (0.433)	1.225* (0.660)	−0.020 (0.442)
Year (Spline Basis 3)	−2.552*** (0.887)	−0.797*** (0.218)	2.303*** (0.193)	−0.112 (0.113)	0.796*** (0.308)	1.620*** (0.393)	1.121*** (0.313)
Governance	−0.749 (0.497)	0.113 (0.116)	0.278** (0.113)	0.391*** (0.120)	−0.139 (0.123)	−0.196* (0.109)	−0.110 (0.107)
Election Year	0.255 (0.299)	0.097 (0.091)	−0.097 (0.082)	−0.136 (0.104)	0.034 (0.126)	−0.111 (0.121)	−0.064 (0.098)
EITI Member	1.488*** (0.397)	0.054 (0.125)	0.071 (0.105)	0.300*** (0.106)	−0.112 (0.102)	−0.175* (0.095)	−0.137 (0.084)
Field Discovery	0.358 (0.383)	−0.086 (0.112)	0.257** (0.102)	0.250*** (0.092)	−0.205 (0.281)	−0.333 (0.250)	−0.218 (0.201)
SIDS	0.525 (0.573)	0.001 (0.185)	0.531*** (0.164)	−0.146 (0.179)	−0.130 (0.259)	−0.002 (0.266)	0.004 (0.214)
Disaster	−0.602 (0.571)	−0.288** (0.133)	0.061 (0.113)	0.153 (0.134)	0.008 (0.122)	0.030 (0.149)	0.095 (0.118)
Population	0.026 (0.176)	0.061* (0.037)	0.114*** (0.034)	−0.067* (0.041)	−0.078 (0.063)	−0.075 (0.072)	−0.103** (0.053)
GDP per Capita	−0.098 (0.202)	−0.071 (0.082)	−0.001 (0.080)	0.086 (0.099)	−0.005 (0.098)	0.098 (0.089)	0.051 (0.081)
Resource Rents	0.000 (0.027)	−0.001 (0.006)	−0.008 (0.007)	−0.003 (0.005)	−0.002 (0.012)	−0.004 (0.011)	−0.003 (0.006)
Access to Electricity	0.004 (0.010)	0.002 (0.003)	0.004 (0.003)	−0.005** (0.002)	−0.003 (0.003)	−0.005* (0.003)	−0.005** (0.003)
DAC Aid	0.058 (0.215)	−0.005 (0.072)	−0.058 (0.073)	0.040 (0.060)	−0.029 (0.076)	−0.053 (0.093)	−0.029 (0.067)
Chinese Finance	−0.106 (0.108)	−0.009 (0.014)	−0.018 (0.013)	0.003 (0.015)	0.022** (0.011)	0.027*** (0.010)	0.024** (0.010)
IMF Program	0.047 (0.288)	0.003 (0.082)	−0.104 (0.108)	−0.176** (0.090)	0.035 (0.076)	0.077 (0.091)	0.066 (0.082)
UNSC Member	−0.153 (0.675)	−0.059 (0.191)	0.266 (0.194)	0.106 (0.111)	0.196 (0.175)	0.338* (0.193)	0.252** (0.128)
US Ideal Point Dist.	0.250 (2.903)	0.926 (0.730)	1.712* (0.888)	−0.655 (0.829)	−1.532 (1.082)	−2.098* (1.101)	−1.429* (0.804)
China Ideal Point Dist.	−0.412 (1.407)	0.053 (0.455)	1.212 (0.806)	0.215 (0.644)	−0.296 (0.922)	−0.918 (0.801)	−0.335 (0.635)
US Pres. is Republican	0.991*** (0.285)	0.258* (0.149)	0.124 (0.196)	−0.092 (0.087)	0.208 (0.180)	0.562** (0.242)	0.383** (0.176)
US Government Is Divided	0.335 (0.338)	−0.058 (0.102)	−0.353*** (0.123)	−0.105 (0.093)	0.317** (0.158)	0.407 (0.252)	0.308* (0.175)
TTL Experience	0.019 (0.065)	0.045** (0.022)	0.038** (0.015)	0.086*** (0.019)	−0.013 (0.030)	−0.023 (0.023)	−0.009 (0.020)
Intercept	−5.975** (2.837)	−3.757*** (0.817)	−7.352*** (1.028)	−2.020*** (0.757)	−0.702 (1.379)	−1.656 (1.102)	−1.199 (0.961)
Num.Obs.	4412	4412	4412	4412	4412	4412	4412
AIC	353.5	1234.2	2911.1	678.8	1974.1	2062.3	881.5
BIC	500.5	1381.3	3058.1	825.8	2121.1	2209.4	1028.5

This table presents the results of seven fractional logistic regressions with standard errors clustered by country and year. All independent variables other than *TTL Experience* are lagged at $t - 1$. The coefficients for natural cubic splines are not directly interpretable on their own; they are used collectively to generate the predicted values shown in the figures. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

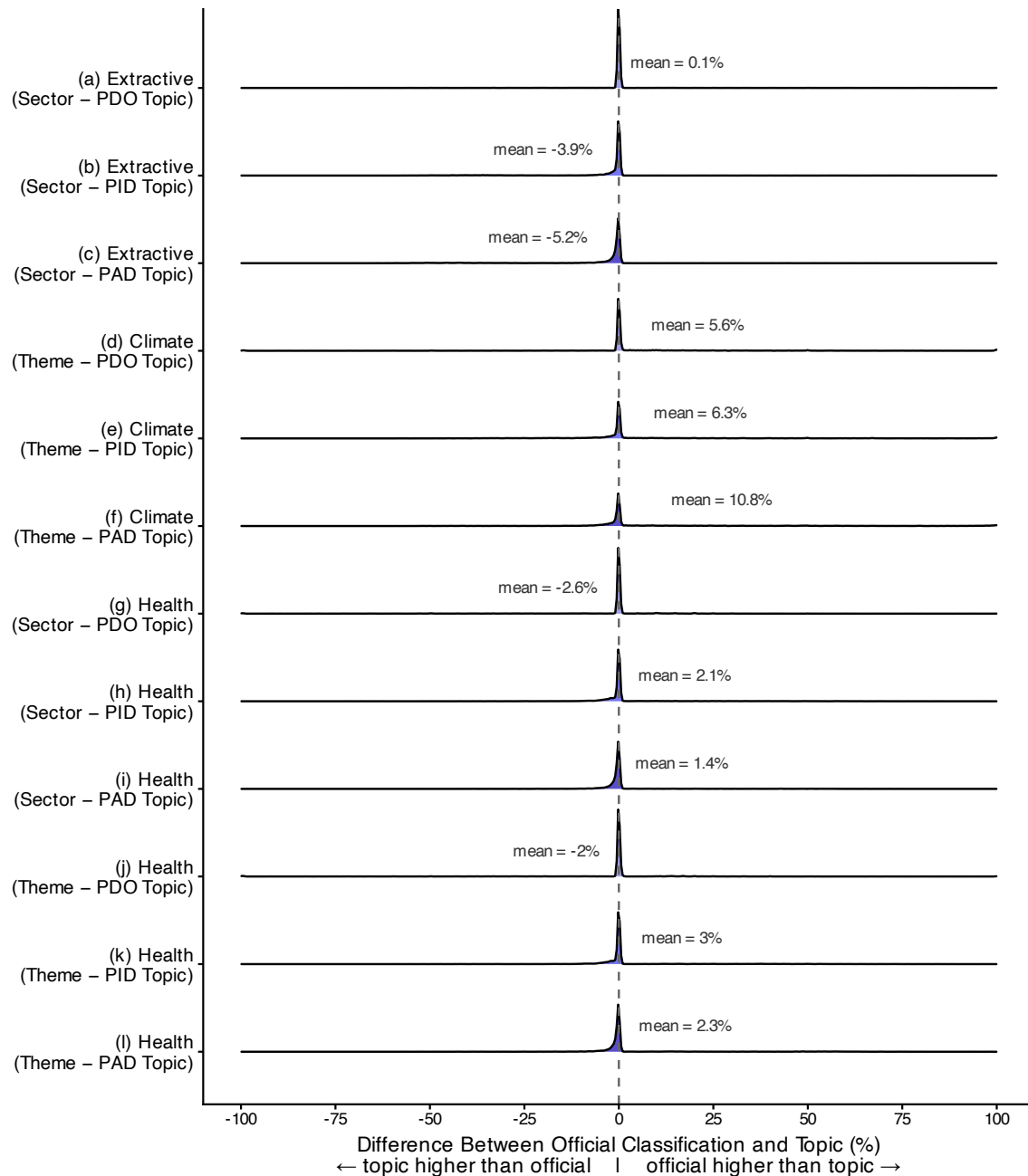
Figure I.2: Predicted Project Content (% , PAD)



These panels display the average predicted extractive, climate, and health content of a project each year. These predictions are based on fractional logistic regressions reported in Table I.4, holding all numeric covariates at their means and categorical covariates at their reference categories. Note that each row has its own y-axis scale.

I.3 Discrepancy Plots

Figure I.3: Discrepancy Plots

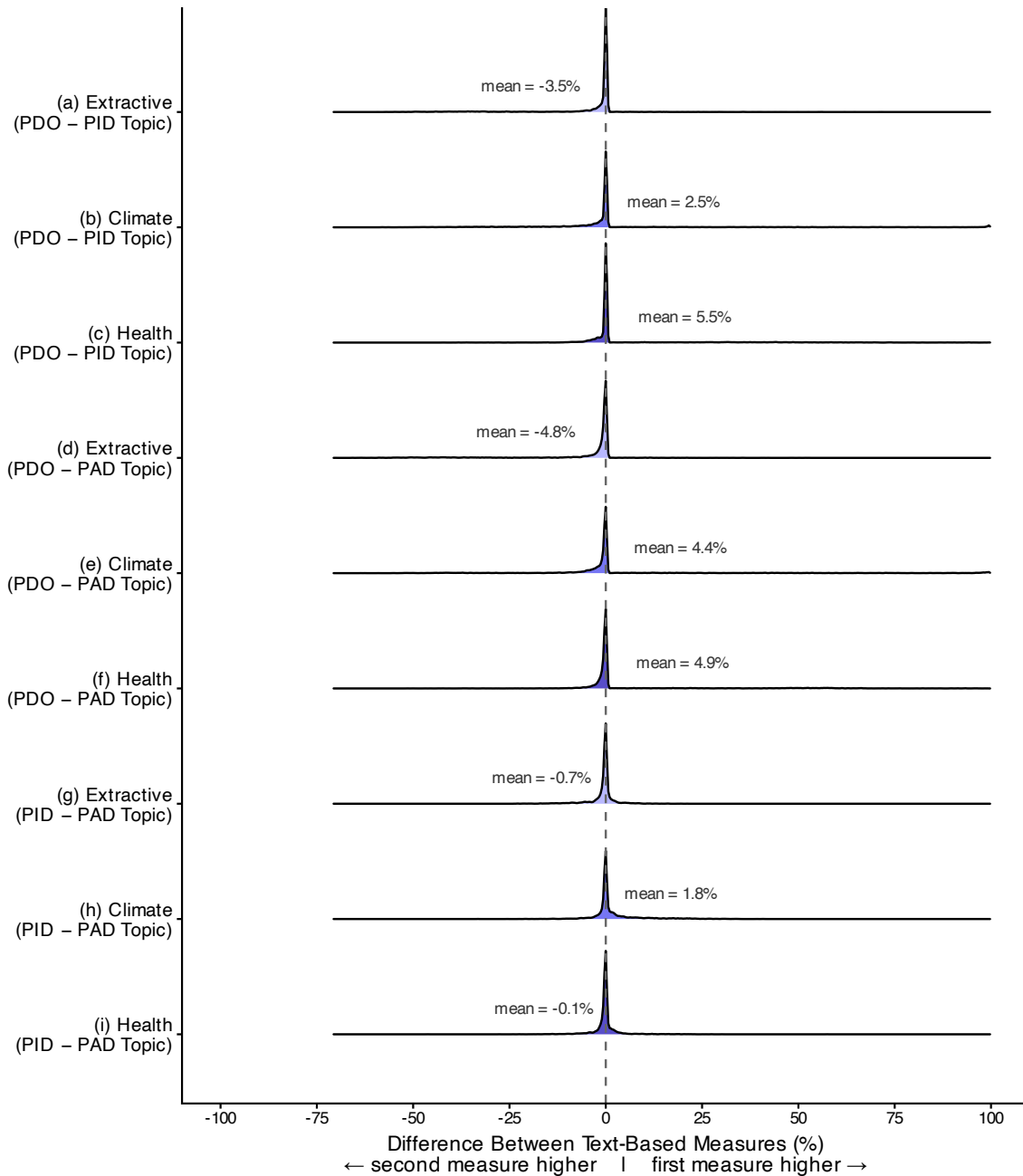


These plots show the distribution of discrepancies between the World Bank's official project classifications and the text-based topic proportions derived from PDOs, PIDs, and PADs. Positive values indicate projects where the official classification exceeds the topic proportion, whereas negative values indicate projects where the topic model identifies more content than the official classification. The dashed vertical line marks zero (perfect agreement).

Figure I.3 compares the discrepancy between official classifications and text-based topic proportions across all three text sources. The direction and magnitude of discrepancies vary systematically with document length. The official *Extractive Sector* classification agrees closely with the PDO topic (mean discrepancy: 0.1 percentage points), but the PID and PAD topics identify progressively more extractive content than officially classified (−3.9 and −5.2 percentage points, respectively). This suggests that the longer, more detailed documents reveal extractive content that the short project summaries and official labels obscure. For climate, the pattern runs in the opposite direction: *Climate Theme* overstates climate content relative to all three text sources, and the discrepancy grows with document length (5.6

percentage points for PDOs, 6.3 for PIDs, and 10.8 for PADs). Put differently, the full technical document underlying a project contains even less climate-relevant vocabulary than the concise project summary, suggesting that climate labels are applied at a high level of abstraction that is not reflected in the concrete details of project design. For health, discrepancies are comparatively small and consistent, confirming that the benchmark category behaves as expected regardless of text source. Together, these results suggest that the longer and less public-facing the document, the larger the climate discrepancy. This is consistent with strategic framing in public-facing communications and cannot be explained by differences in model specification, given that all three topic models use identical keyword lists, the same number of topics, and similar (though not identical) preprocessing pipelines.

Figure I.4: Discrepancy Plots



These plots show the distribution of discrepancies between the three text-based topic measures derived from PDOs, PIDs, and PADs. Positive values indicate projects where the first topic proportion exceeds the second topic proportion, whereas negative values indicate projects where the second topic proportion identifies more content than the first topic proportion. The dashed vertical line marks zero (perfect agreement).

Figure I.4 compares the three text-based measures directly. Across all three issue areas, PID and PAD topics are

quite similar, with mean discrepancies of less than 2 percentage points in all cases. The largest differences are between PDO topics and PID/PAD topics, a pattern consistent with the vocabulary dilution argument. Because PIDs and PADs are longer documents, they spread topic-specific vocabulary more thinly.